77 号往事

Route 77: The Haunted Highway

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迷途的脚印
A Trail of Footprints THH-01

德克萨斯·原野
Countryside, Texas

被雨水润湿的土壤，微微凹陷的脚印。
Rain-soaked soil. Shallow footprints.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

雇佣兵打扮的女性单膝跪地，她的眼睛正发着灼目的亮光。
A mercenary in a wide-brimmed hat kneels on one knee, her left eye glowing brightly.

阿尔古斯：脚长 10.6 英寸。
Argus: 10.6 inches long.

脚印下的泥土并不平整，有一侧更深地印进泥土中。
The soil beneath the footprint is uneven. One side presses deeper into the ground.

阿尔古斯：跛足。
Argus: Signs of limping.

步幅大，压痕重，有挖痕。
Wide stride, heavy indentations, a slight drag.

阿尔古斯：男。
Argus: Male.

中前掌压痕重，后跟则较轻。前尖挖痕大，后跟擦痕相对较少。
Heavy pressure on the forefoot, lighter on the heel. Deep scrapes at the front, fewer at the back.

阿尔古斯：……20 岁左右。
Argus: Around 20 years old.

运步轻便，脚印前掌压力不均匀。
Light on his feet, uneven pressure on the forefoot.

阿尔古斯：体重低。
Argus: Light-weight.

她感到头皮作痒，用猎枪的枪管用力地戳了戳痒处。
She scratches her scalp with the barrel of her shotgun.

行得越远，那些脚印愈发的杂乱——更多的线索出现了。
The further she goes, the more irregular the footprints become—and the more clues emerge.

阿尔古斯：……人数变多了。
Argus: More sets of footprints here.

不远处传来了草叶摩擦的沙沙声。
随之一并涌入耳中的，还有细微的人语。
There's a rustling in the grass nearby, along with the faint sound of a conversation.

“启明会”信众 I：老大，那位大人所需要的材料就在这儿吗?
"Order" Follower I: Boss, are you sure this is where the materials for the revered one are?

“启明会”信众 I：可是……这里没有农宅，更别说是集市了！
"Order" Follower I: There isn't even a single trace of human activity here, let alone a market!

“启明会”信众 II： ……
"Order" Follower II: ...

“启明会”信众 I： 所以……只剩下一种可能——材料是这些植物，对吗?
"Order" Follower I: I guess the only possible explanation is we're here for these plants, right?

“启明会”信众 II： 蠢货，这当然不是。
"Order" Follower II: Of course not, you idiot.

“启明会”信众 I： 哈哈，真可惜！我还想说，割草正是我最擅长的活计之一。您看我掌心的这些茧子……虽然老妈总嫌弃我笨手笨脚。
"Order" Follower I: Haha, that's too bad! I'm great at harvesting plants. I'm a pro, see? Check out these calluses. Although, my mom would probably disagree.

“启明会”信众 I： 我想那应该是些需要细致对待的玩意儿。所以，您得告诉我它们长什么样，以免被我当成杂草。
"Order" Follower I: Do you have any idea what these materials look like? They must be important, so we better handle them with care. Don't wanna risk mistaking them for weeds, you know.

“启明会”信众 I： 毕竟我的腿伤还没好，路都走不顺，更别说那些精细的活计了。
"Order" Follower I: I hope they're easy enough to find. With my leg messed up like this, I can hardly handle any delicate work.

阿尔古斯： 是了……一个跛足的男人。
Argus: That's him. The one with the limp.

“启明会”信众 II： 抱歉。
"Order" Follower II: Sorry about this, man.

遥远而模糊的上膛声。
There's a distant sound of a gun being cocked.

“启明会”信众 II： 我想，她此刻应当正在天堂等您。
"Order" Follower II: But at least you'll see your mom soon, up there in heaven.

“启明会”信众 I： 什、什么……
"Order" Follower I: Wh-What?

“砰——”
bang

雇佣兵果决地按下了扳机，子弹擦伤了施暴者的面颊。
The mercenary decisively pulls the trigger of her shotgun. The bullet grazes the assailant's cheek.

“启明会”信众 II： ——谁?!
"Order" Follower II: Who's there?!

“启明会”信众 I： ……!
"Order" Follower I: ...

阿尔古斯： 还不走?
Argus: What're you waiting for? Get your ass outta here.

“启明会”信众 I： 我……
"Order" Follower I: I ...

那双颤抖的手泄露了他的不安和惊惧。
His trembling hands betray his fear and panic.

阿尔古斯： 也是，我想你应该会需要问他一些问题……
Argus: Ah. You got a couple questions for this one too, huh?

阿尔古斯： 但，抱歉，我先来的。
Argus: Well, first come, first served.

阿尔古斯： 不介意的话，你可以当第二个。
Argus: I'm afraid you're gonna have to get in line.

她一脚踩住男人的胸膛，把枪管压在了男人的喉咙上。
She steps on the man's chest and presses the barrel of her gun against his throat.

阿尔古斯： 听着，老兄。
Argus: Alright, here's how we're gonna do this.

阿尔古斯： 我有话要问你，有什么就说什么，不然我就会打穿你的喉咙。
Argus: I ask. You answer. If you lie, I'll blow your jaw off.

阿尔古斯： 你见过一个叫“凯拉”的女孩吗?
Argus: Have you ever met a girl named Kayla?

“启明会”信众 II： 凯、凯拉……?
"Order" Follower II: Kayla?

阿尔古斯： 我换一个问法。
Argus: Let's try that again.

阿尔古斯： 你是否见过一个女孩，她大概有 5 英尺 3 英寸高，栗色头发，翠绿色的眼珠，有德克萨斯的口音……
Argus: A girl, about 5 foot 3, chestnut hair, emerald green eyes, speaks like a Texan.

阿尔古斯： 你见过吗？是，或者不是。
Argus: Have you seen her? Yes or no?

男人惊恐地以一个小幅度摇头。
The man shakes his head in terror.

阿尔古斯： 不是?
Argus: No?

她忽然露出了一个笑容。
She smirks.

阿尔古斯： 那你的表袋里怎么会有凯拉的发卡?
Argus: Then why's her hair clip in your pocket?

她压了压枪管，男人在感受到喉咙处紧压着的重量之后，意识到了情况并非自己所想象的那样简单。
She presses down harder, jamming the shotgun into his throat.

“启明会”信众 II： 我知道，有一个和你的描述很相似的人——她 5 英尺 3 英寸，栗色头发，总爱挎个小篮子……甚至也叫做凯拉!
"Order" Follower II: I-I remember! There's a girl, 5 foot 3, chestnut hair. She's always carrying a basket. Her name's Kayla, too!

“启明会”信众 II： 但唯独有一点——她的眼睛不是翠绿色的，而是另、另外一种颜色……
"Order" Follower II: But her eyes ain't emerald green. They're ... They're ...

男人徒劳地张着嘴巴，他竭力从脑海中搜寻着那位名叫凯拉的少女。她的眼睛到底是什么颜色?
The man's mouth opens helplessly as he desperately tries to remember the color of the girl's eyes.

一个有关于颜色的词抵在舌尖，但他却无法吐出它——那个他应当记得，但却在此刻被遗忘的关键信息。
It's on the tip of his tongue, but he can't seem to spit it out—the crucial detail he should remember but has now forgotten.

阿尔古斯：继续说，你是怎么拿到这只发卡的——越详细越好。
Argus: Tell me how you got this hair clip—the more detailed, the better.

“启明会”信众 II：那只是一次很短暂的会面……那个姑娘遗失了她的发卡。发卡很漂亮，我想带给我自己的女儿……
"Order" Follower II: We just bumped into each other by chance. She dropped it on the road, and I thought my daughter would like it, so I ...

抛弃了关于颜色的思考，男人从善如流地说道。
Relieved to have moved on from the color, the man blabbers on obediently.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

她的食指紧扣扳机。
Her finger tightens on the trigger.

阿尔古斯：你还有最后一次机会。
Argus: I'll give you one last chance.

阿尔古斯：告诉我，你是在哪里遇见她的?
Argus: Where did you meet?

“启明会”信众 II：……
"Order" Follower II: ...

“启明会”信众 II：我在一个叫蓝手帕旅馆的地方遇见她的……
"Order" Follower II: At a place called Tuesday's Motel.

阿尔古斯：早说不就行了。
Argus: There you go. That wasn't so hard, was it?

她掂了掂手中的猎枪，用枪柄砸晕了眼前的男人。
She hefts the shotgun and knocks the man out with the butt.

阿尔古斯：废话真多。
Argus: Next time, just spit it out. Save us all some time.

“启明会”信众 I：……您、您是“基金会”的人吗?
"Order" Follower I: Are-Are you with the Foundation?

阿尔古斯：基金会?
Argus: The Foundation?

“启明会”信众 I：是、是的……他们很讨厌“基金会”……
"Order" Follower I: Yeah. They hate the Foundation, you see.

“启明会”信众 I：但是您救了我！老妈也会需要……
"Order" Follower I: But you saved me! I need some help. My mom ...

雇佣兵强硬地打断了他。
The mercenary cuts him off harshly.

阿尔古斯：我不认识你口中的“基金会”，也不想了解你们之间的矛盾，我还有其他要做的事。
Argus: I ain't never heard of no "Foundation," and I don't give a you-know-what about what's going on between you and them. Got my own matters to deal with.

阿尔古斯：他晕在了这里，枪也在这里——现在你能够给他一个结局了，不是吗?
Argus: I'll leave him with you. Keep the gun. You figure the rest out yourself.

稀薄的云遮住了将落未落的太阳，它看起来就像一个被搅碎的蛋黄。
A thin cloud obscures the setting sun, scattering its light.

她若有所思地望着远方的太阳。
She looks out into the horizon.

阿尔古斯：……告诉我，蓝手帕旅馆在哪?
Argus: Now, where's this motel?

年轻的追随者颤抖地指向更南方，那儿天幕昏黄，远处有着隐约可见的星光。红土地温驯地伏在低处；犁沟起伏，如绵延的脊梁。
The young follower points a trembling finger southward, where the stars have started to appear in the sky. The red lowlands lie still, their furrows rising and falling gently.

“启明会”信众 I： 等等！您救了我的命，我必须得告诉您，那座旅馆……
"Order" Follower I: Listen! You saved my life, so I owe you one. I have to warn you, that motel—

阿尔古斯：顺手而已，废话就不必再说了。
Argus: Save your breath. We're done here.

“启明会”信众 I： 不!
"Order" Follower I: Wait!

追随者急忙从口袋中翻出几张面额不大的美钞。
The follower hurriedly pulls out a few dollar bills from his pocket.

“启明会”信众 I： 看您的打扮，是一位雇佣兵？我……我很担心我的母亲，如果您在路上见到了我母亲的踪迹……
"Order" Follower I: You're a mercenary, right? I can tell by your gear. I'm, I'm worried about my mother. If you see her on the road, please give me a call.

他犹豫了片刻，从脖子上摘下了一枚金属吊坠。
He hesitates for a moment before taking off a metal locket from around his neck.

“启明会”信众 I： 我母亲长这个样子。
"Order" Follower I: Here's a photo of her.

雇佣兵接过了吊坠，照片中慈祥的妇人正对着她微笑。
The mercenary opens the locket to reveal an elderly woman with a kind smile.

阿尔古斯：我记住了。
Argus: Got it.

她将吊坠回递给了追随者。
She hands it back to the follower.

“启明会”信众 I： 还有……这是我的电话。
"Order" Follower I: And here. My phone number.

追随者在钞票的空白处写下了一串数字。
He writes a series of numbers on a blank section of one banknote.

“启明会”信众 I： 除此以外，我必须得告诉您，那个旅馆有异常……您要小心。
"Order" Follower I: And listen, be careful. Something ain't right about that motel.

阿尔古斯：好的。
Argus: Alright.

她收下了钱，将写着电话号码的纸条塞入兜中，转身离开了这个地方。
She takes the money, slips the dollar bill with the phone number into her pocket, and turns away.

德克萨斯·公路
Roadside, Texas

日照的余热散落在公路上，雇佣兵拎着那柄枪，重新回到了她的车旁。
The afternoon heat lingers on the highway. The mercenary makes her way back to her car, shotgun in hand.

在即将到达之时，她罕见地停下了脚步。
She comes to a sudden stop.

???: 一只羊，两只羊，三只羊……
???: One sheep, two sheep, three sheep ...

细弱的声音自远方传来，她隐约看到一团雪白的毛绒正围着那辆牧马人越野车打转。
A soft voice echoes from afar, and she notices a fluffy white figure circling around her car.

阿尔古斯: ……羊?
Argus: Is that a sheep?

雪白的毛绒赫然地转过了脸——那是一位羊首人身的神秘学家。
The fluffy creature turns its head. It's a sheep-headed, human-bodied arcanist.

???: 嗯，接下来是两只羊，三只羊……就像所有孩童初学数字那样，大部分人每天都需要重温睡眠这个课题。
???: Hm. Two sheep, three sheep ... Funny how we hit the hay every night, just like kids hit the books every day.

数羊羔: 很高兴见到您，我是数羊羔。
Barbara: I'm Barbara. Nice to meet you.

羊首人身的神秘学家伸出了一只手——这符合见面的礼节。
但她并没有得到期望的结果。
The sheep-headed arcanist extends a hand—a gesture befitting an introduction. But she doesn't get the expected response.

阿尔古斯: 让开，我得走了。
Argus: You're in my way, ma'am.

数羊羔: 挥手法、呼喊法、电话求援法……我尝试了很多方法来搭顺风车。
Barbara: I've tried waving and shouting at the drivers, but none of them stopped for me.

数羊羔: 现在尝试的是踱步法——它派上了用场，我很高兴。
Barbara: Thankfully, pacing around on the road seems to have done the trick!

阿尔古斯: ……
Argus: ...

阿尔古斯: 真啰嗦，如果你想搭车的话，我现在就可以回答你。
Argus: Listen. If you need a ride, here's my answer.

她关上了车门，望向窗外的搭车客。
She gets in, closes the door, and looks at the hitchhiker through the open window.

阿尔古斯: 不行。
Argus: No.

数羊羔: 原本的司机丢下我离开了。原因大概是在车行至中途的时候，车顶上传来了一些刮擦声——瞧，只是一些摩擦声就能把他吓成那样。
Barbara: My driver left me here. Probably because of that scraping sound on the car roof. That scared him half to death.

数羊羔: 一切异常都有其成因。所以，我觉得我来对了地方。
Barbara: Everything happens for a reason. Destiny's brought me to the right place, I think.

数羊羔：——您能载我一程吗？这是公务行程，价格好谈。
Barbara: Could you give me a ride? I'm on a business trip, so money is no object.

阿尔古斯：和钱没关系。
Argus: It ain't about money.

数羊羔：噢，令人失望的回答，但我完全理解——保持警惕是好事，小姐。不过……
Barbara: Oh, a disappointing answer, but I understand. One must be vigilant. If you don't mind me asking, Miss ...

数羊羔：您的眼睛为什么这样的红？我不建议您在这种情况下继续行驶，这容易导致危险的发生。
Barbara: What happened to your eyes? They're bloodshot. It's best not to drive with your eyes in such a state. You have a much higher chance of getting into an accident.

阿尔古斯：这也不是你该关心的事，羊羔小姐。
Argus: That ain't none of your concern, Miss Sheep.

阿尔古斯：再见。
Argus: See ya.

雇佣兵关闭了车窗，喋喋不休的噪音终于被中止了。
The mercenary closes the window, finally blocking out the endless chatter.

她转动钥匙，给车子打上了火。电台启动，喧嚷的迪斯科音乐在车内回荡，发出震耳欲聋的响声。
She turns the ignition key, and the radio bursts to life, blaring disco music inside the vehicle.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

她恶狠狠地关闭了音响，踩下了油门。
She shuts it off and stomps on the gas.

发动机震颤着，速度指针不断地攀升。而道路两旁花色的田野上，有牧人正呼唤着羊群。
The engine roars as the speedometer climbs higher and higher. In the fields on either side of the road, shepherds are herding their sheep.

一些回忆不合时宜地在眼前闪现。
Unwelcome memories begin to surface.

山脚的土地长满了印第安草，在临近秋天的时候，它的叶子会呈现出晚霞般的红色。
The land at the foot of the hills is covered in Indian grass, now turning a sunset red as autumn approaches.

凯拉：阿尔古斯，你看这只小羊羔……它险些死在了妈妈的肚子里。
Kayla: Argus, come over here. This little lamb almost didn't make it outta her mama's belly.

女孩用剪子割断了羔羊的脐带。母羊卧在草堆中，发出虚弱的呼唤。
The girl cuts the lamb's umbilical cord with a pair of scissors, while the ewe lies in the hay, baaing weakly.

阿尔古斯：那是它命不好。
Argus: That's life.

凯拉：别这样，没有什么东西是为了死去而降临在这个世界上的——阿尔古斯，你看，它站起来了。
Kayla: Don't say that. No living thing is born to suffer. Look, it's already standing.

母羊低垂着头颅，舔舐着湿润的胎衣，幼小的羊崽子勉力站稳了脚跟。
The ewe licks off the afterbirth as the lamb struggles to stand on its shaky legs.

凯拉：哈，多可爱的小羊。
Kayla: Hah. What an adorable little thing.

她欣喜地在围裙上擦拭着自己沾满了羊水与血迹的双手。
She grins as she wipes the blood and fluid from her hands onto her apron.

凯拉： 天要黑了，我们得带着它们回去——在母羊受伤的情况下，它们一定活不过今晚。
Kayla: It's getting dark. We should take them back. Ain't no way they'll make it through the night out here with their mama hurt.

凯拉： 更何况，天一黑，你的眼睛就什么都看不见了。
Kayla: And you can't see a thing at night.

阿尔古斯： ……好。
Argus: You're right. Let's go.

野地的风吹拂着那些遒劲的草叶，那声音随着风的行迹而愈发遥远。
The wind sweeps through the grass and rustles into the distance.

阿尔古斯： 该死的——
Argus: Screw it!

阿尔古斯咬了咬牙，将方向盘转到极限。
Argus grits her teeth and yanks the steering wheel, screeching her car into a U-turn.

她猛踩油门，以最短的时间回到了那个地方，那名形似小羊的神秘学家应该伫立着的地方。
She slams on the gas, rushing back to where the sheep-like arcanist was.

但路旁空空如也，只有几株棉桃正在随风摇曳。
But when she arrives, there's nothing but a few cotton plants swaying in the breeze.

阿尔古斯： ……他*的。
Argus: Should've minded my own damn business.

这是一次失败的尝试。她再次拧动方向盘，比上一次更急，橡胶轮胎发出了不受控制的哀嚎。
She turns the wheel again, harder this time. The tires screech as she makes another U-turn and drives off.

远方的太阳在此刻回归了群山的怀抱。
In the distance, the sun dips behind the hills.

阿尔古斯： ……
Argus: ...

视线正在逐渐变暗，她不抱希望地点亮了车灯。
Her vision is fading. She switches on the headlights.

然而，车灯的光线微弱。
它远不足以照亮因夜盲症而导致的黑暗。
As expected, the light is too dim to make up for her night blindness. She can hardly see a thing.

阿尔古斯： ——!
Argus: ...!

一脚刹车。
A hard brake.

“砰——”
bang

很遗憾，刺耳的脚刹声没能阻止一场车祸的发生。
Unfortunately, it's too late to stop the crash.

浓雾天
Fog Descends THH-02

维尔汀：在此之前，TTT 告诉了我一个关于德克萨斯的都市怪谈。
Vertin: Before we left, TTT was telling me an urban myth about Texas.

红弩箭：哦？说来听听。
Lilya: Hah. Sounds about right. What's the story about?

故事的开头设计得很典型。
The story starts off in the typical way.

一个疲惫的司机在德克萨斯的一条公路上开车，偶然遭遇了一个搭便车的女孩。
A man was driving down a long Texas road when he saw a girl hitch-hiking.

司机让她上了车，并请她吃了一块巧克力。
He offered her a lift and a piece of chocolate.

女孩在一处墓园下了车，司机继续朝前开——尽管是深夜，但他依然希望能够快些到达目的地。
The man dropped the girl off at a cemetery and drove on. It was late at night, so he was hoping to reach his destination quickly.

没过多久，马路上却出现了一支送葬的队伍。
Soon after, he saw a funeral procession going down the road.

那张遗照似曾相识。
The photo of the dead seemed familiar.

偶然迸发的好奇心驱使着他，于是他随着送葬队伍去了墓园。
Curiosity came over him, and he followed them to the cemetery.

看，是巧克力。
Look, a piece of chocolate.

一阵骤然的响声打断了她的叙述。
A sudden beeping interrupts her story.

维尔汀：稍等，是基金会的通讯。
Vertin: Give me a moment. I have to take this. It's from the Foundation.

打开通讯器之后，接待员冷淡的声音一如既往。
The voice on the other side is as calm as ever.

通讯器：司辰，我们接到了一则紧急通知——位于美国德克萨斯州的芝诺基地进行了大规模的撤离。
Communicator: Timekeeper, this is an emergency notice. The Zeno Base in Texas, USA, has conducted a large-scale evacuation.

通讯器：芝诺方目前尚未给出具体的理由。
Communicator: Zeno has not yet responded regarding their actions.

通讯器：如果您在旅途中遇到任何困难，请及时向总部汇报与寻求帮助。
Communicator: Should you encounter any difficulties on your trip there, please contact headquarters immediately.

维尔汀：明白了。
Vertin: Understood.

通讯器：那么，我再次与您确认一下此次的任务。
Communicator: Despite these developments, your mission remains the same.

通讯器：UTTU 的编辑数羊羔近日前往 77 号公路进行取材，基金会需要您尽快与这位编辑接洽，以获取兀尔德的下落——
Communicator: Contact UTTU editor Barbara, who was last seen near Route 77 collecting information, and find Urd's current whereabouts through her.

通讯器：UTTU 的编辑以特殊的通路传达讯息，基金会仍在调查中，若有进一步的进展，我们将及时与您联系。
Communicator: Since UTTU editors use a special communication channel, her current location is still unknown. We'll be in touch as soon as there's any new information.

通讯器：您还有别的疑问吗?
Communicator: Any questions, Timekeeper?

维尔汀：没有。
Vertin: No. Thank you.

通讯器：那么，祝您一切顺利。
Communicator: All the best, then.

通讯结束了，位于后座的飞行女巫若有所思。
The communication ends. Lilya looks thoughtful.

红弩箭：那群人给了什么新消息吗?
Lilya: What did they say?

维尔汀：在德克萨斯州的芝诺基地进行了大规模的撤离。
Vertin: There was a mass evacuation at the Zeno base in Texas.

红弩箭：啧——搞什么啊。
Lilya: Tsk. What's that all about?

红弩箭：前两天，那些芝诺高层刚告诉我——红色 38 还在德克萨斯的军备工厂进行检修。
Lilya: They called me two days ago, saying that Red 38 was still under routine maintenance in their armament factory.

红弩箭：结果今天就撤离了？见鬼，那我的红色 38 怎么办?
Lilya: But now, all of a sudden, they're gone? How am I going to get my Red 38 back now, huh?

红弩箭：如果没有这次例行检修，我们完全不用花这么多时间在路上……
Lilya: If they hadn't taken her away for inspection, we wouldn't be traveling in this little car, wasting all day on the road.

维尔汀：接线员说，这是一次大规模的撤离，也许他们还留有一些人手在维持工厂的正常运转。
Vertin: The operator only mentioned an evacuation. It's still possible that some of them have stayed behind to keep the factory running.

维尔汀：如果你担心这些，可以直接去军备工厂看看——它位于奇索斯镇，路途并不算太远。
Vertin: If you're worried about Red 38, we can take a detour there. It's in Chisos. The town isn't far from here.

飞行员蜷缩在座位之上，显然心情并不美妙。
Lilya squirms in her seat.

红弩箭：嘿，司机，能送我们到奇索斯镇吗？只是绕个圈，不远。
Lilya: Hey, mister, can you take us to the Chisos? It's just a little detour.

司机：嗯……
Driver: Hmm.

他的双手有节律地叩击着方向盘。
He taps his fingers rhythmically on the steering wheel.

司机：姑娘们，不管你们是什么心血来潮的探险小队，还是确有要务在身。我得提醒你们……那个镇子最近一直在发生怪事。
Driver: Girls, I don't know why y'all are here. But whether it's just for a bit of adventure or for business, I gotta tell you. Something ain't right in that town.

司机：像什么车顶上的摩擦声、“钩子”，或者卡在散热格栅上的动物尸体，甚至于身披黑袍的异教徒……这儿的异常已经够多了。
Driver: We've all heard the stories—scratching sounds on car roofs, animal bits stuck to car grilles, and those people in black robes running around. It's all too weird for me.

红弩箭：得了吧，那只是一些怪谈故事！
Lilya: Ah, give the ghost stories a rest.

红弩箭：你想谈价格，完全能用一个更聪明的方式来谈——而不是拿这些家喻户晓的故事来吓唬人，这太拙劣了。
Lilya: Look, if you're trying to negotiate a higher price, at least be a little smart about it instead of trying to spook us with a few tall tales.

司机：……你没理解我的意思，如果不是情势所迫，谁会放弃到手的美钞？
Driver: You got me all wrong. Who in their right mind would throw away the cash in their hand unless they were forced to?

司机：富兰克林的头像远没有命重要——给再多的钱也不干。
Driver: Benjamins are good and all, but they ain't worth my life. Ain't no way I'm taking you there, no matter how much cash you throw at me.

红弩箭：你就是故事里的那个司机？
Lilya: Why? Were you the driver in that ghost story?

司机：……不是。
Driver: N-No.

红弩箭：还是说，你亲眼看到了全程？
Lilya: Have you seen these things happen yourself?

司机：……
Driver: ...

红弩箭：只是绕个弯而已！又费不了多少油。
Lilya: Come on, it's just a little detour! It won't even cost you much fuel!

司机：……
Driver: ...

男人的双手紧握着方向盘，指节因用力而泛白。
He clenches his hands tightly around the steering wheel, his knuckles turning white from the pressure.

维尔汀：……先生？
Vertin: Sir?

司机：你们看见了吗？这儿……起雾了。
Driver: You see that? It's fogging up.

四周洋溢着白色的雾气，浓稠得如同乳汁。
Thick, milky fog envelopes the car.

车子在道路旁边停了下来。
The driver pulls over.

司机：这不是天然形成的雾气，我们不能再前进了，必须要停下来……
Driver: Ain't no way this fog is natural. We shouldn't go any further. I'm stopping right here.

红弩箭：咱们换个位置。
Lilya: Ugh, fine, I'll drive. Swap seats with me.

司机：不……绝不能在现在下车……
Driver: No. Nobody get out of the car.

红弩箭：为什么?
Lilya: Why?

司机：……该死的！难道你们从来没听过这儿的传说吗？那你们为什么要到这儿来找乐子?
Driver: Are you kidding me?! You haven't heard the stories, have you? Then what in the hell are you even doing here?!

司机：当雾气在 77 号公路翻涌时，一旦下车，就会发生异常的事件……有人说，雾气里有白色的巨型鳄鱼；有人说，远方的树上吊满了尸体。
Driver: When the fog rolls in on Route 77, you should always stay in the car. All kinds of terrible things hide in the fog. Some folks say they saw giant white crocodiles; others say they saw dead bodies hanging from trees.

司机：无论如何，我们应该在车里呆着……直到雾气消失。
Driver: Ain't nobody leaving this car. Not until the fog's gone.

哧啦——哧啦——
screech

车顶上的摩擦声让他立刻中止了述说。
He's interrupted by a drawn-out scraping sound on the roof of the car.

司机：……!
Driver: ...!

司机：等等，这就是、这就是——
Driver: Is that ... Is that ...?

红弩箭：嘿！别告诉我你被这些玩意吓破了胆——
Lilya: Oh, come on! Don't tell me you're scared of this stuff!

没有人回答她。
No response.

维尔汀：……他晕过去了。
Vertin: He's fainted.

狭窄而又安静的车内，诡异的气氛正在蔓延——不过，相较于不久前的绿湖营地来说，这算不了什么。
A strange atmosphere spreads inside the car as they sit and listen to the scraping on the roof. But this is nothing compared to what happened at Green Lake Campsite.

车顶上的摩擦声消失了，几个黑白相间的小身影在道路外一闪而过。
Finally, the scraping stops, and a few black-and-white figures dart past the windows.

维尔汀：原来是这样……你看，那个是穆姆[Mummu]，一种在美国南部极为常见的魔精。它们在受到惊吓时，会从头部的呼吸角产生一种形似于雾的气体。
Vertin: I see. This looks like the work of a Mummus. It's a critter commonly seen in the southern US. When they're frightened, they produce a fog-like gas from their respiratory trumpet.

红弩箭：……只是一些魔精在车顶上瘙痒而已。
Lilya: So that sound is just some critter scratching along on the roof.

飞行员不满地抱怨着，旋即打开了车门。
Lilya opens the door.

红弩箭：照这样下去，一个月都到不了目的地。
Lilya: At this rate, I won't get my Red 38 back for another month!

红弩箭：我老早就想试试——我们得先把这个家伙挪走！头儿，你得从副驾驶上下来了。
Lilya: Well, I've always wanted to try this. Help me move this guy! And you'll have to give up your passenger seat, Captain.

维尔汀：我明白你想做什么……但是，你有美国驾照，或者国际驾照吗?
Vertin: I know what you're thinking. But do you have a US driver's license? Or any driver's license at all, for that matter?

红弩箭：为什么开车一定要有驾照？我会驾驶飞行载具，还能用它们玩特技，这不比开车难多了?
Lilya: What do I need that for? I can fly a broom and even do all those maneuvers. That takes more skill than driving a car, don't you think?

红弩箭：哈，驾驶汽车只会比驾驶飞机更简单——你可以从飞行员和司机的数量对比上推知这一点。
Lilya: Ha, compared to flying, driving a car is child's play. Just look at the number of drivers compared to pilots in the world.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

按照飞行员的规划，位置得到了调整。
Following the pilot's plan, they adjust positions.

红弩箭：首先……
Lilya: Now, where do we start?

她望着眼前的仪表盘与操纵杆。
She glances at the dashboard in front of her.

这和 Su-01Be 内部结构不尽相似——没关系，小问题。
This doesn't look like the interior of an Su-01Be. A minor issue.

飞行员开始回忆。
She thinks back to her training.

红弩箭：开启双侧发动机，转速表稳定到 70%。
Lilya: Start both engines. Keep the tachometer at 70%.

红弩箭：前机轮转向锁、杆位指示器，推杆……噢，襟翼……
Lilya: Here's the nose wheel steering, the position indicator for the joystick, the throttle lever ... ah, and these are for the flaps.

红弩箭：不对——这是汽车！该死的!
Lilya: No, no! That's not right! We're in a car, not a flying machine!

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

“咔哒”。
click

后座的乘客沉默地系上了安全带。
The rear-seat passenger quietly fastens her seatbelt.

红弩箭：下车吧，头儿，我得承认我搞不定这铁家伙。
Lilya: Let's just get out, Captain. Can't wrap my head around this hunk of metal.

维尔汀：我非常赞同你的决定。
Vertin: Good decision.

红弩箭：既然这些雾气的源头是魔精，那也很简单，把它们驱逐出这儿就行了。
Lilya: If these critters are responsible for this fog, our solution is simple. We drive them away.

红弩箭：走吧。
Lilya: Let's go.

她伸手打开了车门，外部浓稠的雾气如潮水般扑入车内。
She opens the door, and the thick fog outside rushes in like a tide.

怪谈与旅行
Tales and Journeys 小径

《搭车客专栏》
The Hitchhiker's Column

简中
自上期专栏发出后，本刊收到了众多热心读者寄来的信函、磁带和传声工具。我必须承认“下水道的食人鱼”故事引起的共鸣广泛程度确实出乎了我的意料。一位匿名女士整理了 23 种她在环游世界时听到过的，有关城市下水道捕猎者的怪谈异闻版本，并询问何时才能就“变成野兔的乡野女巫”写一篇专栏文章。因为在她幼年时代，正是外祖母讲述的关于女巫们的滑稽故事（以及善意的恐吓）伴她入梦。

在此，我必须郑重地向这位读者表达谢意，这些资料为我的写作提供了极大的帮助，我将在不久后开始对这些童年故事的调查。变形类神秘术引起的怪谈是个有趣的题材，它的蛛丝马迹也许比我想象中的更加广泛。

那么，延续上期的话题，下水道中的怪异传说常与各种阴谋论联系在一起。一个例子：在纽约市的 K 先生寄与本刊的录音带中，他的一位亲戚非常肯定地宣称，政府秘密招募了一批专员，其职责是喂养那些生活在下水道中的白化鱼类。在之前的调查中，我曾听到一位青少年向我讲述他的惊险经历：他在下水道中曾与和人一样高、直立行走的爬行动物和啮齿动物擦肩而过。这段话常常出现在故事的结尾：“政府知道它们的存在，但是上面的人决定保密……”另一些更激进的猜测者认为，城市下水道很容易变成某种实验场，那些生活在下水道的食人鱼、鳄鱼、巨蟒或其他危险生物，都是政府或神秘组织为了某个目的在暗中培养。

……

在下期专栏中，我们会再次回到德州——本系列专栏开始的地方。在各位阅读本期专栏时，我应当已经踏上了新的旅途。也许我们会在德克萨斯尘土飞扬的公路边相遇。

English
Since our last column, we've been inundated with letters, tapes, and voice recordings from our passionate readers. I must say, the impact of the "Piranhas in the Sewers" story exceeded my expectations. One anonymous reader compiled 23 different urban sewer predator legends she picked up during her travels and asked when I was going to write about "The Country Witch Who Turned Into a Hare." She fondly recalled how her grandmother's amusing witch stories, tinged with a touch of gentle fright, would lull her to sleep as a child.

I'd like to extend my heartfelt thanks to this reader—these contributions are invaluable to my writing, and I'll soon delve into these childhood tales. Stories of mysterious transformative arcane skills are truly captivating, and their prevalence might be more widespread than I initially thought.

As we continue with the last issue's theme, sewer legends intertwine with conspiracy theories. For example, in a tape sent in by a Mr. K from New York City, a relative of his staunchly believes that the government secretly hired a team to feed albino fish living in the sewers. In previous

investigations, a teenager shared his thrilling experience—he encountered human-sized, upright-walking reptiles and rodents in the city sewers. These stories often end with the line, "The government knows they exist, but the higher-ups are keeping it all hush-hush ..." More radical speculators suggest that city sewers can easily be used as experimentation sites, with piranhas, alligators, giant snakes, and all manner of other dangerous creatures being secretly bred by the government or mysterious organizations for unknown purposes.

...

In our next column, we'll be returning to Texas—where this series began. As you read this, I'll most likely already have set off on a new adventure. Perhaps our paths will cross on the dusty roads of Texas.

婴儿电台
Baby Broadcaster THH-03

年轻的乘客们下了车，踩在了沥青的马路上。
They get out of the car and step onto the asphalt road.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

一丝微不可察的潮湿。乳白色的空气四处蔓延，充塞了鼻腔与耳道。
A barely perceptible moisture fills the air. The mist is pervasive, even filling their ears and nostrils.

若有似无的风黏在脸上，如同蜘蛛摇曳的丝网。
A faint breeze runs along their faces, like a spider's web blowing in the wind.

维尔汀：——！
Vertin: ...!

一点转瞬即逝的灵光，自遥不可及的远处延伸而来。
A flash of insight comes to her from some distant, unreachable place.

红弩箭：怎么了，头儿?
Lilya: What is it, Captain?

维尔汀：有人在使用神秘术。
Vertin: Someone's casting arcane skills nearby.

???：哇……
???: *baby cries*

婴儿的哭啼宛如虫蚁的咬噬，在耳道的深处隐隐作痛。
The crying of a baby throbs faintly in her ears like an insect bite.

维尔汀：你听到婴儿的哭声了吗?
Vertin: Do you hear that? Sounds like a crying baby.

红弩箭：走，去看看。
Lilya: Better go take a look.

静谧的旷野中，响起了急促的草叶摩擦声，仿佛有什么东西正在不远处快速地通行。
The grass is rustling, as if something is moving nearby.

红弩箭：出身于德克萨斯的士兵和我说过，在很多年前，他的故乡出现过一个臭名昭著的抢劫犯。
Lilya: You know, a Texan soldier once told me about a notorious bandit back in his hometown many years ago.

红弩箭： 他用磁带录下婴儿的声音，在单身母亲的门前播放。一旦有人因为怜悯而开门，立刻会招致不必要的灾祸。
Lilya: He would record the sound of a crying baby and play it outside the homes of single mothers. Then he'd wait, ready to attack them if any of them opened their door to look for the baby.

维尔汀： 不能因为这个事件而否定所有的求援。
Vertin: Yes, but the actions of one man don't negate all other calls for help.

红弩箭： 当然，我只是提醒——声源近在眼前，做好战斗的准备。
Lilya: Of course not. It's just a reminder to be ready for anything. We're close now. Prepare yourself.

维尔汀： 好，我明白。
Vertin: Got it.

草叶飘摇，细弱的哭声戛然而止，随之而来的是骤然加重的雾气。
The grass sways, and the faint crying stops. The fog grows thicker.

红弩箭： 不好——！
Lilya: Vertin, over here!

一个破损的手电筒卧在泥土上，伤痕崭新。
A broken flashlight lies on the ground. The damage looks recent.

不远处是一片灰蓝色的衣角和半截脚踝，其上沾满了新鲜而潮湿的泥土。
Not far away, they spot a foot in a black shoe, and a pale ankle disappearing under purple fabric.

侍应生： 噢……孩子们，帮帮我……
Maid: Ah. Hello. Please help.

瘦弱的女性紧紧地怀抱着一个襁褓，身体蜷成一小团，因受惊而轻颤着。
A frail woman tightly cradles a swaddled infant, her body curled up and trembling with fear.

维尔汀： 小姐，有什么可以帮助您的吗?
Vertin: Are you alright, Miss?

随着呼唤声，侍应生转过了头，面容苍白，毫无血色。
The maid turns her head. Her face is pale, as if all the blood has been drained from it.

侍应生： 终于有人来了……
Maid: Finally, someone ...

侍应生： 您能帮帮我吗……？这些魔精堵塞了道路，它们不肯让我离开……但凡我想挤出一条路，它们都会跳起来，狠狠撞在我的身上……
Maid: Please, help me. These critters won't let me leave. Every time I try, they knock me back.

侍应生： 你看，连孩子的肚子都饿了，止不住地哭。要不是你们，我真不知道该怎么办才好……
Maid: My baby's starving and crying. If you hadn't come, I really don't know what I would've done.

穆姆： 咕呜，咕呜——呜，呜……
Mummus: Cooumm, cooumm ... Urhm, urhm ...

黑白相间的魔精发出了警惕的叫声。
The critter makes a wary sound.

维尔汀： 穆姆……？我没有看见过以它为主角的袭击报告，这应该是一种温驯而胆小的魔精……
Vertin: You mean these Mummus? I've never read about them attacking anyone in any reports. In fact, they're known for being rather timid.

红弩箭： 头儿，报告并不能说明一切。
Lilya: Reports don't necessarily capture the whole story, Captain.

红弩箭： 你看看这些家伙，它们的眼里可没写着“温驯”两个字。
Lilya: Look at them. They don't seem very "timid" to me.

穆姆：咕——
Mummus: Coo ...

眼前的穆姆骤然地张大了嘴，露出口中白森森的牙齿。
The Mummus before them opens its mouth wide, revealing its sharp white teeth.

红弩箭：小心！它要进攻了！
Lilya: Careful! It's going to attack!

喧闹的家伙们四散着逃离了现场，草叶晃动，发出沙沙的响声。
The creatures scatter, the grass rustling as they flee.

侍应生：……噢，它们每次走得都是这样的快。
Maid: Ah. They always run off so quickly.

侍应生打扮的女性慢慢地从泥地里站起了身，拍去了衣角的尘土。
The woman pulls herself up off the ground and brushes the dirt from her skirt.

维尔汀：您还好吗?
Vertin: Are you alright?

侍应生：您也看到了，对吗？那种滑溜溜的小生物……和海豹长得太相似了。
Maid: Did you get a good look at them? Those slippery little things look like seals, don't they?

侍应生：它们总是喜欢踩着汽车的顶部，用扁平而宽大的后肢摩擦车顶，发出刺耳的刮擦声——
Maid: They always jump on passing cars and rub their flat hind legs on the roof, making that coarse scraping sound.

侍应生：多惊人呀，它们也懂得恐惧的好处呢。
Maid: Amazing creatures, aren't they? These little fearmongers.

风吹过原野，雾气渐消，她的面孔潮红，身形随之微微晃动着。
Wind sweeps across the plains, dispersing the fog. The woman's face flushes red as she sways lightly in the breeze.

侍应生：可惜，它们胆子太小，一有动静就要害怕……所以，这儿的雾气从来没有散过，客人也总找不到路。
Maid: But they are, in fact, easily frightened; the slightest movement could startle them. That's why it's foggy all year around here. Many of my guests have trouble finding their way to the motel.

侍应生：……姑娘们，你们是旅店的客人吗?
Maid: Are you ladies looking to check in at the motel?

红弩箭：旅店?
Lilya: Motel?

侍应生：那是一个叫“蓝手帕旅馆”的地方，如果您正感到疲累，去那儿就能好好地睡上一觉……
Maid: Yes, Tuesday's Motel. If you're looking for a comfortable bed for the night, it's the place to go.

侍应生：总之，姑娘们，我得好好谢谢你们……
Maid: Anyway, thank you so much for saving us. I owe you one.

她拍了拍怀中的襁褓。
She pats the swaddled baby.

维尔汀：……您是旅馆的侍应生吗?
Vertin: Excuse me, are you the maid at Tuesday's Motel?

蓝手帕：噢……险些忘了介绍自己，您也可以叫我蓝手帕——人们常常这么叫我，多亲切的名字。
Tuesday: Ah, I almost forgot to introduce myself. Folks around here call me Tuesday.

蓝手帕：嘿，蓝手帕，到这儿来。嘿，蓝手帕，送一份早餐……蓝手帕，蓝手帕，名字就像是一根缰绳，拴在每个人的脖颈儿上。
Tuesday: "Hey, Tuesday, over here. Hey, Tuesday! Breakfast for one, please. Tuesday, Tuesday ..." Ain't we all like horses, and our names like the reins pulling at us?

她打量着两位风尘仆仆的客人。
She looks the two of them over.

蓝手帕：你们需要暂时地歇歇脚吗？姑娘们。
Tuesday: Do you need a place to stay, ladies?

维尔汀：……谢谢你的好意。
Vertin: Thank you for your kindness.

维尔汀：——我们的司机还在车内，我们不能把他一个人丢在那儿。
Vertin: But our driver's still in the car. We can't just leave him there.

红弩箭：证件和行李也都在车里，还有所有的现金——既然雾已经散了，那就赶紧走吧。
Lilya: And our luggage and travel documents are still in the trunk, along with our cash, too. Let's head back now that the fog has cleared.

蓝手帕：需要我为你们引路吗?
Tuesday: Shall I lead the way?

红弩箭：你?
Lilya: You?

飞行员怀疑地打量着眼前的侍应生。
She looks the maid up and down suspiciously.

红弩箭：你不用做别的事吗?
Lilya: What were you doing out here alone, anyway?

蓝手帕：……
Tuesday: ...

蓝手帕：我……在这儿等了两个小时了，预定的客人却迟迟未来。
Tuesday: I-I was waiting for a guest. It's been two hours, and they still haven't shown up.

蓝手帕：我想，与其在这儿继续等候……不如做一些力所能及的好事。
Tuesday: I thought, rather than waiting here, I would pay you back for helping me.

蓝手帕：姑娘们，你们的车是停靠在 77 号公路的附近吗？让我带你们过去吧。
Tuesday: I assume you parked near Route 77? Let me take you there.

西垂的太阳散发着热力，红土地上的山茱萸与棉桃杂糅地生长于一处。
The setting sun scatters its light, illuminating the dogwood and cotton plants in the fields.

红弩箭：……这胆小的家伙。
Lilya: That coward!

公路边空荡荡的——先前停靠的车辆已不知所踪，路边只留下了少量的行李。
The car is gone. Nothing remains but a few scattered pieces of luggage.

红弩箭：——他把我们的行李丢了下来，自己逃得连影子都不见。
Lilya: He just threw out our luggage and took off! Tsk, how pathetic.

维尔汀：……往好处想，至少他没有侵吞我们的财产。
Vertin: At least he didn't take the luggage with him.

蓝手帕：嗯……所以，您要拎着这些行李，在公路上等下一辆顺风车吗……?
Tuesday: Mmm. Are you going to thumb a ride with all these bags?

蓝手帕：我不会建议你们这么做，尤其是在这儿——您至少应该看过一些公路片，对吗？那就应该知道公路并不是一个安全的地方。
Tuesday: I'd advise against that, especially here. You've seen those movies, right? Bad things can happen on the road out here.

蓝手帕：除此以外，还有许多偷渡客来到了这里……
Tuesday: There are a lot of smugglers around these days.

她声音中的担忧显而易见。
There's a clear concern in her voice.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

维尔汀：您的旅馆就在附近，对吗？
Vertin: Did you say your motel wasn't far from here?

蓝手帕：当然，请往这儿走——这里有一条易于行走的小径，别让泥土沾上了你们的鞋子。
Tuesday: Yes. Come this way. There's an easy trail that won't dirty your shoes.

蓝手帕：不用担心，路途并不遥远。
Tuesday: Don't worry. It ain't far.

蓝手帕旅馆·外围
Entrance, Tuesday's Motel

步行的时间并不算长。脚腕还未察觉到疲累，就已经看见了不远处的汽车旅馆。
The walk isn't far, indeed. Before long, they're standing in front of the motel.

蓝手帕：等到天色暗去，悬置的灯牌将会被点亮，每一个迷途的旅人都能得到柔软的床榻。
Tuesday: When night falls and the signs are lit, a weary traveler may find a comfortable place to rest here.

楝树的掩映下，木制门廊于黄昏中静候着它的主人。
Under the shade of the neem trees, the wooden porch awaits its owner, darkening in the fading sunlight.

蓝手帕：孩子们，欢迎来到蓝手帕旅馆。
Tuesday: Welcome to Tuesday's Motel, ladies.

红勋章
Medal of Honor THH-04

蓝手帕旅馆·前台
Front Desk, Tuesday's Motel

旅馆前台，侍应生正为客人们办理入住手续。
The maid stands behind the front desk in the motel lobby. She's checking in her new guests.

蓝手帕：您的房费共计 25 美金……信用卡还是现金？
Tuesday: That'll be 25 dollars altogether. Will that be on card or cash?

维尔汀：现金。
Vertin: Cash, please.

侍应生拿起护照比对着上方的信息。
The maid holds up the passport, comparing the information on it.

红弩箭：嘿，侍应生，附近的小镇上是不是有一个军备工厂？
Lilya: Hey, do you know if there's an armament factory in the town nearby?

蓝手帕：军备工厂？
Tuesday: An armament factory?

她打量着红弩箭的装扮，微笑着作出了回应。
She studies Lilya's outfit and smiles as she responds.

蓝手帕：是的，就在附近……我想，也许您需要一份地图。
Tuesday: Yes, there is one. Would you like a map?

她打开抽屉，摸出了一份地图，交至了飞行员的手中。
She opens a drawer, pulls out a map, and hands it to her.

蓝手帕：如果您要去，请务必早些回来，夜里的路会很难走。
Tuesday: If you plan on visiting, make sure to return early. It can be a difficult walk in the dark.

飞行员很快在地图上找到了那个被命名为“奇索斯”的镇子。
Lilya quickly finds the town labeled "Chisos" on the map.

红弩箭：看起来不远。
Lilya: Doesn't seem far from here.

蓝手帕：这儿离镇子有将近一小时的步行路程，我会建议您等到明天早晨再出发。
Tuesday: It's about an hour's walk. I'd recommend leaving tomorrow morning.

蓝手帕：天已经快黑了，而走夜路总归不是一件好事。
Tuesday: It's getting late. It's best not to be outside at night.

红弩箭：多谢你的好心提醒……不过，我现在就得走了。
Lilya: Thanks, but I'm going right now.

飞行员一扫平日的懒散，展现出了绝佳的行动力。
She moves with swift purpose to the front door.

红弩箭：只要红色 38 在我的身边，所有的事情都会顺利起来！
Lilya: Nothing can go wrong as long as I have the Red 38 by my side.

维尔汀：如果有意外，及时联系我。
Vertin: Call me if anything happens.

红弩箭：意外？哈，我会把罪魁祸首的头拧下来。
Lilya: Like what? I can handle myself.

平地刮起了一阵骤风，飞行员冲出了旅馆的大门。
A rush of wind enters as Lilya opens the door and makes her way out of the motel.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

维尔汀：我想，她应该会在稍晚些时候再入住。
Vertin: Don't worry. She'll check in later.

蓝手帕：这是您的护照，请收好。
Tuesday: Here's your passport.

维尔汀：您一直在这儿当侍应生吗？
Vertin: Have you been working here since the opening of this place?

蓝手帕：嗯。
Tuesday: Yes.

维尔汀：这儿的生意好吗？
Vertin: How's business?

侍应生轻轻地笑了。
The maid laughs softly.

蓝手帕：现在正是淡季，生意并不怎么好。
Tuesday: Not too great. It's the off-season now.

蓝手帕：您不怎么擅长寒暄，是有什么想问的吗?
Tuesday: You don't seem too good at small talk. Is there anything you'd like to ask?

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

维尔汀：实际上，我想询问您一个问题。
Vertin: I do have one question.

维尔汀：您见过一位羊首人身的神秘学家吗?
Vertin: Have you seen a sheep-headed arcanist around?

她展示了基金会给予的资料。
She shows the information provided by the Foundation.

蓝手帕：噢……很有趣。我想，任何人见过这位小家伙，都会印象深刻的。
Tuesday: Ah, that's not a face you'd easily forget.

蓝手帕：您是为什么要找她呢?
Tuesday: And why are you looking for this arcanist?

选项 / Choices

1. 为了世界和平
1. For world peace.

2. 寻找 UTTU 的编辑
2. Looking for an editor of UTTU.

分支 / Branch 1

蓝手帕：世界和平……?
Tuesday: World peace?

侍应生略带惊讶地眨巴着眼睛，随后笑出了声。
The maid blinks in surprise, then laughs.

蓝手帕：嗯……这是一个难以拒绝、可爱的理由。
Tuesday: Well, that makes this request simply too adorable to turn down.

分支 / Branch 2

蓝手帕：《UTTU》……这个名字很亲切，我想我应该在哪里听过。
Tuesday: UTTU ... I think I've heard of that before.

蓝手帕：是那本针对神秘学家发行的杂志，对吗?
Tuesday: That's a magazine specially made for arcanists, right?

共同接续 / Shared continuation

蓝手帕：不过，实在很可惜……我没有见过她。
Tuesday: Well, I'm sorry to say that I've never met an arcanist with the head of a sheep.

蓝手帕：如果您需要的话，我可以帮您问问附近的农户……
Tuesday: I can help you ask around if you—

她正要说得更多，天花板却开始颤动，扑簌簌地抖下灰尘。
Suddenly, the ceiling starts to tremble.

神秘术的涌动从头顶上传来。
A surge of arcane energy comes from above.

维尔汀： 这是……
Vertin: What's ...

蓝手帕： 抱歉，我想是有了一些突发的状况。
Tuesday: Sounds like something's gone wrong upstairs. Sorry about that.

蓝手帕： 您的房间也在二楼，我先带您过去吧。或许可以一起看看楼上到底发生了什么。
Tuesday: Let's head up. Your room's on the second floor, too. Then we can take a look at what's happened.

维尔汀： 好。
Vertin: Sounds good.

蓝手帕： 不过，楼上的客人……
Tuesday: Just so you know, the guests upstairs are a little ...

侍应生欲言又止。
The maid hesitates.

蓝手帕： 总之，如果您感到害怕，可以躲在我的身后。
Tuesday: Well, you can stay behind me if you like.

蓝手帕旅馆·走廊
Hallway, Tuesday's Motel

阿尔古斯： 这个提议怎么样?
Argus: How about it?

走廊的远处传来了交谈的声音。
A voice echoes from down the hall.

阿尔古斯： 只是交换房间而已，更何况您还是这样一位慷慨的小姐。
Argus: It's just a simple room swap. I'm sure it won't be no trouble at all for a generous lady such as yourself.

蓝手帕： 那位是 210 房间的客人，她是在前天夜里到这儿的。
Tuesday: That's the guest staying in room 210. She arrived here the night before yesterday.

蓝手帕： 她刚来到这儿的时候受了伤，没想到现在就恢复得差不多了。
Tuesday: She was injured when she came in. Seems it didn't take her long to recover.

蓝手帕： 噢，但我不知道为什么……她一直执着于与别人交换房间——如果您感到无法应付，请及时给前台打电话，我总会为您提供帮助的……
Tuesday: But I don't quite understand why she insists on swapping rooms with the other guests. If she does the same to you, please call the front desk. I'll do my best to help.

维尔汀： 也许她比我更需要帮助——你不去问问她为什么要做这些事吗?
Vertin: Why don't you offer her your help? She needs it more than I do.

蓝手帕： 噢……您果然还是一个孩子。
Tuesday: Oh, things don't work like that here, Miss.

蓝手帕： 每个人都有自己的秘密，更何况这儿是汽车旅馆。如果人闭不上自己的嘴巴，自然会有别人替他闭上。
Tuesday: Everyone has their own secrets. With the variety of guests we get, it's best to keep your mouth shut, or else somebody will shut it for you.

蓝手帕： 虽然现在已经不是赏金猎人横行的时代了……但需要提醒您的是，如果不想以身涉险，最好能够保持安静……
Tuesday: Although there are fewer bounty hunters around these days, my advice is to stay quiet if you don't want any trouble.

蓝手帕： 尤其是面对一位带着猎枪的雇佣兵……噢，您应该知道这在德州意味着什么，对吧?
Tuesday: Especially if you're dealing with an armed mercenary. You know how things like that play out down here in Texas, don't you?

维尔汀： ……我明白。
Vertin: Understood.

不远处的对话还在继续。
The voice down the hall continues.

阿尔古斯： 还是说，你有什么别的条件?
Argus: Or do you have something else in mind?

女房客： 你的房间会更大、更好吗?
Female Guest: Is your room bigger and better than this one?

一个更雀跃的声音出现了。
A more lively voice chimes in.

蓝手帕： 这位是 218 房间的客人——另一位年轻的小姐。
Tuesday: That's the guest of room 218 speaking. She too is a young lady like you.

维尔汀： 你能记住所有人的房间号?
Vertin: You remember all the guests and their room numbers?

蓝手帕： 如果有一位客人在您的旅馆里住了一个月，我相信您也能记住她的名字——这位金伯利女郎就是这样的状况。
Tuesday: You'd remember her too if she'd been staying in your motel for a month. Ms. Kimberly's been here for just over that.

史蒂文： 我……
Stefen: I ...

蓝手帕： ……咦?
Tuesday: Hm?

侍应生发出了诧异的声音，快步地走向了声音的发源地。
The maid quickly moves toward the source of the voice.

眼前的男人面孔憔悴，他的脊背略弓着，眼睛泛黄且浑浊。
The man before her looks haggard, his back slightly hunched, his eyes yellowed and cloudy.

史蒂文： 镜子……镜子……
Stefen: Mirror ... The mirror ...

蓝手帕： 史蒂文先生，您……怎么出来了?
Tuesday: Mr. Stefen, are you coming out for some fresh air?

走廊中的人齐齐地望向了他们。
Everyone in the hallway turns to look at the maid.

阿尔古斯： 侍应生? 你来得正好。
Argus: Maid! You're just in time.

阿尔古斯： 我想和这位……嗯，金伯利女郎换一个房间。
Argus: I'd like to swap rooms with this Kimberly lady.

蓝手帕：噢，如果你们达成了一致，我当然没有反对的理由……
Tuesday: If Ms. Kimberly and yourself have come to an agreement, then I see no reason why you can't do so.

史蒂文：啊……
Stefen: Ah.

男人沉默已久的喉咙发出了干涩的声音，他的声带不自然地震颤着，如同初次学语的婴儿。
The man makes a dry, rasping sound, his vocal cords trembling unnaturally. It's like he's speaking for the first time in his life.

史蒂文：司辰?
Stefen: Timekeeper?

维尔汀：……您是?
Vertin: Have we met?

这个回答似乎点燃了男人某根异常的神经，他的表情在一瞬间变得扭曲。
This response seems to trigger something. His expression twists.

史蒂文：维尔汀……?
Stefen: Vertin?

维尔汀：是我，先生……?
Vertin: That's me. Do I know you, sir?

史蒂文：我看到过你……在那份报纸上……
Stefen: I saw you—in the newspaper.

史蒂文：哦……报纸，那颗爆炸的真空弹——您看见了吗？您一定看见了，因为那正是你一手促成的！你们扔下了那颗炸弹，是毋庸置疑的刽子手……
Stefen: Arh, the newspaper, that vacuum bomb—did you see the explosion? You must have, because you made it happen! You dropped the bomb! You murderers!

史蒂文：但是你们因此受到审判了吗……？完全没有！你们甚至因为这个而收到了表彰，所有人都在那一刻为您发来贺电……
Stefen: But have any of you been brought to justice? No, not a single one! Instead, you were congratulated and given medals.

史蒂文：这个颠倒的世界啊……我想问，人怎么能够因为杀人而被表彰呢?
Stefen: Revolting! Disgusting! Why were you rewarded for murder?!

他神经质地呢喃着。
He blabbers on, working himself into a frenzy.

史蒂文：而我就要待在这个小小的旅馆里……主啊，难道我的人生仅止于此吗?
Stefen: Meanwhile, I'm stuck in this hotel. Lord, is this what my life has come to?

维尔汀：可是我从来没有见过你，先生。在这之前我甚至不知道您的名字。
Vertin: But we've never met before. I don't even know your name, sir.

史蒂文：你当然不会见过我……因为我将会把你们的罪行公之于众……
Stefen: Of course you don't know me. But I'll get the truth out. I'll expose your crimes to the public!

近似疯癫的男人喋喋不休地说着，他的指关节因用力而泛出白色。
The man's deranged rant continues, his knuckles turning white as he clenches his fists.

史蒂文：浴缸里腐烂的女人，羊头人身的怪物……还有镜子里的……
Stefen: That rotting woman in the tub, that sheep-headed monster, and that one inside the mirror.

维尔汀：羊头人身……?
Vertin: Sheep-headed, you say?

维尔汀： 等等，先生——
Vertin: Wait! Sir—

阿尔古斯： 嘘，他已经疯了。
Argus: Shh. Don't startle him. He's totally crazy.

史蒂文： 我早该知道一切都是假的！
Stefen: I should've known it was all fake!

史蒂文： 如果杀人就能获得勋章……
Stefen: If they're giving out medals for killing people ...

史蒂文： 哦……我也应该拥有那一枚亮闪闪的勋章啊——那本来就是我的！
Stefen: Ah, then I should have one, too. That shiny medal—it should be mine!

他紧咬着嘴唇，那双浑浊的眼睛如同钩子，直愣愣地望向前方。
He bites down hard on his lip, his cloudy eyes staring straight ahead.

男人试探性地向前踏出了一步。
He steps forward.

阿尔古斯： 退后！
Argus: Stay back!

未等雇佣兵的话音落下，那精瘦的男人赫然扑向了众人。
But the man has already lunged at them.

失去理智的男人被一枪托打晕在了地上。
A single blow from the butt of the mercenary's shotgun knocks the man out.

蓝手帕： ……
Tuesday: ...

侍应生急促地呼吸着，她的面孔微微发热。
The maid breathes heavily, her face slightly flushed.

蓝手帕： 抱歉……维尔汀小姐。
Tuesday: I'm ever so sorry about all this, Ms. Vertin.

蓝手帕： 您刚来不久，就让您卷入了这么大的麻烦……
Tuesday: You've only just arrived, and you've had to deal with so much trouble already.

维尔汀： 我不认为这是麻烦……甚至我需要感谢您。
Vertin: Oh, it's no trouble. In fact, I'm glad that we came here.

维尔汀： 他说，他见过一个“羊头人身的怪物”……
Vertin: That man said he'd seen a "sheep-headed monster."

蓝手帕： ……噢，但我不得不提醒您一句，您真的要相信一个癔病患者的话语吗?
Tuesday: Oh, that ... He's quite delusional. Surely you won't take the ramblings of a madman for a fact, will you?

蓝手帕： 自他入住旅馆的那一天起，就出现了诸如漫游、痉挛、抽搐的症状……
Tuesday: He's been peculiar since the day he checked in. He spasms and twitches and pays little attention to his surroundings.

蓝手帕： 我并不建议您与他见面或交谈……因为谁也不知道他下一刻会爆发出什么样的行动。
Tuesday: It's best not to have a face-to-face conversation with him. Who knows what he'll do next.

金伯利女郎： 嘿，侍应生，别光顾着聊天了！你得处理你的工作。
Ms. Kimberly: Hey, you, maid! Enough chatter. You have a job to do.

一边的女郎迫不及待地打断了对话。
The girl impatiently interrupts their conversation.

金伯利女郎： 我与这位，呃……阿尔古斯小姐，要交换房间。你知道该怎么做，对吗?
Ms. Kimberly: I've accepted the offer this, uh, Ms. Argus made. What's next? What should we do?

蓝手帕： ……抱歉，金伯利女郎。
Tuesday: Apologies, Ms. Kimberly. I'll be with you in a moment.

蓝手帕： 不过，在此之前，请二位移步至前台吧……再漂亮的房间，也要收拾之后才能住人。您需要稍等一会儿，在此期间，您可以在前台的椅子上休憩。
Tuesday: Could the both of you wait for me at the front desk? The rooms need a tidy-up before they can be occupied. You may take a rest on the couch in the lobby while you wait.

蓝手帕： 至于这位维尔汀小姐……非常抱歉，您能够独自前往您的房间吗?
Tuesday: Ms. Vertin, I'm afraid I'll have to leave you here. Do you mind going to your room alone?

维尔汀： 好。
Vertin: Not at all.

手提箱随着步履的节奏而微微晃动着，将人们抛在身后。
The suitcase sways with her steps as she heads to her room.

空气中再次传来了神秘术的涌动，令人不自觉地回头望去。
Once again, the air pulses with the flow of arcane energy, compelling her to look back.

阿尔古斯： 不——我不需要，侍应生。不如说，你对房间的清理只会干扰我的工作。
Argus: Ma'am, you can just leave the room as it is. If you clean it, it'll interfere with my work.

阿尔古斯： 去照看那位金伯利女郎吧……她看起来饿得厉害，连身体都在打颤。
Argus: You might wanna check on that Kimberly lady. She looks starved. She wouldn't stop shaking.

雇佣兵的眼中绽放了一簇蓝绿色的光芒，辉光四散，如同鸟类正在舒展它们绚丽的尾羽。
A cluster of emerald light sparks in the mercenary's left eye, scattering like a bird unfurling its brilliant tail feathers.

蓝手帕： 噢……金伯利女郎，您需要送餐服务吗?
Tuesday: Oh, Ms. Kimberly. Would you like something to eat?

金伯利女郎： 不需要!
Ms. Kimberly: I'm fine!

女房客的脸色肉眼可见地变得不友善。
The guest's face visibly sours.

金伯利女郎： 我同意了你的要求——你怎么还能这样嘲讽我?
Ms. Kimberly: I agreed to change rooms, didn't I? Why are you two still mocking me?

女郎如同一只被触发了防御机制的刺猬，恼火地望向了雇佣兵。
She turns her attention to the mercenary.

金伯利女郎： 你是一个彻头彻尾的讨厌鬼！我讨厌和你做交易。
Ms. Kimberly: You're not exactly a pleasant person to do business with; you know that, right?

阿尔古斯： 哦，我不知道我在哪里冒犯了你。
Argus: Well, darn, what got you so riled up?

阿尔古斯： 但已经晚了，就好像在合同上签下字以后，一切条款都会开始生效——您当然也可以反悔。但你最好不要在德克萨斯招惹一个带枪的人，这是不明智的。
Argus: It's too late now. A deal's a deal. You can backpedal if you like, but it ain't wise to mess with a girl packing heat down here in Texas.

阿尔古斯： 再见了，金伯利女郎。
Argus: Later, Ms. Kimberly.

雇佣兵的眼中辉光流溢。随后她拧开了门锁，进入了那个她渴望已久的房间。
The mercenary's eye gleams as she turns the lock and enters her hard-won room.

维尔汀： ——是她在使用神秘术。
Vertin: Her arcane skill.

临时通讯
A Sudden Message THH-05

蓝手帕旅馆·207 房
Room 207, Tuesday's Motel

年久失修的房门被推开，空气中散发着地板蜡的清香。
The door creaks as she opens it, and her nostrils are hit with the distinct scent of floor wax.

摁下开关，在短暂的电流声后，房间里的灯亮了起来。
She flips the switch, and after a brief hum of electricity, the room lights up.

维尔汀： 这个名叫史蒂文的住客，他很显然知道些什么。但……他的癔病看上去很严重，并且对我抱有敌意……
Vertin: That man, Stefen. He clearly knows something. But he appears to be rather mentally unstable, and he's hostile towards me.

维尔汀： Z 女士曾经告诉过我，遇到这种不稳定的对象，需要特别注意沟通的方式、技巧，以及……准备好突发情况的兜底保障。
Vertin: Madam Z cautioned me on this. I must be extra careful when dealing with people like him. Should make sure I have a backup plan in place before proceeding.

维尔汀： 而现在，红弩箭还不在这儿……
Vertin: Still no sign of Lilya.

思及此，她使用通讯设备联络了飞行女巫。不久之后，彼端传来了通讯失败的忙音。
She tries contacting her on her communication device, but the line is busy.

维尔汀： ……
Vertin: ...

她继续了通讯的尝试，结果并无意外。
She tries again, but still no luck.

维尔汀： 她是不是遇到了什么麻烦……?
Vertin: Did she get in trouble?

房间里忽然响起了尖锐的电话声。
钴绿色的电话座机正剧烈地震动着。
Suddenly, the phone on the nightstand rings. It vibrates violently.

维尔汀： 您好?
Vertin: Hello?

电话： 哒，哒，哒，哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap, tap, tap*

维尔汀： ……您好?
Vertin: Hello?!

电话的彼端响起了意义不明的叩击声。
A series of strange tapping sounds comes from the other end of the line.

维尔汀：请问，是蓝手帕小姐吗?
Vertin: Erm, is that Ms. Tuesday?

电话：哒。
Telephone: *tap*

电话：哒，哒——哒，哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap—tap, tap*

电话：哒，哒——哒——哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap—tap—tap*

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

明晰的短音与长音，以一定的节奏交织着。
The short and long sounds are distinct. They form a certain rhythm.

维尔汀：我想，我知道这是什么了。
Vertin: Oh, I think I know what this is.

电话：哒，哒——哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap—tap*

维尔汀：R。
Vertin: That's an R.

电话：哒。
Telephone: *tap*

维尔汀：E。
Vertin: E.

电话：哒，哒，哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap, tap*

维尔汀：S。
Vertin: S.

电话：哒，哒——哒——哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap—tap—tap*

维尔汀：P。
Vertin: P.

电话：哒——哒——哒——
Telephone: *tap—tap—tap—*

维尔汀：O。
Vertin: O.

电话被急促地挂断了。
——但这无碍于思维的补全。
The phone is abruptly hung up. But it doesn't matter. The thoughts are complete.

RESPOND
RESPOND

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

一份由摩斯电码传达的密电。
A message conveyed through Morse code.

这是一种为了安全而舍弃效率的信息传达方式，常用于情报的传递，在日常生活中极为少见。
A means of communication that sacrifices efficiency for safety. It's commonly used in intelligence, but rarely for anything else.

在一个汽车旅馆中，为什么会出现这样的信息?
Why would there be such a message in a motel?

电话： 叮铃铃铃铃——
Telephone: *ring-ring-ring—*

铃声再次响起，电话被不假思索地接起。
The telephone rings again. She picks it up without hesitation.

蓝手帕： 您好，是维尔汀小姐吗?
Tuesday: Hello, is this Ms. Vertin?

维尔汀： ……蓝手帕小姐?
Vertin: Ms. Tuesday?

蓝手帕： 噢，我需要告知您一则通知。
Tuesday: Yes. I have an announcement for you.

蓝手帕： 附近信号塔的电线遭到了魔精的啃噬，需要进行检修——这会导致通讯上的不便。但旅馆的内线电话始终是接通的。
Tuesday: There's a service outage going on in the area. Some critters nibbled through the cables of a nearby signal tower. But all our internal phone lines are still running well.

维尔汀： 我明白了。
Vertin: I see.

蓝手帕： 我想，很快就会检修完毕……毕竟附近那个军备工厂也与旅馆同用一个信号塔——无论如何，对您造成的困扰，我深表歉意。
Tuesday: It should be repaired soon, since we share the signal tower with that armament factory. I apologize for any inconvenience this may cause.

蓝手帕： 在不久之后，我会为您送上一份晚餐……不必担心费用问题，这是一份完全的馈赠。
Tuesday: I'll bring your dinner up later. It's on the house.

选项 / Choices

1. 询问诡异的电话
1. Ask about the strange phone call.

2. 询问晚餐的种类
2. Ask about dinner.

分支 / Branch 1

维尔汀： 事实上，我刚刚接到了一个来源不明的电话……
Vertin: There's something I want to ask you. I received a phone call earlier.

蓝手帕： 噢……不久前，我也收到过金伯利女郎关于电话的投诉。
Tuesday: Oh, Ms. Kimberly was also prank-called not long ago.

蓝手帕： 请您无需担心，我想这也是魔精们的捣乱——您也知道，它们总是很调皮，就像一群猴子，有适量的智力用于捉弄他人。
Tuesday: I suppose it's a critter's doing—you know how mischievous they can be, and since they have decent smarts, they can play some pretty nasty tricks.

也许理论上会存在猴子在打字机上撰写莎士比亚全集的概率，但这会在现实世界中出现吗?
In theory, a group of monkeys could write Shakespeare's complete works on a typewriter if given the time. But would this happen in reality?

维尔汀: 我认为这不是巧合。
Vertin: I don't think that's what made the phone call.

蓝手帕: 噢，维尔汀小姐，但这就是我眼见的现实……
Tuesday: Mm, well, Ms. Vertin, this is what I understand to be the truth.

分支 / Branch 2

维尔汀: 有什么样的餐点?
Vertin: May I ask what's on the menu?

蓝手帕: 噢……我们这儿有每天一顿的免费餐点，是火腿三明治和一杯牛奶。
Tuesday: We have one free meal a day—a ham sandwich and a glass of milk.

蓝手帕: 如果您有别的需求，我们这儿也能做烤鸡或是鹰嘴豆泥……或者是一些简单的墨西哥菜。
Tuesday: If you'd like to have something else, we've also got roast chicken and hummus and a few simple Mexican dishes.

维尔汀: 谢谢，等我的同伴回来之后，我会问问她想吃些什么。
Vertin: Thank you. I'll ask my friend what she thinks when she comes back.

蓝手帕: 噢，还有一点需要提醒您，我们在 9 点之后就不会再供应餐点了。
Tuesday: Oh, and the kitchen closes at nine. Please take note of that.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

蓝手帕: 您还有别的疑问吗?
Tuesday: Is there anything else I can help you with?

维尔汀: 暂时没有了。
Vertin: I'm good for now. Thank you.

撂下电话后，脖颈处忽然传来了轻微的触感，如同一片羽毛拂过皮肤。
As she hangs up, she feels a light touch on her neck, like a feather brushing against her skin.

抬头望去，天花板的角落中，一条若隐若现的细丝垂了下来。
She reflexively touches her neck. It's a spider's web. She follows it up to the corner of the ceiling.

维尔汀: ……蜘蛛?
Vertin: Spiders?

节肢动物落在了木柜子的案面上。它挥动细长的足，从一片暗处，爬行到另一片暗处。
A spider falls onto the surface of the wooden cabinet. It moves its slender legs, crawling from one shadowy spot to another.

它行走时，引燃了空气中的火花。
As it moves, sparks ignite in the air.

随后，神秘术的辉光显现。借着这一瞬的光芒，她得以看清了一切。
Then, in the glow of an arcane skill, she can see everything clearly.

维尔汀: ……奇怪，这是……神秘学术阵?
Vertin: Is that an arcane array?

维尔汀: 很熟悉的纹路，我曾经在哪里见过它。
Vertin: The pattern's familiar. I've seen it somewhere before.

床头柜的表面，镌刻着几道凹凸不平的痕迹。手指抚上纹路，试图分辨刻痕的纹理与走向。
The surface of the bedside cabinet has a rough engraving on it. She traces the markings with her fingers, trying to discern their texture and direction.

维尔汀： ——！
Vertin: ...!

术阵的纹理烫伤了指尖，籍由这一瞬的痛感，过去的回忆从脑海中被唤醒。
The array burns her fingertips, and in that momentary pain, memories are awakened.

维尔汀： 我见过这个术阵。
Vertin: Yes, I've definitely seen this before,

维尔汀： ……在第一防线学校的课堂中。
Vertin: when I was in school.

第一防线学校·教室
Classroom, SPDM

教员： 这是一种极其危险的术阵，脱离了固有的范式——这代表着它不受控制。
Instructor: This is an extremely dangerous array—one that you are prohibited from using. It can go easily beyond the caster's control.

教员： 我们学习神秘术，驯化未知的能量，让它们为我们所用。
Instructor: We study arcanum and tame it for our use.

教员： 而这力量一旦超过合理的限度，反而会引发自身的毁灭……
Instructor: But once its power surpasses our limits, it is highly likely that it will lead to our own destruction.

教员： 我需要你们记住这个图案，因为我会在下一次测验中考到它。
Instructor: I need you all to remember that. It'll be in your next exam.

学生们低下稚嫩的脖颈，教室中满溢沙沙的书写声。
The students put their heads down, and the sound of scribbling fills the classroom.

十四行诗： 维尔汀，你在听吗?
Sonetto: Vertin? Are you listening?

十四行诗： 教员说，这是一定会考核的内容。如果你需要笔记的话……
Sonetto: The instructor just said it'd be in the next exam. If you like, you can check my notes.

优等生惴惴不安地攥紧了手中的笔记本。
The top student nervously clutches her notebook in her hands.

维尔汀： ……谢谢，不过，我在想另一个问题。
Vertin: Oh, thank you. My mind was somewhere else.

维尔汀： 为什么学校要把一个学生根本无法用到的术阵，作为考试的重点?
Vertin: Why have they made it a key point of the exam if we can't even use it?

维尔汀： ……我想，教员的本意并不是让我们学会使用这些术阵。
Vertin: I see. They didn't teach us about arrays so that we could use them.

维尔汀： ——而是尽快地识别它，好察觉危险的来源。
Vertin: They wanted us to be able to identify them so that we could avoid danger.

她转头望向窗外，暮色沉沉。
She looks out the window. It's getting dark.

维尔汀： 如果贸然行动，极有可能引发爆炸，或是其他结果……
Vertin: It's highly likely to cause an explosion or other severe consequences if I act too hastily.

不远处的术阵中，有微弱的光芒正在闪烁。
The array glows faintly.

维尔汀： 不能再等下去了，红弩箭不在这儿，我得尽快找到一个帮手。
Vertin: Lilya still hasn't come back. I must find someone else to help.

一个帮手需要具备什么特质?
What qualities should an ally have?

果决，利落，有一些进攻或自保的手段。
Decisiveness, efficiency, some means of offense or self-defense ...

突如其来的敲门声打断了她的思绪。
A sudden knock on the door interrupts her thoughts.

门扉开启后，一张眼熟的面孔出现了。
She opens it to a familiar face.

阿尔古斯： 嘿，小姑娘，我刚刚在走廊见到了你。
Argus: Hey. We met back in the hallway, remember?

阿尔古斯： ——我得说，现在轮到你了。
Argus: Now, it's your turn.

维尔汀： 在没有说明前因后果的情况下，我很难对此做出正确的反应，小姐。
Vertin: What exactly do you want from me, Miss?

雇佣兵挑了挑眉毛。
The mercenary raises an eyebrow.

阿尔古斯： 很简单，我要找的人就藏在这个旅馆里——为了找到她，我不得不翻遍整座旅馆。
Argus: Well, it's simple. The person I'm looking for is right here in this motel, and I'm scouring every corner of it to find her.

阿尔古斯： 小姐，我并不是在提一些无礼的要求，你当然可以开出你的价码。
Argus: Look, missy, I don't wanna make things hard for you. Name your price, and we can talk.

维尔汀： ……如果一个人这样地躲着您，那么她大概是不愿意见您。
Vertin: If this person's gone to such great lengths to avoid you, perhaps she doesn't want to see you at all.

阿尔古斯： 噢，这不是我该考虑的事情——雇主发布了任务，我只需要完成它，无论是捉奸、跟踪，还是送信……没有差别。
Argus: Well, that ain't my concern, is it? A job's a job. Whether it's catching a cheating spouse, tracking someone down, or delivering a letter, it don't make no difference to me.

维尔汀： ……好吧，但你的任务目标不在这个房间里——我很确定这里没有其他人。
Vertin: Very well. But you'll have to look elsewhere, I'm afraid. There's no one but me in this room.

阿尔古斯： 哈。
Argus: Hah.

阿尔古斯： 我自然有我的用意——您先转过头，看向这个房间。
Argus: Look, I know what I'm doing. How about you turn around and take a good look around the room?

维尔汀： ……你不会趁我转头的时候敲晕我吧?
Vertin: So you can knock me out as soon as I turn my back to you?

阿尔古斯： 哈哈哈……
Argus: Hahaha!

雇佣兵发出了爽朗的笑声。
The mercenary gives a hearty laugh.

阿尔古斯： 小姑娘，如果我只是想敲晕你，我就不必花这些功夫，和你说上这样多的话。
Argus: Missy, if that were my plan, I wouldn't have spent all this time talking to you.

阿尔古斯： 非必要的情况下，我还是更愿意用一种合情合理的方式来解决问题——不必让双方闹得太不愉快。
Argus: I much prefer to do my business pleasantly. I don't like to see things get too ugly.

维尔汀： ……好。
Vertin: I see.

阿尔古斯： 不转头也没有关系，我会告诉你我看见的一切。
Argus: Fine. If you don't wanna turn around, I'll tell you what I see.

雇佣兵眯起眼睛，眼中辉光流转。
The mercenary squints, that same emerald light shimmering in her eye.

阿尔古斯： 您的手指被烫伤了——为什么这样的不小心?
Argus: You've burned your finger there. You should be more careful.

维尔汀： 这是……
Vertin: This is ...

阿尔古斯： 真奇怪，这不像是因为靠近火源而造成的灼伤……更像是某种神秘能量?
Argus: Don't look like a fire burn to me. What was it? Some arcane energy?

阿尔古斯： 看来……和其他的房间一样，这个房间也有它的秘密。
Argus: Looks like this room has a couple secrets, too.

雇佣兵的视线望向了更遥远的方向。
The mercenary shifts her gaze to the room further away.

阿尔古斯： 哈，我猜——您刚刚触摸了位于某处的神秘术术阵，而术阵造成的烫伤在您的手上留下了灼痕？我说得对吗?
Argus: So you touched an arcane array, and its power burned you. How's that for a guess? Pretty close, huh?

维尔汀： ——!
Vertin: ...!

她望向那双正燃烧着蓝绿色的眼睛。
She examines the mercenary's burning emerald eye.

阿尔古斯： 小姑娘，这是我的神秘术，能够帮助我看清楚所有的痕迹。这也是那些老板看重我的原因。
Argus: This is my arcane skill. It allows me to see the traces that people leave behind. That's how I get these jobs, you see.

阿尔古斯： 一件事要不留下痕迹，只有一种可能性——它从未发生。所以，我来到这个房间，只是为了寻找痕迹，而不是寻找人。
Argus: Ain't nothing happening that don't leave a trace. If there ain't no trace, then it never happened. I came to your room to look for evidence, not a person.

维尔汀： 我明白了，您是想要知道——那位追踪对象是否来过这里，对吗?
Vertin: I see. You want to know whether the person you're tracking has been here, right?

阿尔古斯： 聪明的小姑娘。
Argus: Now we're talking.

维尔汀： 在你调查房间之前，我还有一个问题……你是附近的受雇佣者?
Vertin: Before I let you investigate the room, I have one more question. You take jobs from people nearby, don't you?

阿尔古斯： 很明显，不是吗?
Argus: Of course. It's obvious, ain't it?

她没有等到自己想要的回应。而在这熟悉的沉默中，老道的雇佣兵似乎捕捉到了一线生意即将到来的气息。
She doesn't get the response she wants. In this familiar silence, the experienced mercenary smells an imminent deal.

那是一种防备与信任，期待与犹疑交杂的情绪。
It's a mixture of caution and trust, anticipation and doubt.

阿尔古斯： 相较于我不合常理的请求，您似乎更关注我的身份。
Argus: You seem more intrigued by my profession than my peculiar request.

阿尔古斯： ——您是遇到麻烦了，是吗?
Argus: You're in trouble, ain't you?

阿尔古斯： 那么，我再向您坦诚地介绍一下自己。我叫阿尔古斯，26 岁，有丰富的受雇佣经验。
Argus: Then let me formally introduce myself. The name's Argus, I'm 26, and I have extensive experience as a mercenary.

维尔汀： 成交。
Vertin: Let's make a deal.

维尔汀： 您可以查探这个房间……但在这段时间里，我需要您协助我的调查。
Vertin: You may search this room all you like, and I won't say a thing. But in return, I'd like your assistance in my own investigation.

阿尔古斯： 调查什么?
Argus: How, exactly?

维尔汀： ……你能看出柜子上的术阵是什么时候镌刻的吗?
Vertin: Can you tell when that array on the cupboard was drawn?

雇佣兵斜挎着枪支，走入了房间的内部，在床头柜的侧边蹲了下来。
在短暂的观察之后，她给出了结论。
Argus slings her shotgun over her shoulder and crouches down beside the nightstand. After a brief examination, she gives her assessment.

阿尔古斯： 距离现在不超过 24 小时。
Argus: Less than 24 hours ago.

维尔汀： ……也就是说，这些都是上一个住客留下的痕迹。
Vertin: In other words, this was left behind by the last guest who stayed in this room.

面对这个结论，雇佣兵摇了摇头。
Argus shakes her head.

阿尔古斯： 未必。
Argus: Can't say for certain.

玻璃酒瓶 · 1/2

Glass Bottles · 1/2 THH-06

奇索斯镇·军备工厂
Armament Factory, Chisos

空无一人的工厂内，空气潮湿而冰冷。
The empty factory is cold and damp.

红弩箭： 哈，希望你别是个空架子。
Lilya: Hah, let's see what you've got in there for me.

她沿着工厂晃了两圈，在收发室里看见了一个硕大的木箱，上面盖满了邮戳。
She wanders the factory, eventually spotting a large crate covered in postage stamps in the receiving room.

狭长的木箱被钉子紧紧地钉着。
她眯着眼睛，借着窗外的月光，看清了木箱上的字迹——
The crate is nailed tightly shut. She squints, having only the moonlight to help her read the words on the box.

红色 38，莉莉娅。
Red 38, Lilya.

红弩箭： 哈，老伙计！
Lilya: Hey, buddy!

她蹲下身，细细地检视着木箱。在伸手敲了敲木箱之后，飞行员拧起了眉毛。
She squats down and inspects the crate. After tapping it a few times, she frowns.

红弩箭： 只有一层木板——这就是他们的保护措施?
Lilya: They just left her in a wooden box. What kind of safekeeping is this?

红弩箭： 行吧，时间紧急，这笔账以后再和他们算……
Lilya: Anyway, I don't have much time. I'll settle that with them later.

她伸出双手，托住了木箱的两端。
She grabs the crate and tries to lift it.

木箱岿然不动——是重力术式。
It doesn't budge—it's bound by arcanum.

红弩箭： ……他们至少准备了一个需要特定口令才能解除的重力术式——
Lilya: Alright. At least they bothered to put a gravity ritual on it.

细微的脚步声在身后响起。
Light footsteps echo behind her.

???: 您也是在准备撤离吗?
???: Are you also preparing to evacuate?

飞行员转过身，一个纤细的身影映入眼帘。
Lilya turns around. A slender girl stands before her, a basket in her arms.

红弩箭： 来得好，你是这儿管事的人?
Lilya: Ah, perfect timing. Are you in charge here?

挎着篮子的女孩打量了她一番之后，甜甜地笑了。
The girl looks her up and down before giving a sweet smile.

凯拉： 中尉，我当然不是管事的人，也不是什么可疑的人——我只是经过这儿而已，您可以叫我凯拉。
Kayla: No, I'm not in charge of anything, Lieutenant. I'm just passing through. I'm Kayla, by the way.

凯拉：我在外面听到了一些响动，还以为是那些不听管教的孩子又来这儿偷军火了……这些东西的价格可不便宜，总有小偷会打上它们的主意。
Kayla: I heard some rattling here and thought some of those kids might've come back to steal weapons again. These things aren't cheap, and the kids know it.

红弩箭：偷军火的孩子？有意思，这儿看守的人呢？
Lilya: Kids stealing from the military? Hah, that's a new one. Where are the guards here?

凯拉：这位中尉，没有人告诉您吗？
Kayla: Oh. Didn't they tell you, Lieutenant?

女孩略感惊讶地说道。
The girl sounds surprised.

凯拉：早在一个月以前，这儿的军队就已经开始撤离了，他们没有留下多少士兵——连我都知道这些。
Kayla: The army stationed here started evacuating a month ago. There aren't many of them around these days.

红弩箭：撤离？
Lilya: Evacuating?

眼前的状况与基金会告知的信息别无二致，飞行员察觉到了一丝危机的预兆。
The Foundation's report was correct. Lilya senses impending danger.

红弩箭：告诉我，哪里能找到那些留下的士兵？
Lilya: Then where can I find the soldiers that are still here?

凯拉：嗯……您是从镇子外面来的吧？在路上的时候，您是否有看到路边的酒吧？
Kayla: Hmm. You're new in town, right? Did you see a bar on your way here?

凯拉：在闲暇的时候，那些芝诺的士兵最喜欢去那儿喝酒……您尽可以去看看，说不准他正在那儿呢？
Kayla: That's where the Zeno soldiers spend their nights drinking. You might wanna check there first. That's probably where you'll find him.

红弩箭：他长什么样子？
Lilya: Him? What does he look like?

凯拉：噢，就像所有芝诺士兵那样，您保准一眼就能认出他。
Kayla: Like every other Zeno soldier. They all look the same to me. You'll know when you see him.

她忽然停止了说话，上下打量着飞行员。
She pauses, looking the pilot up and down.

凯拉：但是我得告诉您……酒吧里的人并不欢迎外乡人——您听说过“启明会”吗？
Kayla: But I have to tell you: The bar doesn't like outsiders. Have you heard of the Order of Enlightenment?

凯拉：这是一个非常活跃的密教组织……前不久他们一直在镇子上宣教，而今天正是他们做祷告的日子。
Kayla: It's an occult society—very active these days. They were preaching in this town just a few days ago. Today is their day of prayer.

红弩箭：这和我有什么关系？
Lilya: And, what does that have to do with me?

凯拉：当然与您有关系——因为他们做祷告的地方，正是镇子上的酒吧。
Kayla: The bar you're going to is where they gather to pray.

凯拉：再多的，我就不知道了。总之，您如果要去那儿，一定要多加小心。
Kayla: That's all I know. If you're going up there, please be careful.

红弩箭：哈……谢了。
Lilya: Hah. Thanks.

飞行员转身离去，而白衣的少女依然立在原地，静静地望着她离去的背影。
Lilya turns and leaves. The girl watches her as she goes.

凯拉：……愿“受苦者”保佑您。
Kayla: May the Sufferer watch over you.

凯拉：我们将奉行“受苦者”的意志，让那过去的荣光行于当下……
Kayla: Great Sufferer, by your decree, the glory of former days shall grace our present path.

她低声地祷告着。
于她合拢的双手之上，戒指漆黑的刻面正在闪闪发亮。
She whispers a prayer. As she clasps her hands together, the black facets of her ring shimmer.

奇索斯镇·酒吧
Bar, Chisos

客人Ⅰ：我们将奉行“受苦者”的意志，让那过去的荣光行于当下。
Guest I: Great Sufferer, by your decree, the glory of former days shall grace our present path.

客人Ⅱ：我们将进献心灵中的一切，以信仰换取崇高的福祉。
Guest II: We dedicate our souls and minds to you. We seek the well-being of our people in your name.

肃穆的氛围笼罩着那座小小的酒吧，灯光昏黄地亮着。聚集的人们或披黑袍，或着常服。他们彼此依靠，如兄弟之于兄弟，姊妹之于姊妹。
A solemn atmosphere fills the bar. A small group has gathered under the dim lights, some in black robes, others in everyday clothes. They lean on each other like brothers and sisters.

为首的一人高举着手中的玻璃酒杯，对着在座的所有人遥相致意。
The man leading the prayer raises his glass and gives a toast.

酒吧老板：愿“受苦者”保佑诸位。
Bar Owner: May the Sufferer watch over you.

酒吧老板：祂的恩典必将使我们福杯满溢。
Bar Owner: Under THEIR grace, may our cups overflow.

酒吧老板：敬颂“受苦者”。
Bar Owner: To the Sufferer.

众：敬颂“受苦者”！
Crowd: To the Sufferer!

酒吧的大门被猛然推开了。
The bar door flings open.

客人Ⅰ：一个外乡人？
Guest I: Hm? Odd time for a stranger to come.

年轻的飞行员望着眼前的一切。
The young pilot looks around.

红弩箭：……真热闹。
Lilya: Not crashing the party, am I?

她径自走向吧台，酒墙上各色的玻璃酒瓶正闪烁着光泽。
She heads straight to the bar, where the shelves glitter with various bottles.

红弩箭：纳帕河谷葡萄酒、加州红酒、肯塔基的威士忌……哈，好货不少。
Lilya: Napa Valley, Californian red, Kentucky whiskey ... Hah, there's a lot of good stuff here.

红弩箭：来一杯伏特加纯饮，我要你这儿最好的牌子。
Lilya: One vodka. Straight. The best you got.

酒吧老板：现在不是开业的时间，斯拉夫人。
Bar Owner: It ain't business hours, lady.

咔哒。
click

这声音她再熟悉不过——有一把枪，正在数英寸之远的地方上了膛。
She knows that sound—someone's cocking a gun just inches away from her.

红弩箭：嘿，我只是想买酒——这就是你们对待客人的方式吗?
Lilya: Hey, all I did was ask for a drink! Is this how you treat your customers?

酒吧老板：我说了，没有。
Bar Owner: As I said, we ain't serving you.

红弩箭：开酒吧的没有伏特加?
Lilya: Why? Don't you have vodka?

红弩箭：那来一杯威士忌吧，我不挑。
Lilya: Fine, I can settle for whiskey. Have to learn to take what we can get, eh?

酒吧老板：——没有。
Bar Owner: You ain't getting that, either.

红弩箭：这也没有?
Lilya: Seriously? You don't have any whiskey?

她望向了酒墙上琳琅满目的威士忌。
She glances at the whiskey bottles lining the shelves.

红弩箭：那我知道芝诺为什么要撤离了——那帮家伙嗜酒如命，他们可没有办法在这儿待下去。
Lilya: Pft. I'm starting to understand why Zeno evacuated. What's the point of living in a town where there's no real liquor? Especially for those drunkards.

酒吧老板：芝诺的中尉为什么要来这儿喝酒？你们的工厂仓库里没有酒精燃料了吗?
Bar Owner: What's a Zeno lieutenant doing here, anyway? No alcohol fuel in that warehouse of yours?

客人们发出一阵哄笑。
The patrons laugh.

红弩箭：哈，我可不知道当地有喝酒精燃料的习俗。
Lilya: Hah! You sure have some interesting drinking habits down here.

红弩箭：——说真的，我很好奇，那个“受苦者”到底给了你们多少好处?
Lilya: But I'm curious. What did this Sufferer promise you to make you all change your faith?

红弩箭：让固执的德克萨斯人改变信仰，这不是一件简单的事。
Lilya: I mean, that's quite an achievement, especially here in Texas.

她敏锐地转身，一颗子弹擦过了她的发丝。
She turns, narrowly avoiding a bullet. It whizzes past her hair.

红弩箭：这就忍不住了?
Lilya: Oh, so we're doing this now, are we?

定期报告
Periodic Report 小径

圣洛夫基金会报告
St. Pavlov Foundation Report

简中
报告编号：XXXXXXXXXXXXX
发件人：外派调查小组 组长 安德烈·西尔韦斯特
收件人：圣洛夫基金会副主席办公室

致副主席女士：
经由一个月的追踪，我同我的组员在美国南部发现了多名重塑之手间谍。至少 3 名间谍来往于达拉斯、奥斯汀和休斯顿之间，疑似在为“启明会”建立信息与物资获取渠道。另外数人活跃于 77 号公路沿线，由于其多使用假名与易容魔药，准确身份与人数尚未确定，但可以确认至少 5 个假身份。以上间谍的信息将附于报告后。
我认为，这些迹象进一步证实了我们的猜测，“启明会”正在有目的地筹备某种神秘学事项。
另外值得注意的是，线人情报表明，有一个被称为“淑女格蕾丝”的间谍在德克萨斯州活动（已知情报已随信附上）。是否要对此人进行进一步追踪，我们等待您的回复。

愿和平与我们同在。

外派调查小组 组长 安德烈·西尔韦斯特

复信：
致外派调查小组：
感谢你们为和平作出的辛勤劳动。上述情报已记录在案。
关于“淑女格蕾丝”，我已充分知悉。鉴于该间谍的意图未知，我建议不予干涉，放任其行动，以待后观。

愿和平与我们同在。

圣洛夫基金会副主席 康斯坦丁

English
Report Number: XXXXXXXXXXXXX

From: Field Investigation Team Leader Andreas Sylvester

To: Office of the Vice President, St. Pavlov Foundation

Dear Madam Vice President,

After a month of surveillance, my team has identified several Manus Vindictae agents operating in the southern United States. At least three have been traveling between Dallas, Austin, and Houston; they are likely establishing information and supply channels for the Order of Enlightenment. Several others are active along Route 77, frequently using aliases and disguise potions to keep their exact identities and numbers hidden; however, at least five false identities have been confirmed. Please find detailed information on these agents attached to this report.

I believe these findings further substantiate our hypothesis that the Order of Enlightenment is planning to carry out an unprecedented arcane ritual.

Additionally, informant reports indicate that a spy known as "Ms. Grace" is active in Texas (see attached document). We await your directive on whether to pursue further surveillance of this individual.

May the peace be with us.

Field Investigation Team Leader Andreas Sylvester

Reply:

To the Field Investigation Team,

Thank you for your diligent efforts in the pursuit of peace. The aforementioned intelligence has been documented.

Regarding "Ms. Grace," I am fully aware of the situation. Given the unknown intentions of this spy, I recommend a strategy of non-interference. Allow her to proceed in her actions for further observation.

May the peace be with us.

Vice President Constantine of the St. Pavlov Foundation

玻璃酒瓶 · 2/2

Glass Bottles · 2/2 THH-06

玻璃酒瓶碎了一地，晶亮的酒液浸透了地板。
Bottles crash to the floor, splashing alcohol all over the bar.

酒吧老板： 呼……呼……
Bar Owner: *pant*

红弩箭： 我没有兴趣掺和多余的事。你只要告诉我，那个芝诺的士兵去哪儿了?
Lilya: Look, I don't care what you're doing here. Just tell me where that Zeno soldier went.

飞行员望着趴伏在酒柜上的老板。
She looks down at the bar owner slumped over the counter.

酒吧老板： 芝诺士兵……?
Bar Owner: What Zeno soldier?

男人勉力睁大了肿胀的眼睛。
The man strains to open his swollen eyes.

红弩箭： 别装傻。
Lilya: Don't play dumb with me.

酒吧老板： 噢……那个士兵，他是一个十足的蠢货。
Bar Owner: Oh. That soldier. He's a complete idiot, that one.

酒吧老板： 芝诺已经完全地抛弃他了，他却总觉得是芝诺赏识他，才委派给他看守工厂的任务……
Bar Owner: It's obvious that Zeno's abandoned him. But he insists that they left him here because they believed that only he could keep the warehouse safe.

酒吧老板： 这就是你们芝诺的作风。既然已经决定抛弃他，为什么现在又要寻找他?
Bar Owner: Why are you looking for him now if you decided to ditch him in the first place?

红弩箭： ……听着，我知道你们看不惯芝诺。但这和我没关系。
Lilya: Listen, I can tell you guys aren't the biggest fans of Zeno, but that has nothing to do with me.

红弩箭： 我来这儿只是为了拿回我的东西。
Lilya: I'm just here to get my stuff back.

酒吧老板： 呼……
Bar Owner: *exhale*

他虚弱地喘了一口气。
He takes a labored breath.

酒吧老板： 如果你执意要找他，那他也许在镇子的远郊喝酒。
Bar Owner: Fine. If you insist on finding him, try your luck on the outskirts of town. He might be drinking there.

红弩箭： 哈，谢了。
Lilya: Hmph. Thanks.

飞行员踩着夜色，离开了这间沉寂的酒吧。
She steps over the unconscious man beside her and leaves the bar.

羊皮纸
The Parchment THH-07

阿尔古斯： 这未必是上一位房客留下的痕迹。
Argus: We can't say for sure if this ritual was created by the last guest.

阿尔古斯： 实际上，在这个旅馆的所有房间中，或多或少地都存在着一些古怪的痕迹——这些痕迹非常新鲜，存续的时间不会超过一个月。
Argus: Fact is, you can find all kinds of unusual markings in this motel—most of them less than a month old. Very recent indeed.

阿尔古斯： 那名侍应生说，最近并没有大体量的旅客潮——所以，我猜应当是一个精通秘术的团伙，在各个房间之中流窜。
Argus: The maid said that there ain't many tourists these days, so my guess is that a group of skilled arcanists have left their work in every room.

阿尔古斯： 根据留下的痕迹推断，这个团伙大约有三至五人……
Argus: Based on the markings I've seen so far, there were about three to five people in this group.

维尔汀： 那么，这些人里，有一位羊首人身的神秘学家吗?
Vertin: And was there a sheep-headed arcanist among them?

阿尔古斯： 哈，这我可就不知道了。
Argus: Well, that I don't know.

阿尔古斯： 但我能告诉您的是……这儿确实有羊存在过的痕迹——我曾在走廊上看到过几只小小的羊蹄印。
Argus: What I can say, though, is that there was a sheep living in here. I saw some hoofprints on the hallway floor.

阿尔古斯： 这里曾有人牵着羊来住宿，多么奇怪——但是，这儿是德州，附近多是农户，这样的事情似乎又没有那么奇怪了。
Argus: It looked like someone had stayed in this motel with a sheep—sounds pretty odd, but I suppose it ain't too strange given the local farmland.

阿尔古斯： 不过，我保证，有一个信息是您一定感兴趣的。
Argus: But I'm sure this will catch your attention.

维尔汀： ……什么?
Vertin: What?

阿尔古斯： 我们都知道，羊用四个蹄子来走路。
Argus: We all know that sheep walk on four hooves.

阿尔古斯： 但是我看到的足迹显然并不符合这个特征——它小巧而精致。最重要的是，脚印主人的行走方式更接近于人，而且……
Argus: But the hoofprints I saw were different. They were small and delicate and, most importantly, followed the movement pattern of a human. Judging by the trail ...

阿尔古斯： 我能看出来，脚印的主人是个瘦弱的孩子，身高约为 5 英尺。
Argus: The owner of the hoofprints was about the size of a slender kid, maybe 5 feet tall.

雇佣兵口述的数据与基金会的报告如出一辙。
This description exactly matches the Foundation's report.

维尔汀： ……你说得没有错。
Vertin: That's it. That's the one I'm looking for.

阿尔古斯： 当然——您可以质疑我的为人，但绝不能质疑我的专业水准。
Argus: Don't I know it—they can question my morals, but nobody can question my competence.

阿尔古斯： 现在，我可以开始对房间的探查了吗？维尔汀小姐。
Argus: So, may I enter your room now, Ms. Vertin?

维尔汀： 请。
Vertin: Please.

阿尔古斯： 那么……首先来看看这个。
Argus: Now, let's start with this little thing.

阿尔古斯： 这些刻痕非常新鲜，没有被虫蚁咬噬，也没有遭到水雾的侵蚀。
Argus: The carvings are new. No sign of woodworm damage or moisture absorption.

阿尔古斯： 断口的木刺非常锐利，连……嗯?
Argus: These splinters along the edge are extremely sharp. Mm?

痕迹中有一些暗红色的脆质结晶，她伸手蘸取。
She dips her finger into a dark red, crumbly residue.

阿尔古斯： 这是……血痂?
Argus: Is this dried blood?

她揉搓着那些细碎的结晶，它们随着雇佣兵的动作化为更细碎的粉末。
She rubs the granules between her finger and her thumb, reducing them to a fine powder.

维尔汀： 它在术阵中作为触媒而使用。
Vertin: Blood was used as the medium for this array.

维尔汀： 这儿，未闭口的圆，用力不匀的线条。从作画方式来看——不是精于此道的专家。
Vertin: The circle isn't fully closed here, and the lines are a bit uneven. Whoever drew this doesn't seem to be an expert.

维尔汀： 您的身手不错，对吗?
Vertin: You know how to deal with this, right?

阿尔古斯： 老板，别小瞧我。
Argus: All you have to do is ask, boss. You might be surprised.

维尔汀： 我们需要尽可能快地摧毁这个术阵……我想这是一个危险的密教团体所篆刻的……
Vertin: We need to destroy it as quickly as possible. I think it's been left by a dangerous occult group.

阿尔古斯：稍等。
Argus: Hold on.

雇佣兵将枕头垫在了木板之上，随后扣下扳机。
She places a pillow over the wood and pulls the trigger.

微弱的枪击声之后，残余的亮光熄灭了。
After a faint gunshot, the lingering light goes out.

哗啦——
squelch

新鲜的血液自术阵中涌出，浸湿了发白的刻痕。
Fresh blood oozes from the array, settling in the faded carvings.

维尔汀：……血?
Vertin: Is that blood?

雇佣兵恍若未闻，在错愕的目光中，她用手指蘸取了红色的液体，放在鼻端之下嗅闻着。
The mercenary, unfazed, dips her finger into the red liquid and sniffs it.

阿尔古斯：这是一个神秘学家的血——不是凯拉。
Argus: Yup. The blood of an arcanist. So it can't be Kayla's.

维尔汀：……你能看出这位神秘学家的身份吗?
Vertin: Can you discern the owner's identity?

阿尔古斯：老板，你未免有些太高估我了——我并不能通过血的气味定位到某个具体的人。
Argus: Hah, I ain't all-knowing. I can't identify people by their blood.

阿尔古斯：——还需要更多的线索。
Argus: No, I'll need more than just blood to find out who was here.

阿尔古斯：……嗯?
Argus: Mm?

雇佣兵从柜子与墙面的缝隙处，摸出了一本遍布灰尘的羊皮手册。
She fishes out a dusty sheepskin journal from the gap between the cabinet and the wall.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

她翻开了手册。
She flips through the pages.

阿尔古斯：我等乃金属之第一本质，以及唯一源泉。
Argus: *"We are the beginning and the original source of metals."*

阿尔古斯：经由我等，伟大艺术之最高酊剂得以酿造。
Argus: *"Through us, the highest tincture of art is brewed."*

阿尔古斯：无泉无水能似我，我成全贫者和富者，或让他们罹患病灾。
Argus: *"There is neither a spring nor water like mine. I heal and help both the rich and the poor."*

阿尔古斯：因我可为良药，可为鸩酒。
Argus: *"Yet I am full of hurtful poison."*

阿尔古斯：……什么意思?
Argus: What the hell does that mean?

维尔汀：这是一段有关于炼金术的引文。
Vertin: It's a quote from a text on alchemy.

阿尔古斯：只需要准备足量且优质的材料，画出足够准确的术阵，一切问题都能够被解决。
Argus: *"All challenges will be resolved with the provision of sufficient and high quality materials and the precise execution of the array."*

阿尔古斯：那么——从哪里可以找到优质的材料？
Argus: *"But where do we find these materials?"*

她快速地翻动着陈旧的手册，缝隙中堆积的炼金产物飘扬在空气之中。
She continues to flick through the journal, releasing the accumulated alchemical residue on its pages into the air.

最后一页中，形态抽搐的文字如同遭受火刑的罪者，于书页上写满了孤独的呓语。
On the last page, tortured words are scrawled on the paper. It looks like something a criminal would write in their final moments before their death sentence.

阿尔古斯：存在的，分裂的，终将走向极一。
Argus: *"What was once sundered shall reunite."*

维尔汀：咳、咳……
Vertin: *cough*

鼻腔滚烫，细不可察的火花在空气中涌动。
Her nose burns as barely visible sparks heat the air.

阿尔古斯：我看见过这个笔迹。
Argus: I've seen this handwriting before.

“启明会”信众 I：还有……这是我的电话。
"Order" Follower I: And here. My phone number.

追随者随之递过来一张美钞，上面潦草地写着一串数字。
He hands over a dollar bill with a string of numbers scrawled along the blank space.

雇佣兵从口袋中掏出了那张皱巴巴的钞票，将上面的字迹与羊皮手册进行比对。
The mercenary pulls out the crumpled bill from her pocket, comparing the handwriting with that in the journal.

阿尔古斯：……是了，两份笔迹的书写特征完全吻合。
Argus: Yup. This is definitely the same.

砰——
bang

维尔汀：——！
Vertin: ...!

阿尔古斯：……飞矢 M1903 式手枪。
Argus: That sound. It's a Flying Arrow M1903 pistol.

???：啊啊啊啊——
???: Ahhh.

阿尔古斯：……金伯利？怎么哪里都有她？
Argus: Kimberly? What's wrong with her now?

阿尔古斯：老板，外面出岔子了。我得过去看看，你要和我来吗？
Argus: I better go check it out, boss. Something don't seem right. You coming?

阿尔古斯：那个金伯利可能看见了什么。
Argus: That Kimberly must've run into something.

纪实文学
Face Reality THH-08

长绒的厚地毯本应具备绝佳的隔音效果。
The thick carpet in the hallway is usually enough to dampen any sounds.

但人们急切的情绪让这份本应具有的功能无限地趋近于无。
But no amount of soundproofing could stop the sound of a gunshot from echoing through the place.

枪响之处，毫无生机的史蒂文躺在地上。
他的头上被开了一个大洞，孱弱的神经末梢在一片红色中颤动。
At its source, Stefen's limp, twitching body lies on the floor. There's a gaping hole in his head.

金伯利女郎： 啊……
Ms. Kimberly: Ah.

女房客失去了全身的力气，正惊魂未定地战栗着。
She's trembling in fear.

金伯利女郎： 他、他还活着吗……?
Ms. Kimberly: Is-Is he still alive?

阿尔古斯： 蠢问题。
Argus: Just when I thought you couldn't get any dumber.

金伯利女郎： ……
Ms. Kimberly: ...

维尔汀： 这是自杀?
Vertin: Is this a suicide?

金伯利女郎： 他掏出枪，对着自己的太阳穴来了一枪……
Ms. Kimberly: He pulled out the gun and shot himself in the head.

金伯利女郎： 那些脑子里的东西，全部流到了地板和墙壁上……
Ms. Kimberly: His brains splattered on the walls and flowed onto the floor.

她的喃喃自语近乎于告解。
Her muttering is almost a confession.

雇佣兵俯下身，查看现场的狼藉。
Argus kneels down to examine the body.

阿尔古斯： 嗯……伤口附近存在灼伤与烟垢。
Argus: Mm. There's gunshot residue and powder burns near the wound.

阿尔古斯： 手上有火药粒。
Argus: Gunpowder particles on his fingers.

维尔汀： ……
Vertin: ...

阿尔古斯： 他死于枪伤，子弹由飞矢 M1903 式手枪发出，贯穿了他的脑部。
Argus: There's no doubt. He died from a gunshot wound. The bullet was fired from the pistol in his hand and went straight through his skull.

阿尔古斯： 这把枪的来头可不小，是芝诺那边配发的军备用品——你惹上大麻烦了。
Argus: But this ain't just any pistol. It's a Zeno pistol. You've got yourself in some serious trouble, missy.

金伯利女郎：不是我……
Ms. Kimberly: It wasn't me.

她面色苍白，勉强地镇定了下来。
Her face is still pale, but she manages to stop her shaking.

金伯利女郎：我只是一个路过的、可怜的、被牵连进来的普通人。
Ms. Kimberly: I'm just an innocent, sad, terrified girl who just happened to pass by.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

阿尔古斯：好吧，这位路过的、可怜的、被牵连进来的小姐。
Argus: Well, Ms. Innocent-Sad-and-Terrified ...

阿尔古斯：如果你想完全摆脱自身的嫌疑，就告诉我们刚刚发生了什么。
Argus: If you wanna prove your innocence, start by telling us what happened here.

阿尔古斯：——你说的谎言都会被我识破，因为这儿的痕迹不会骗人。
Argus: And mind you, I will call you out if you lie. The evidence here will tell me what's true and what ain't.

她指了指自己的眼睛。
She points to her eye.

金伯利女郎：……
Ms. Kimberly: ...

金伯利女郎：既然你心里已经有了答案，那为什么还要问我！
Ms. Kimberly: If you're so clever, then why are you asking me? Just figure it out yourself!

惊魂未定的女郎虚弱地申辩着。
Her protestation is weak. She quickly gives in.

金伯利女郎：好吧，好吧——我告诉你们，这个疯子在这段时间里是怎么纠缠我的。
Ms. Kimberly: Ugh! Alright, alright! I'll tell you. This madman has been harassing me.

金伯利女郎：……自从我住进来之后，这个男人时常会在走廊中踱步。
Ms. Kimberly: Ever since I moved into this place, I'd often seen him pacing around in the hallway.

金伯利女郎：无论白天还是黑夜，他总是踩着重重的步子，一步一步踩在走廊上——他从来不会考虑别的人是不是要休息！
Ms. Kimberly: Day and night, he'd stomp around out here. He didn't care if anyone else was trying to sleep!

金伯利女郎：但也许他正因为什么事而困扰着呢？出于好心，我决定问问他，发生了什么事……
Ms. Kimberly: I thought he must have had a lot on his mind, like he was troubled or something. So I asked him what happened.

史蒂文：……
Stefen: ...

他眼窝深陷，眼睛里布满了血丝，整个人呈现出一种神经质的特征。
His deep, sunken eyes were bloodshot. Every fiber of his being screamed that something was wrong with him.

金伯利女郎：先生，如果您遇到了困难，可以寻找更合理的方式去解决——在走廊上踱步不仅不管用，还会影响到其他人的休息。
Ms. Kimberly: Sir, if you're having any problems, there are many ways to solve them, but pacing in the hallway isn't one of them. Plus, it disrupts everyone's sleep.

我敢打赌，我没有说任何过激的言语——但他接下来的反应却相当的无礼！
I swear I didn't say anything too harsh, but he was just downright rude!

史蒂文： 滚、滚开——离我远点！
Stefen: Get the hell away! Get out of my face!

金伯利女郎： ……什么？没礼貌的家伙。
Ms. Kimberly: Excuse me? That's pretty rude, you know.

我不想和疯子吵架，还好侍应生及时地过来，帮我解了围。
I had no desire to argue with a madman. Thankfully, the maid intervened when she heard what was going on.

我不知道她是怎么劝说了史蒂文……总之他们最后达成了一致。史蒂文从此不再出现在走廊中，这对其他旅客而言是一件好事。
I have no idea what she said to him, but eventually they came to terms. He stopped pacing the hallway from then on. That was a relief. I'm sure the other guests would agree.

这些话，那个侍应生都可以为我作证，你们大可去问问她。
That maid can vouch for what I've said. Ask her yourselves.

不久之后，史蒂文写了一封信，通过门缝，塞到了我的房间里。
Not long after, I found a letter from Stefen on the floor of my room. It'd been slid under my door.

信上说，他为他的鲁莽感到抱歉。
In the letter, he apologized for his behavior.

……

...

要不要原谅他呢?
"Should I make peace with him?" I thought.

这么想着，我鬼使神差地往猫眼望去——奇怪的是，那里漆黑一片。
As I wondered, I took a look through the peephole. It was strange. I couldn't see a thing. It was pitch black out there.

——这是猫眼坏了吗?
"Is it broken?" I wondered.

没等我想得太多，房间里的电话铃声忽然叮铃铃地响了起来——吓了我一跳呢，还好那是侍应生的电话。
Before I could dwell on it too much, the phone rang. I was startled, but it was just the front desk calling.

蓝手帕： 您好，金伯利女郎。
Tuesday: Hello, Ms. Kimberly.

金伯利女郎： 是到了晚餐的时间吗?
Ms. Kimberly: Is it dinner time already?

蓝手帕： ……不是。
Tuesday: No.

蓝手帕： 您与史蒂文先生有什么……
Tuesday: Is there an issue between Mr. Stefen and yourself?

她欲言又止。
She seemed hesitant to speak.

金伯利女郎： ……嗯?
Ms. Kimberly: Mm?

蓝手帕： 抱歉，也许我并不该问您这些，但目前的状况实在令人担心。
Tuesday: I know it's not my place to ask, but the situation is a little concerning.

蓝手帕： 史蒂文先生的整张脸都贴在了您的门板上……他应该正通过猫眼在看您。
Tuesday: Mr. Stefen is standing at your door, his face pressed up against it.

蓝手帕： ……我需要与您确认一个问题——您确定与他没有任何矛盾吗?
Tuesday: So I just wanna confirm that everything's alright between you two.

金伯利女郎： ……这就是我所遭遇的一切!
Ms. Kimberly: And that's what happened!

维尔汀： 不要太紧张，小姐。至少现在，一切都已经过去了。
Vertin: Calm down, Miss. It's all over now.

维尔汀： 那封信你还保存着吗?
Vertin: Do you still have that letter with you?

女房客露出了嫌恶的表情，用下巴指了指脚边的垃圾桶。
A look of disgust comes across Ms. Kimberly's face as she gestures to the trash can nearby.

金伯利女郎： 谁会留着这种恶心的东西，当然是扔了——如果你们有兴趣，就在这儿找吧。
Ms. Kimberly: Who'd hold onto that? I threw it out right away. It's somewhere in that bin.

垃圾桶里只有一个被揉皱的纸团，雇佣兵拾起了它。
Argus quickly retrieves the crumpled piece of paper from the trash can.

她尽力将纸抚平，阅读着上方的内容。
She smooths it out on her palm and reads its contents.

阿尔古斯： “亲爱的金伯利女郎……”
Argus: "Dear Ms. Kimberly ..."

阿尔古斯： 噢，小姐，我也没想到第一个疑问来得居然如此之快。
Argus: I've got a question already.

阿尔古斯： ——他为什么知道你叫金伯利？你们在之前可没有熟络到互通姓名的程度。
Argus: How did he know your name? You didn't know each other well enough to have exchanged them, did you?

金伯利女郎： 见鬼了……我才是那个受害者！你为什么要像审一个犯人一样来审我!
Ms. Kimberly: I'm the victim here, damn it! You can't interrogate me like this!

金伯利女郎： 如果你非要知道这其中的原因……那我告诉你！因为我的同伴总会叫我的名字……谁知道是不是被史蒂文听见了。
Ms. Kimberly: Ugh, but if you must know, maybe he heard it when my friend called me.

阿尔古斯： 你的同伴?
Argus: Your friend?

金伯利女郎： 当然得有同伴，一位像我这样高贵的小姐，怎么可能孤身来到这个地方……
Ms. Kimberly: Why, what's so odd about that? A young girl like myself should never travel alone to places like this!

窈窕的女郎愤愤不平地控诉着。
She continues in her indignation.

金伯利女郎： 我总得有柔软的床榻、美丽的衣饰，还有……最重要的粮食！要不是为了找东西，我才不会……
Ms. Kimberly: I need someone to make my bed and prepare my clothes, and, most importantly, I need to eat! I wouldn't even be here if I weren't looking for ...

金伯利女郎： ——！
Ms. Kimberly: ...!

她倒吸了一口凉气，用手捂住了自己的嘴。
She gasps, covering her mouth with her hand.

雇佣兵无暇理会女郎聒噪的声音。她眯着眼睛，继续念诵着书信的内容。
But Argus isn't listening. She continues to read the letter aloud.

阿尔古斯： “我对我在走廊上的行为深感歉意……”
Argus: "I wanna apologize for my behavior earlier in the hallway."

维尔汀： 嗯……这封信的措辞从头到尾都很正常，几乎看不出笔者是一位濒临崩溃的人。
Vertin: Hmm. Looks like a perfectly normal letter to me. No hints that this is from a man on the verge of a mental breakdown.

金伯利女郎： 如果你不相信我说的话，你大可去询问那位侍应生……她看见了一切，她可以为我作证！
Ms. Kimberly: If you won't take my word for it, go ahead and ask the maid. She was there! She can vouch for me!

维尔汀： ……请您冷静，我们没有冒犯您的意思。
Vertin: Please. We aren't accusing you of anything.

雇佣兵用指尖夹住了那张信纸，发出了一声嗤笑。
Argus lets out a laugh.

阿尔古斯： 虽然笔迹学已经被证实为一种可信度极低的学问……但我还是不得不说一句。
Argus: Though graphology has been criticized a lot these days, I gotta say ...

阿尔古斯： 这个字迹更像是女人的字迹。
Argus: This looks more like a woman's handwriting to me.

金伯利女郎： ……史蒂文是女人？
Ms. Kimberly: So you mean Stefen was a woman?

原本张牙舞爪的女郎微张着嘴，愣在了原地——
Her aggression seems to dissipate as her eyes widen and her mouth drops.

阿尔古斯： 哈哈……小姐，您想到哪儿去了？
Argus: Hah! You still with us, missy?

阿尔古斯： 我的意思是，这封信有可能不是由史蒂文先生书写的，而是由一位女性所书写。
Argus: What I'm suggesting is that Mr. Stefen didn't write this letter, but a woman did.

阿尔古斯： ……当然，这也只是一种猜测，也许史蒂文先生本人的字迹就是如此纤细呢？
Argus: But that's just speculation. Chances are Mr. Stefen's handwriting was just a little feminine.

阿尔古斯： 我会暂时保留这张纸条。现在，让我们继续之前的问题。
Argus: I'll keep this letter for now. Back to my questions.

阿尔古斯： 既然如此，你为什么要继续接近史蒂文？你明明知道他曾做过不合常理的行为。
Argus: If the story you told is true, then why are you at the scene of his death? Did you go looking for him, even after all the weird things he'd done?

金伯利女郎： ……
Ms. Kimberly: ...

金伯利女郎： 因为我饿了！我总不能饿着肚子干活！
Ms. Kimberly: I was hungry, okay?! That a good enough answer for you?! I can't just starve myself!

阿尔古斯： ……饿了？我记得旅馆中有送餐服务。
Argus: Hungry? If I remember correctly, the motel offers room service.

阿尔古斯： 而旅馆每天会有一份免费的餐点——所以即使您没有钱，也可以维持基本的温饱。
Argus: And you get one free meal a day, so even if you ain't got no money, you have enough food to get by.

金伯利女郎： 你、你不懂——！
Ms. Kimberly: What-what do you know?!

女房客有些气急败坏了。
She looks flustered.

金伯利女郎： 我怎么能吃那些东西……
Ms. Kimberly: I'm not eating one of those ham sandwiches.

阿尔古斯： 好吧，您是一位对生活品质有所追求的小姐。
Argus: Alright, so you've got some standards when it comes to food.

阿尔古斯： 现在让我们回到正题，在他开枪前一刻，您也在场，对吗？那时发生了什么？
Argus: Let's drop that. You were there when he fired the shot, right? What happened then?

阿尔古斯： 不要慌张，您可以慢慢地讲述。
Argus: Take your time and think it through. There's no rush.

金伯利女郎： ……
Ms. Kimberly: ...

一刻钟以前，史蒂文按响了我的门铃。
About fifteen minutes ago, he rang my doorbell.

我以为是我的同伴从镇子上回来了，每次她一回来，就会带来一些好东西。于是我打开了门——谁能知道史蒂文挨了那样一顿打，还能这么快地出门。
I thought my friend had returned from town. She always brings something amazing with her. So I opened the door. The last thing I expected was to see Stefen standing there—who'd have thought that he could get back on his feet so quickly after the beating he took?

看到他的脸之后，我吓坏了，用力地砸上门，原本以为他会放手。
I was terrified when I saw him there. He towered over me, one hand on the doorframe and the other pushing against the door. I slammed the door shut. I thought he'd let go.

——但是他没有。
But he didn't. The door closed on his fingers.

史蒂文： 哈哈……我明白，我全都搞懂了！你就是芝诺派来的人，对不对！
Stefen: Hahaha, I understand now. I understand it all! You're with Zeno, aren't you?!

他的手指因骨折而扭曲成奇异的角度，但他却对此毫不在意……就像骨折对于他而言，只是虱子的咬噬。
His fingers were bent at a peculiar angle. It must've been painful, but he didn't seem to feel the pain at all. The fracturing of his fingers was no more painful than a mosquito bite to him.

史蒂文： 所有的接近行为，最终的目的都只是为了拿我去换赏金……天哪，我真是搞不懂你们为什么要这么做。
Stefen: You came to me and made me drop my guard so that one day you could turn me in for a bounty. But why me? Why are you doing this to me?!

史蒂文： 提出计划的不是我，执行计划的人不是我，按下那个发射按钮的人……更不是我！
Stefen: It wasn't me who made the plan. It wasn't me who executed it. It wasn't me who pressed that damn button!

史蒂文：我只是向世人揭露了这段罪行——你说，要不是心虚，他们为什么要发布这么多的通缉令呢?
Stefen: All I did was expose their crime to the rest of the world. Tell me. Why else would they want my head so desperately if they didn't believe they were guilty?

史蒂文：那些杀人的人饱受赞誉，这不正常——而我原本应该是个英雄！却只能龟缩在这个肮脏的小旅馆里，这更不正常！
Stefen: In the meantime, the actual killers are treated as heroes. But I'm the hero! Me! ME! But, but all my sorry ass gets is a lifetime of hiding out in some random motel in the middle of nowhere! This world is sick!

金伯利女郎：……天啊，你在说些什么?
Ms. Kimberly: What the hell are you talking about?

史蒂文：得了吧，小姐，不要再装腔作势了。你一和我说话，维尔汀就来了——世界上哪里会有这么巧的事。
Stefen: Come on. Drop the act. Right after you spoke to me, Vertin showed up at my door. Are you trying to tell me that that was just by chance?

金伯利女郎：维尔汀?
Ms. Kimberly: Vertin?

他没有理会我的疑问。
He totally ignored my question.

史蒂文：这个世界生病了。
Stefen: The world has fallen ill.

史蒂文：我想明白了……那天上的国是确实存在着的。要不然，我们的脑子里为何会拥有一个关于“完美的天国”的概念呢?
Stefen: I can see that now. The, the realm above truly does exist. How else would we have gotten the idea of a perfect heavenly realm?

史蒂文：明明它不存在于现实世界里啊……
Stefen: Obviously, it doesn't exist in this world.

金伯利女郎：别再发癔症了。就算那天上的国确实存在，和现在的你也没关系——你松手，我要关门了。
Ms. Kimberly: I don't care. Even if that place does exist, it has nothing to do with you. Get out of the way. I'm closing the door.

史蒂文：但至少，我可以决定在什么时候踏入那道窄门，对吗?
Stefen: But at least I get to decide when I step through that door, right?

我不知道他在说什么。
I had no idea what he was talking about.

而他也没有继续给我说话的机会。
And he didn't give me much chance to figure it out, either.

史蒂文：小姐，恐怕你得带着“任务失败”的消息回去咯。
Stefen: I'm afraid your mission is doomed to fail, young lady.

他在那一瞬间露出从未有过的释然笑容。
In that moment, a smile of relief came over his face.

随后，他毫不犹豫地将手枪抵在了太阳穴上，扣下了扳机。
Then, without a moment's hesitation, he pressed the pistol against his temple and pulled the trigger.

砰——！
bang

金伯利女郎：……后来的事，你们都知道了。
Ms. Kimberly: And you know the rest.

渐近的足音在这一刻停止，众人望向了声音的来源。
The approaching footsteps stop abruptly. They turn to the source.

身着蓝灰色裙装的侍应生停在了众人的面前。望着眼前的尸体，她展露出恰到好处的惊讶。
The maid stands before the group, showing just the right amount of surprise as her eyes fall upon the body.

蓝手帕：这儿刚刚发生了什么……?
Tuesday: What's going on in here?

阿尔古斯：他自杀了，就是这么简单。
Argus: This man killed himself.

蓝手帕：……您看看，他的血流了一地。
Tuesday: Oh, dear. There's blood everywhere.

蓝手帕：这打扫起来会多么麻烦……天气又这样的热，也许残留的血迹和油脂很快就会发出腐败的臭味……
Tuesday: It'll be a lot of work to clean it all up, and with the weather being so hot, the room will soon start to smell.

蓝手帕：我得把这些地毯全换了……
Tuesday: All the carpets have to go.

侍应生发出一声长叹，语气中略带苦恼。
The maid lets out a long sigh, her tone tinged with annoyance.

维尔汀：……蓝手帕小姐，有一个问题我想与您确认。
Vertin: Ms. Tuesday, can I ask you a question?

蓝手帕：什么?
Tuesday: Yes?

维尔汀：在您这里，是否有一些来自于重塑之手的客人?
Vertin: Have you ever had any guests who looked like or claimed themselves to be Manus Vindictae?

蓝手帕：……重塑之手?
Tuesday: Manus Vindictae?

她的面孔红润，似笑非笑地伫立着。
Her face flushes as she smiles faintly.

蓝手帕：我不明白这些，您能替我讲讲吗?
Tuesday: I'm not entirely sure what you mean. Could you explain in more detail?

维尔汀：他们总喜欢穿着蓝黑色的衣物，有部分信徒时常口角流涎，无法说出完整的语句。
Vertin: Most of them dress in blue and black, some drool a fair bit, and most of them can't speak in full sentences.

维尔汀：最重要的特征是，他们总会戴着手状的面具——您见过吗?
Vertin: The most notable feature is that they all wear masks shaped like hands. Have you seen any before?

蓝手帕：手状的面具……
Tuesday: Masks shaped like hands ...

她像是开始了回忆。
She taps her finger on her chin.

蓝手帕：我所接待的客人，没有一位曾经戴过手状的面具——他们也不曾穿着蓝黑色的衣物。
Tuesday: No, I've never had a guest who wore a hand-shaped mask. Never seen anyone in blue and black, either.

蓝手帕：但如果一个组织要秘密地做些什么，我想他们也不会太过张扬。
Tuesday: But if an organization was going to do something in secret, I don't think they'd be too public about it.

阿尔古斯：嘿，侍应生。
Argus: Hey, lady.

雇佣兵毫不客气地打断了对话。
Argus doesn't hesitate to interrupt the conversation.

阿尔古斯：告诉我这个男人住在哪儿。
Argus: Take me to his room.

她的枪管指向史蒂文的尸体。
She points the barrel of her gun at Stefen's corpse.

蓝手帕：您不是顶擅长这些追踪吗？阿尔古斯小姐。
Tuesday: Oh, it shouldn't be too hard for you to find the room yourself, right, Ms. Argus? After all, that's how you make a living.

蓝手帕：我可以告诉您他的房间号码——214，您应该也想去那个房间。
Tuesday: But I can just tell it to you. It's 214. You must be curious about that room.

蓝手帕：……我很惊讶，您竟然在短短的两天内，就快要查遍整座旅馆了……充沛的行动力，就像一个饱含好奇心的孩子。
Tuesday: I'm surprised. You've been in almost every room in the motel, and you've been here for two days. You're like a child in your curiosity.

蓝手帕：……嗯，如果您是一位州际警察，我相信附近的治安会得到很大的改善。
Tuesday: This place would be much safer if you were the sheriff here.

蓝手帕：……哈，祝愿您能找到那位小姑娘。
Tuesday: Anyway, I hope you can find that girl soon.

血肉模糊的尸体近在眼前，而她垂下头，轻轻地掖了掖怀中的襁褓。
Standing before the bloody corpse, she looks down and gently adjusts the baby in her arms.

丝与线
Spider Silk THH-09

维尔汀：……为什么要去那个军官的房间？这和我们的目的有什么关系吗？
Vertin: Why do you want to go to Stefen's room exactly? Is it related to our investigation?

阿尔古斯：当然有关系，老板。
Argus: Of course, boss.

阿尔古斯：就像我在这儿寻找凯拉一样，您也在这儿寻找那位羊首人身的神秘……
Argus: I'm here looking for Kayla, just as you're looking for that sheep-headed ...

雇佣兵罕见地陷入了沉默。
She falls into an unusual silence.

维尔汀： 怎么了？
Vertin: What is it?

阿尔古斯： ……您要找的那位神秘学家，她的名字是叫做数羊羔吗？
Argus: That arcanist you're looking for, is her name Barbara?

维尔汀： ——你知道她？
Vertin: You know her?

阿尔古斯： ……我见过她。
Argus: Yup, we met.

阿尔古斯： 就在 77 号公路的一侧。
Argus: On Route 77.

阿尔古斯： 我刚刚在两个男人嘴里问到了凯拉的下落，那时天已经快黑了。
Argus: I'd just got done asking two men about Kayla's whereabouts, and saw that it was getting dark.

阿尔古斯： 每到晚上，我的视线就会受到影响——这个季节，天又总是黑得很快。
Argus: My sight ain't so good at night. And the nights are long these days.

阿尔古斯： 我要赶紧发动车子，到达一个足够明亮的地方。
Argus: So I was in a bit of a hurry, hoping to get somewhere with proper lights as fast as I could.

阿尔古斯： 这时候，那个名叫数羊羔的神秘学家找上了我——司机把她丢在了公路边，她希望我能够带她一程。
Argus: That's when I saw her, Barbara—all alone by the road. Some jerk of a driver dumped her there, and she asked me for a ride.

阿尔古斯： 我拒绝了，因为我的眼睛已经快看不清了——这样疲惫的状态下，路上有大概率会出事。
Argus: I turned her down. Heck, I could hardly see. She'd have been better off waiting for the next driver than riding with a blind bat like me, you know?

阿尔古斯： 但在不久之后，我还是反悔了——那样小的一个孩子，怎么能让她一个人留在路边呢？
Argus: But as I drove away, I changed my mind. She was too young to be left out there all by herself.

阿尔古斯： 当我再次到达那个地方的时候，小东西已经不见了，地上只留下了一串小小的羊蹄印。
Argus: So I turned back to get her. But when I arrived, she was already gone. There was nothing but a trail of hoofprints in the dirt.

阿尔古斯： 后来，我也在旅馆里见到了一模一样的、形似羊蹄的脚印——她最后还是来到了这座旅馆，我很庆幸。
Argus: When I got to the motel, I saw those hoofprints again. I gotta say, I was kinda relieved to see them. At least she made it here safely.

维尔汀： 她现在还在这座旅馆中吗？
Vertin: And is she still here?

阿尔古斯： 当然，因为没有离去的脚印。
Argus: Well, I've never seen any hoofprints leaving the motel.

阿尔古斯： 不过，从结果去推导原因，无异于射出了箭再画靶子。痕迹只能作为一种辅助手段——这就是所有痕迹追踪的局限。
Argus: But that don't mean she's still here. You gotta be mindful of what your mind picks up and what might slip you by. It's easy to ignore other evidence when what you've seen already fits your hypothesis.

阿尔古斯： 但我依然认为她有很大的可能性在这座旅馆之中。
Argus: That being said, it's still likely that she's somewhere in the motel.

维尔汀： ……好，我和你一起找。
Vertin: Alright. Then let's look for her.

阿尔古斯： 很高兴与您达成了一致——下一个房间是 214。
Argus: It seems we're in agreement. To room 214.

维尔汀： 202，203……
Vertin: 202, 203 ...

沿着走廊，一扇一扇地数过门扉。
She counts the doors as they walk down the hallway.

维尔汀： ……嗯?
Vertin: Mm?

恍惚间，有一抹红色自眼前闪过。
Out of the corner of her eye, a flash of red catches her attention.

阿尔古斯： 这两个房间我都查过了，没有相关的痕迹。
Argus: I've checked those two. Ain't much in them.

维尔汀： ……阿尔古斯，你有没有看到一扇红色的门扉?
Vertin: Argus, did you see a red door just now?

阿尔古斯： 红色的门扉?
Argus: A red door?

维尔汀： ……没什么，也许是我看错了。
Vertin: Nothing. Must've been my imagination.

214 号房间位于走廊的尽头，房门半阖着——房间的主人显然走得很匆忙。
As they approach the end of the hallway, they spot room 214. The door is slightly ajar—clearly Stefen left in a hurry.

蓝手帕旅馆·214 房
Room 214, Tuesday's Motel

她们进入了史蒂文的房间，厚重的窗帘紧封着窗户。室内昏沉而寂静，房间里飘浮着一种醉酒后的酸臭味。
They enter. The thick curtains are pulled shut, blocking out almost all the light from outside. They're hit with the stale, sour smell of old alcohol.

阿尔古斯眼中的辉光不断地闪烁着，如同接触不良的电路。
The glow in Argus's eye flickers like a light with a faulty circuit.

维尔汀： 你的眼睛还好吗?
Vertin: Are you alright? Can you still see?

阿尔古斯： 噢，不用担心，常有的事。
Argus: Don't worry about it. Ain't the first time this has happened.

阿尔古斯： 我们这一支的神秘学家都是这样，靠眼睛为生，自然会存在用眼过度的问题。
Argus: This eye issue runs in the family. It's the price we pay for having our arcane power.

雇佣兵简单地环顾了四周，室内的凌乱令她微微皱起了眉毛。
The mercenary glances around the room, a slight frown on her face.

阿尔古斯： 老板，你想让我找什么?
Argus: Now, what are we looking for, boss?

阿尔古斯： 一个人留下的痕迹有很多种，如果像无头苍蝇一样没有方向，就什么都找不到。
Argus: People leave all kinds of evidence behind all the time. It'll be like wandering around in the woods without a compass if we don't know what we're looking for.

阿尔古斯：如果不想被毫无意义的线索淹没，你得给我一个方向。
Argus: So, if you don't wanna be inundated with meaningless clues, you need to give me some directions.

维尔汀：我希望能找到有关于数羊羔的线索。
Vertin: Alright. First, I'd like to know what happened to Barbara.

维尔汀：还有……
Vertin: Second ...

似是而非的线索在脑海中浮现。
Fleeting images surface in her mind.

维尔汀：这里是否有重塑之手……或者是自称“启明会”的人来过，以及……
Vertin: Whether Manus Vindictae has been here, or anyone from that Order of Enlightenment. And last ...

维尔汀：史蒂文先生使用的是飞矢 M1903 式手枪，并且知道我与“真空弹”的关系——他应该是一名来自于芝诺的军官，军衔应当不低。
Vertin: About Mr. Stefen. The pistol he used was a Zeno military weapon, and he seemed to know about my relation to the vacuum bomb operation. It's likely that he once held a high rank within the Zeno military.

维尔汀：我想要知道，他为什么会来到这里，又为什么会在这里罹患癔症。
Vertin: I want to know why he came to this motel and what happened to make him lose his mind here.

阿尔古斯：在这里患上癔症？老板，或许他原本就是个精神病人呢？
Argus: "Lose his mind here"? What makes you think he wasn't crazy already?

维尔汀：……实际上，相较于人类的军事机构，芝诺会更加重视军士的精神问题。
Vertin: Zeno pays much more attention to its soldiers' mental well-being than any conventional military organization.

维尔汀：——毕竟有相当一部分的军士有着神秘学家的血统，这既是超凡的根源，也是不稳定的因素。
Vertin: It's because quite a few of them are arcanists. They're both Zeno's strength and weakness.

维尔汀：所以，我更倾向于认为，史蒂文先生是在进入旅馆之后，才患上了癔症。
Vertin: So I'm inclined to think Mr. Stefen developed these mental health issues after entering the motel.

阿尔古斯：行吧，我得承认我不了解这些军事机构。
Argus: Huh, is that so? I gotta say, I don't know much about all this military institution stuff.

阿尔古斯：一，搜寻数羊羔的下落；二，是否有重塑之手，或者启明会的人来过；三，史蒂文是如何来到这里，又如何罹患病症……
Argus: Right, so here's the plan: first, locate Barbara; second, look for any signs of Manus Vindictae or the Order of Enlightenment; and third, find out how poor old Stefen lost his marbles.

阿尔古斯：当然，还有一件我自己的事……找到凯拉的下落。
Argus: And, of course, I've got my own business to deal with—tracking down Kayla.

雇佣兵开始对室内的痕迹进行逐一排查。
She starts to meticulously search the room.

阿尔古斯：噢，老板，有新发现。
Argus: Hey, boss! I've got something.

一道明晰的行迹，嵌于灰尘之中。
There's a series of small but clear traces imprinted in the dust.

阿尔古斯：这是蜘蛛的足迹，它来回地徘徊于一侧，对于当下的情景来说没什么价值，但也是个异常的线索——您觉得，蜘蛛会打电话吗?
Argus: These footprints are from a spider. Looks like the little guy went back and forth along here quite a few times. I know this might not seem pertinent to our investigation, but it is worth noting. You ever seen a spider make a phone call?

维尔汀：……阿尔古斯，我现在并不想了解蜘蛛的习性。
Vertin: I'm afraid I'm not interested in the movements of spiders right now.

雇佣兵耸了耸肩。
Argus shrugs.

阿尔古斯：好吧，老板——你看起来有些过于紧张了。
Argus: Come on, boss, loosen up a little.

滴答，滴答……
drip-drip

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

回荡的水滴声在不远处响起。
The sound of dripping water echoes nearby.

维尔汀：你听到了响声吗?
Vertin: Do you hear that? Sounds like dripping water.

滴答，滴答，滴答……
drip-drip-drip

伴随着水滴的声响，一片洇湿的水渍正于墙纸上扩散。
With every drip, a water stain grows larger and larger on the wallpaper.

阿尔古斯：只是水而已，这家旅馆的管道系统就是这样，不是什么值得惊讶的事。
Argus: I'm sure it's just the motel plumbing.

维尔汀：可是……
Vertin: But ...

墙上的水渍逐渐洇成了手掌的形状，五指俱全。
The stain gradually takes the form of a hand, its five fingers all clearly defined.

维尔汀：——小心!
Vertin: Watch out!

那只手掌赫然地拍了下来——
Suddenly, the hand pulls itself from the wall and slams down.

维尔汀：……这座旅馆没有那么简单。
Vertin: This place is definitely more than meets the eye.

阿尔古斯：实际上我在之前也发现了这一点……
Argus: I'm with you on that.

阿尔古斯：这儿有着过于浓厚的神秘学氛围，我从来没有在别的旅馆中看到过这样多的术阵。
Argus: There's just too much arcanum-related weirdness going on here. Never seen so many arrays in a motel before.

维尔汀：……可是我们只看到了一个术阵。
Vertin: But we've only found one.

阿尔古斯：那只是您的房间。
Argus: In your room, yeah.

阿尔古斯：在其他房间中，术阵并不少见……最多的一间房，它从地板到天花板，都刻满了密密麻麻的术阵。
Argus: But there are a load more. One room has them drawn from floor to ceiling.

阿尔古斯：看起来像是……转化方面的用途？我并不了解术阵，也不清楚它们的用途。
Argus: Looked like some kinda transformation array to me. I ain't no expert, so, I can't say for sure.

维尔汀：……他们想要获得什么？
Vertin: What are they trying to do, I wonder?

阿尔古斯：谁知道呢。
Argus: Who knows.

雇佣兵简单地结束了对话，随即继续开始对房间的探查。
She brings the conversation to an abrupt end and continues searching the room.

阿尔古斯：噢，老板，你可能对这个感兴趣。
Argus: Oh, boss, you might be interested in this.

雇佣兵望向了床底。
She peers under the bed.

阿尔古斯：就是这样的图案。
Argus: It's another one. Just like the others.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

一个巨大的术阵横卧于眼前，周围散落着一些暗色的结晶。
A huge array lies beneath the bed. It's scattered with dark crystals.

似曾相识的图案。
The design is familiar.

维尔汀：我看过这个，就在那本羊皮手册上……
Vertin: I've seen this before. It was also drawn in that parchment notebook.

维尔汀：这的确是一个有关于转化的术阵……但它残破不堪。
Vertin: This is indeed a transformation array. But it's not in its full form.

阿尔古斯：他们在尝试什么东西，您瞧。
Argus: They were trying something. Check it out.

雇佣兵捻起了旁边的一根毛发。
She plucks a hair from the carpet.

阿尔古斯：这是吼狮的鬃毛……旁边还有许多神秘学的材料，但它们被磨得太细碎，我无法判断具体是什么。
Argus: This is hair from the mane of a howler lion, and there are some other materials around it, too. Not exactly sure what they are, though. They're too finely ground.

阿尔古斯：但毋庸置疑的一点是——有人在这里进行某种神秘学仪式，不知道出于什么原因，仪式并未成功。
Argus: But one thing's for sure: Someone held a ceremony here, and for some reason, it didn't work out for them.

维尔汀：这很重要……得及时上报基金会。
Vertin: This is important. The Foundation needs to know about this.

空气中一片寂静。
The air is silent.

维尔汀： ……阿尔古斯?
Vertin: Argus?

雇佣兵并未对这声呼唤作出反应，她正紧盯着自己的掌心——其上有一根栗色的发丝。
The mercenary doesn't respond. She's still staring at the strand of hair between her fingers. It's chestnut colored.

阿尔古斯： 还有凯拉的头发，她来过这儿！
Argus: This is Kayla's hair. She was here! In this room!

阿尔古斯： ……至少，有一位和她打过交道的人，来过这儿。
Argus: Or at least someone who came into contact with her.

还未等雇佣兵说得更多，房间里的电话忽然急促地响了起来。
The phone rings, cutting her off.

嘿，万圣节！ · 1/2
It's Spooky Time! · 1/2 THH-10

辽阔的远郊，有人在野地里弹起了吉他，哼起了二部曲式的调子。
A man lies in the grass just outside of town. He's strumming a guitar and humming to himself.

士兵： 哦，这样美丽且悠闲的夜晚，最适合在微醺之后，坐在原野之上吹风……如果能就此睡到明天……
Zeno Soldier: Ah, this is the life. A warm, beautiful night, a cold drink, and no one but me and the stars in the sky. Eh, maybe I'll just lie here till morning.

年轻的芝诺士兵醉眼迷蒙地躺在镇外的原野上，他对着闪烁的星空，高高地举起了手中的酒壶。
It's a young Zeno soldier, his eyes hazy from intoxication. He raises his flask to the twinkling stars above.

士兵： 多么好的酒，多么美妙的夜晚！噢，如果每天都能这样……
Zeno Soldier: A good night with good drinks! I wish every day could be like this.

一片人形的阴影笼罩在他的脸上——士兵虚焦的眼睛并不能分辨出那是谁。
A dark figure looms over him, but in his blurred vision, he can't make out who it is.

士兵： 嘿，你挡住我看星星了。
Zeno Soldier: Hey, buddy, you're blocking my view.

红弩箭： 哈……看星星?
Lilya: Huh? Are you stargazing?

听到了熟悉的声音，士兵眨了眨眼睛。
The soldier blinks. He knows that voice.

士兵： ……唔，小姐，有没有人和你说过……你的声音很像红弩箭中尉?
Zeno Soldier: Has anyone ever told you that you sound awfully like Lieutenant Lilya?

士兵： 就是那个驾驶着红色 38 的飞行女巫……你应该认得她吧？没有人能做出比她更好的飞行了。
Zeno Soldier: The rider of Red 38. Heard of her? No one can fly like her.

红弩箭： 当然。
Lilya: Of course.

士兵勉强聚焦了视线，一张似曾相识的脸庞出现在了他的面前。
The soldier concentrates, getting the figure's face a little more into focus.

士兵： 天哪——您就连长相都和中尉相似……
Zeno Soldier: Oh, my! You even look like her.

红弩箭：你如果再装疯卖傻，我就会让你知道红弩箭揍起人来是什么样子。
Lilya: Keep playing dumb, and I'll show you what it's like to have her kick your ass.

因酒醉而迟缓的眼睛终于在这一刻对上了焦，一张满是不爽的面孔赫然现于眼前。
The soldier's drunken eyes finally focus to see Lilya herself, a look of displeasure on her face.

士兵：——！
Zeno Soldier: ...!

年轻的士兵手忙脚乱地扔下了酒壶。
He stumbles to his feet, dropping the flask in his hand on the way up.

他试图用无力的手行个标准的军礼，但虚浮的步伐使他险些摔了一个倒栽葱。
He tries to salute, but almost falls flat on his face in the attempt.

士兵：红弩箭中尉，一等列兵安德烈向您致敬！
Zeno Soldier: Lieutenant Lilya! Airman First Class Andreas at your service!

所幸，他最后还是完成了那个七倒八歪的军礼。
Luckily, he manages to complete the wobbly salute.

红弩箭：你就是那个看守军备工厂的人？
Lilya: Are you the warehouse guard?

飞行员充满怀疑的目光在士兵的身上游移。
She looks at the soldier doubtfully.

士兵：是的！红弩箭中尉！
Zeno Soldier: Yes, ma'am!

红弩箭：……
Lilya: ...

很少有人会如此兴奋地承认自己的渎职，某种程度上，他的确拥有出类拔萃的勇气。
Few would so eagerly admit to the dereliction of their duties. In a way, he possesses exceptional courage.

红弩箭：那么，现在到你干活的时候了——我的红色 38 被寄到了这儿的军备工厂，我需要你帮我解开包裹上附着的重力术式。
Lilya: On your feet, soldier. My Red 38 is in your warehouse for maintenance, and I need you to remove the gravity ritual from it.

士兵：……重力术式？
Zeno Soldier: Gravity ritual?

红弩箭：如果你不明白我在说什么，就去找负责人过来——我必须得在今天拿到红色 38。
Lilya: If you don't understand what I'm saying, go get someone who does. I need it today.

他被酒精麻痹的神经滞涩地转动着。
在飞行员即将爆发的前一刻，士兵终于露出了恍然大悟的表情。
The soldier ponders, slowed by his inebriation. Just as Lilya is about to lose her patience, the soldier's eyes light up.

士兵：……噢，重力术式！
Zeno Soldier: Oh, right, the gravity ritual!

士兵：我知道您在说什么了，请和我一起去军备工厂吧！
Zeno Soldier: Yes, yes, I know! Please, come with me. I'll take you to the warehouse!

红弩箭：……你真的能解开那个术式吗？
Lilya: Are you certain you can undo the ritual?

士兵： 当然！军官们在撤离之前，特地培训了我好几次——您就放心吧！
Zeno Soldier: Yes, ma'am! They made sure I got the hang of it before they took off. Leave it to me!

红弩箭： 带路吧，士兵。
Lilya: Lead the way, soldier.

他们再次来到了那个工厂，巨大的木箱横亘于二人的面前。
They stand side by side in the factory, the wooden crate before them.

红弩箭： 打开它。
Lilya: Open it.

士兵： 噢——这个包裹。
Zeno Soldier: Oh, I remember this package.

士兵： 我拿到的时候，还以为是什么玩笑，或者是同名的军士——谁也想不到，您居然会到德克萨斯来！
Zeno Soldier: I thought it was some kind of joke, or someone with the same name as you sent the package. Who would've thought that you'd come to Texas yourself?

他喋喋不休地说着，飞行员的耐心正在飞速下滑。
He rambles on. Lilya's patience is coming to an end.

红弩箭： 士兵，我没空和你废话。
Lilya: Hurry it up, soldier.

红弩箭： 打开它，现在。
Lilya: Open the crate. Now.

士兵： 嗯，中尉，我理解您的心情，但是……嗝。
Zeno Soldier: Ma'am, I know you want to do this quick, but ... *burp*

士兵： 我没有解开这个术式的权限。
Zeno Soldier: I haven't been authorized to undo this incantation.

红弩箭： 如果你不能解决这个问题，那就找能解决的人来——不要让我重复第三次。
Lilya: If you can't do it, find me someone who can. I won't say it a third time.

士兵： 实话告诉您，除了我以外，您找不到别的人了。现在驻守在军备工厂的人，只剩下我了——
Zeno Soldier: Truth be told, there's no one else to turn to. I'm the only one left.

士兵： 为了让我干这活，他们还特地给我升了军衔——现在，我是个一等列兵了！
Zeno Soldier: I was made an Airman First Class to do this job. I was still in training before this, you see.

他骄傲地拍了拍胸口。
He proudly pats his chest.

士兵： 其他人要么接到了调令，回到了总部，要么就离开了这里……
Zeno Soldier: The others were either transferred back to headquarters or just left.

士兵： 我也不知道他们去了哪里。
Zeno Soldier: I don't know where they are now.

士兵： 不过，他们把这么重要的任务交给我，我相信以后一定还有更好的未来在等着我……
Zeno Soldier: But since they entrusted me with such an important task, I'm sure I have a bright future ahead of me.

在士兵连篇累牍的废话之下，飞行员的耐心正式宣布告罄。
Lilya's patience has officially run out.

红弩箭： 士兵，你只是没有解开术式的权限，而并不是没有解开术式的能力，对吗？
Lilya: You just said you aren't authorized, not that you don't have the ability, right?

红弩箭： 我现在给你两个选择。
Lilya: I have two options for you.

红弩箭： 第一，现在帮我解开术式。
Lilya: One, remove the ritual now.

红弩箭： 第二，被我狠狠揍一顿后，解开这个术式。
Lilya: Or, two, I beat your ass, and then you remove the ritual.

士兵： 其实……
Zeno Soldier: Well ...

红弩箭： 别废话。
Lilya: Choose. No more gibbering.

她晃了晃自己的拳头。
She readies her fist.

士兵： ……我选第二个。
Zeno Soldier: I pick the second one.

红弩箭： ……?
Lilya: Huh?

她发自内心地困惑了。
She is genuinely confused.

士兵： 哈哈……嗝，我可以帮您解开术式，但是这个行为不能是我主动、自愿发起的……
Zeno Soldier: Haha. *burp* You see, I'm happy to get rid of the ritual for you, but I can't do it on my own initiative.

士兵： 因为我现在还只是一个一等列兵……
Zeno Soldier: I'm only an Airman First Class. I can't make decisions about this stuff.

士兵： 所以，您的确得揍我一顿……以避免后续的审查——
Zeno Soldier: So, you have to beat me up to avoid future inquiries.

士兵： 不过——！等我以后得到了更高的军衔，我就能更好地帮助您了！红弩箭中尉！
Zeno Soldier: One day, after I'm promoted, I'll be able to better assist you, ma'am!

士兵： 您的飞行真是太棒了，我还特意做了剪报，贴在了我的……
Zeno Soldier: I mean, you're the best pilot I've ever seen! I even made a scrapbook of the reports on your flights.

话音未落，他的右脸颊已重重地挨了一拳。
Before he can finish what he's saying, Lilya has already clocked him.

红弩箭： 放心，我会掌握分寸的。
Lilya: Alright, no screaming, soldier. Let's do this.

显然，疼痛有助于醒酒。
Each hit seems to clear his head a little more.

当士兵的面孔无限地接近于猪头的时候，他的脑子忽然地清醒了。
By the time his face is completely swollen, he has snapped back to reality.

士兵： 慢着……我相信这已经达到了他们的标准！
Zeno Soldier: Stop! Stop! This is plenty to prove my innocence!

士兵： 现在，我来帮您解开这个术式。
Zeno Soldier: I'll undo the ritual now.

他蹲下了身，在木箱的周围进行了相应的动作——辉光流溢，木箱被打开了。
He squats down and performs the necessary movements around the crate. There's a flash of light, and the crate opens.

红弩箭： 这亮得像个闪光弹。
Lilya: Oof. You almost blinded me there.

她迫不及待地拿起了红色 38，金属冰凉的触感一如既往。
She eagerly grabs the Red 38 and feels the familiar touch of the cold metal in her palm.

红弩箭： ——谢了，一等列兵。
Lilya: Thanks, soldier.

红弩箭： 在走之前，有一件事情需要再向你确认。
Lilya: There's one more thing.

士兵： 请说，中尉！
Zeno Soldier: Yes, ma'am!

红弩箭： 这儿的人为什么全部撤离了？
Lilya: Do you know why Zeno pulled out of here so suddenly?

士兵： 唔……
Zeno Soldier: Hmm.

他眯起了眼睛，开始回忆。
He squints, trying to remember.

士兵： 听说是“上面”的指示。
Zeno Soldier: They said it was an order from "the top."

红弩箭： “上面”？
Lilya: "The top"?

士兵： 这就不是我能知道的了……据说是那个轰炸视频被泄露，伊戈尔上将发了大火——有人说和这件事有关。
Zeno Soldier: That's all I was told. But word is, it was because Admiral Igor got real mad about the video leak of the vacuum bomb.

士兵： 但这也只是传言。大部队还是撤离了，人少了以后，这儿逐渐变得奇怪……
Zeno Soldier: But that's just a rumor. Ever since the evacuation, strange things have started to happen.

红弩箭： 怎样的奇怪？
Lilya: Such as?

士兵： 最开始只是几个外乡人前来传教，说是一个名叫“启明会”的新兴密教……
Zeno Soldier: We started getting visitors from this group called the Order of Enlightenment.

士兵： 农民们不再去耕种田地，牧民也不再放牧牛羊。他们每日参加各种集会，期盼“受苦者”能够给予永恒的安乐。
Zeno Soldier: And now, the farmers have stopped tending their fields. The cattle and sheep have been abandoned in the wilderness. All the townsfolk do now is go to these gatherings, hoping that the Sufferer will bring them eternal joy.

士兵： 我不知道“受苦者”是谁，但想来应该不是一个好人。
Zeno Soldier: I don't know who this Sufferer is, but he ain't doing any good here.

红弩箭： 那些人驻扎在哪里？镇子的中心吗？
Lilya: Where do those people stay? In the town?

士兵：嗯……并不是在镇子里，离这儿有些距离，好像是……
Zeno Soldier: Mm. It's a ways away, I think.

士兵费力地回想着。
The soldier struggles to recall.

士兵：……是一个叫做蓝手帕旅馆的地方。
Zeno Soldier: A place called Tuesday's Motel.

红弩箭：该死的！维尔汀有危险——我得回去找她！
Lilya: Damn! Vertin! I have to go back!

流线型的金属机身泛着微微的凉意，一切都一如往昔。
She clasps the Red 38 with both hands, the cool grooves of the metal settling into her grasp.

红弩箭：好伙计，得出发了。
Lilya: Let's get out of here, girl!

说着，她以一个胜利者的姿态，骑上了红色 38。
With a victorious stance, she mounts the Red 38.

银白色的光芒划出一道弧线，如同一枚贴地飞行的流星。
飞行员驾驶它离开了工厂，随后消失在了漆黑的天幕中。
A silver light traces an arc in the sky as the pilot leaves the factory and disappears into the night.

士兵：中尉，请小心——
Zeno Soldier: Safe travels, ma'am!

年轻的士兵在她的身后遥遥呼喊，那声音很快被夜色吞没。
The young soldier calls out after her, his voice soon swallowed by the night.

短途飞行对她而言并非难事。
Short-distance flights are no challenge for Lilya.

在黑夜中，远处亮起的灯牌显得尤为清晰。远处树影憧憧，如同佝偻着的人形。
She lands near the motel, guided by its glowing sign. The shadows of the trees around it look like hunched human figures.

红弩箭：蓝手帕旅馆。
Lilya: Tuesday's Motel.

飞行员锁定了目标，准备向前走去，忽然有什么东西，在后面轻轻地拍了拍她的肩膀。
She locks onto her destination and is about to proceed when she feels something tap her on the shoulder from behind.

???：您好，请问可以搭便车吗？
???: Hello, can you give me a ride?

红弩箭：我载不了你，找别人吧。
Lilya: I can't help you. Ask someone else.

???：……我可以搭便车吗？
???: Can you give me a ride?

红弩箭：——我说了，我载不了你！
Lilya: I said I can't help you!

重复的问题让飞行员不耐烦了起来，她转过头，却当场愣在了原地。
The repeated questions are getting on her nerves. She swivels around, ready to give the questioner a piece of her mind, but freezes on the spot.

面前的人——她应当是一个姑娘，穿着数年前流行的裙子，整张脸却像水泥一样被抹平了。
There's a girl wearing an out-dated outfit. Her face has no discernible features, like it's been smoothed over with cement.

???: 噢……那您可以给我一块儿巧克力吗?
???: Oh, can I have some chocolate?

无脸的女孩展示着一张糖果的包装纸。
The faceless girl holds out a candy wrapper.

???: 不久前，我遇到了一位好心人……他请我吃了一颗巧克力，我从来没有吃过这样美味的糖果……
???: I met a kind man who gave me some chocolate. I've never tasted anything so sweet.

红弩箭: 见鬼了！你离我远点!
Lilya: The hell—stay away from me!

???: 给我，给我……把那颗糖果……给我……我要更多……
???: Can I? Can I have that candy? More. I want more.

无脸的女孩忽然裂开了嘴，露出了口中如同剃刀一样锋利的牙齿。
She opens her mouth wide, revealing a row of razorsharp teeth.

红弩箭: *的，别找我要糖了，我可不想过万圣节!
Lilya: Stop asking me for candy. This isn't Halloween, idiot!

纪律，纪律
Discipline, Discipline 小径

问责记录
Accountability Record

简中
记录日期：1990 年 9 月 20 日
记录人：副官 莫莉德尔
记录事项：伊戈尔将军近期行为摘要

本周伊戈尔将军对三名下属进行了问责和处理，情况如下：

上尉 L.哈里斯：
事由：在训练期间指挥不力，导致演习结果不达标。
处理：严厉警告，调离现职岗位。

中士 K.罗德里格斯：
事由：违反军纪，私自离岗。
处理：记大过一次，罚禁闭三天。

中尉 J.戴维斯：
事由：未能及时完成预定任务。
处理：严厉警告，并增派人员协助调查。
——泄密者可以确定是史蒂文·加西亚。泄密内容：真空弹视频?

记录完毕。

私人备忘：
毫无疑问，将军的严厉措施旨在整顿军纪。我们需要确保每位军官和士兵严格履行职责，保持高标准战备状态。
部分军官认为他近期太过严厉→和他们谈谈

高层的看法→为将军安排一次会面
追踪目标“K”→德克萨斯州，等待报告
English
Date of Record: September 20, 1990

Recorded By: Lieutenant Moldir

Subject: Admiral Igor's Recent Actions

This week, Admiral Igor addressed the conduct of three subordinates and implemented the following measures:

Captain L. Harris

Transgression: Ineffective leadership during training, resulting in subpar exercise performance.

Admiral Igor's Action: Issued a severe warning and reassigned from current position.

Sergeant K. Rodriguez

Transgression: Breach of military discipline, unauthorized absence from duty.

Admiral Igor's Action: Gave a severe reprimand and imposed three days of confinement.

Lieutenant J. Davis:

Transgression: Failure to complete assigned tasks within the designated timeframe.

Admiral Igor's Action: Issued a severe warning and assigned additional personnel to assist with the investigation.

The source of the leak has been identified as Stefen Garcia. Leaked content: Vacuum bomb explosion footage?

End of record.

Notes to self:

It is evident that the admiral's stringent measures are aimed at reinforcing military discipline. We must ensure that every officer and soldier adheres strictly to their duties and maintains a high level of readiness.

Some officers believe he has been excessively harsh recently—discuss this with them.

High command's perspective—arrange a meeting for the admiral.

Tracking target "K"—Texas, awaiting scout report.

小镇故事
Small Town Tales 小径

皮面日记本
Leather-bound Diary

简中
2 月 5 日
　　真是怪事，皮尔斯一大清早就回来了，吓得屁滚尿流，我没见过这小子这么害怕过。他在镇子里猛踩油门，到家门口才停下，就像被什么东西追着一样。这个疯子差点撞死玛丽塔的小斗牛犬！
　　鬼知道他遇见了什么。

2 月 15 日

鸟叫了整整一夜，我从来没见过这么大一群鸟。该死，这些家伙吵得我几乎没睡着觉。

露丝被吓着了，她认为这是某种征兆。可笑。

不过这群长嘴巴的家伙居然不怕猎枪，我朝它们开了一枪，但没几只鸟飞走。

摩根神父建议找个驱鸟队，如果大城市里真有这种玩意的话。但我还是认为大家一起开枪最管用，不是吓跑它们，而是一劳永逸。

3 月 27 日

一个噩梦，很真实，尽管我现在不记得它是什么了。

露丝也吓醒了，我安抚了她，噩梦而已。

3 月 30 日

皮尔斯没从休斯顿回来，但是警察来了。他们说，皮尔斯在休斯顿的雇主报案，认为这小子带着钱跑路了。

听起来像这小滑头会做的事。

4 月 10 日

鸟叫，又是整整一夜鸟叫。拉开窗帘时我以为我在做梦，但这是真的。鸟遮住了日光。

简直是个现实中的噩梦。

4 月 12 日

鸟群散去了。

所有人都看起来怪怪的，我很久没见过玛丽塔遛狗了，露丝为一点小事便哭个不停，令人心慌。

4 月 17 日

约翰尼回到了镇上，看起来像是被魔鬼吃掉了魂儿。他狂奔、咆哮，然后忽然在草坪上抱头哭泣，请求什么东西放过他。

摩根神父来了，但是面色很奇怪。

我听见了约翰尼在说什么，他一个劲儿地念叨“旅馆”。

5 月 13 日

我和房产经纪人谈了谈。没错，我第一次考虑要不要离开这儿，换一个地方，换一个房子。

我说不上来为什么，但这是一种……直觉？也许换一个地方，我能呼吸得更放松一点。

English

February 5th

Well, ain't that odd? Pierce came back early this morning, scared out of his mind. I had never seen the kid so freaked out. He sped through town and only slammed on the brakes when he got to the front door, as if something was chasing him. That nut almost ran over Marita's little bulldog!

Only God knows what he ran into.

February 15th

The birds were chirping the whole night long. I had never seen so many of them gathered together. Oh boy, they were so noisy; I barely slept a wink.

Ruth was scared, she thought it was some kind of omen. What a joke.

Those long-beaked birdies weren't afraid of shotguns, that's for sure. I fired a shot at them, but only a few got spooked enough to fly away.

Father Morgan suggested hiring a "bird control team"—if such a thing exists in the big city,

that is. But I still think we should assemble all the gun users in the town and kill all those birds once and for all, rather than scare them off.

March 27th

Had a nightmare, a very vivid one, though I can't for the life of me remember what it was all about now.

Ruth woke up scared too; I comforted her. It was just a nightmare, nothing more.

March 30th

Pierce didn't come back from Houston, but the police sure did. They said Pierce's employer in Houston reported him missing, thinking he ran off with their money.

I wouldn't put it past that sly fox.

April 10th

All night long, the birds were making that racket again. When I pulled back the curtains in the morning, I thought I was still dreaming, but it was real. There were so many birds they were blocking out the sun.

It was like a waking nightmare.

April 12th

The birds scattered.

Everyone looked kind of strange. It had been ages since I saw Marita walking her dog, and Ruth started bawling over the most trivial things. It's unnerving.

April 17th

Johnny's back in town, looking like his soul got swallowed up by the devil. I saw him running, screaming like a madman, then he just collapsed on the lawn all of a sudden, crying and begging for something to spare him.

Father Morgan came, but he had this strange look about him.

I heard what Johnny was saying. He was mumbling on and on about a "motel."

May 13th

I talked to a realtor. Yeah, it's come to that—I'm finally thinking about moving.

Why? I don't know. I guess you could call it a ... gut feeling? Maybe my mind can be eased a bit somewhere new.

嘿，万圣节！ · 2/2
It's Spooky Time! · 2/2 THH-10

红弩箭： 呼……呼……
Lilya: *pant*

蓝手帕： ……嘿。
Tuesday: Hey.

红弩箭： ——！
Lilya: ...!

飞行员在看清了来人的面孔之后，骤然放松了蓄势待发的拳头。
The pilot relaxes her poised fists when she recognizes the person in front of her.

红弩箭： 原来是你。
Lilya: It's you.

蓝手帕： 您刚刚是看见什么了吗？脸色这样的白。
Tuesday: Are you alright? You look pale.

红弩箭： ……不要在别人的背后突然出声，我有时会来不及收手。
Lilya: You shouldn't sneak up on people like that. I could've hurt you.

蓝手帕： 噢，抱歉……不过，既然已经到了旅馆，您现在可以不必这么紧绷着了。
Tuesday: My apologies. But you're safe now that you're at the motel. No need to be frightened.

“请勿打扰” · 1/2
"Please Do Not Disturb" · 1/2 THH-11

雇佣兵按下了免提键。
Argus presses the speaker button on the telephone.

电话彼端传来熟悉的敲击声。
A familiar tapping sound comes from the other end of the line.

电话： 哒，哒，哒，哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap, tap, tap*

电话： 哒。
Telephone: *tap*

电话： 哒，哒——哒，哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap—tap, tap*

电话： 哒，哒——哒——哒。
Telephone: *tap, tap—tap—tap*

维尔汀： 求救。
Vertin: HELP.

电话： 哒——哒，哒。
Telephone: *tap—tap, tap*

电话： 哒，哒——
Telephone: *tap, tap—*

电话： 哒，哒——
Telephone: *tap, tap—*

维尔汀： Baa……羊的叫声?
Vertin: BAA. Is that the sound of a sheep?

阿尔古斯： 老板，你听出来了吗?
Argus: You noticed it, too, huh?

阿尔古斯： 这的确不是人打出来的电话——而是某种动物，或是昆虫。
Argus: Ain't no way that's a human on the other end. It's gotta be some kind of animal.

维尔汀： ……动物或昆虫?
Vertin: Animal?

阿尔古斯： 根据电话座机上爬行的声音，以及灰尘中的足迹——我想它的体型不会太大。
Argus: Based on those sounds and the tracks in the dust, I figure it's something small like a—

雇佣兵忽然停止了说话。
She stops.

阿尔古斯： 稍等，老板。
Argus: One sec, boss.

雇佣兵从口袋中摸出了一些东西，塞入了嘴中。
She fishes something out of her pocket and pops it into her mouth.

维尔汀： 苦目糖?
Vertin: Picrasma candy?

维尔汀： 如果使用神秘术已经让你感到负担，我们可以暂时休息一下。
Vertin: Using your arcane skill so frequently must be tiring. You should take a break.

阿尔古斯： 任务还没完成——远远没到休息的时候呢。
Argus: The job ain't done yet. Far too early to rest.

阿尔古斯： 不用担心，老板，这是代代相传的病症，从老阿尔古斯到小阿尔古斯，没有一个人能够逃脱。
Argus: Don't worry, boss. It's just a condition that runs in my family, no biggie.

维尔汀： 它的副作用是什么?
Vertin: What are its side effects?

阿尔古斯： 哈，老板，让一个雇佣兵把自己的弱点告诉你……我们还没有熟到这种地步吧?
Argus: Ha, boss. You expect a merc to reveal her weakness? We ain't that close yet.

阿尔古斯： 不过，可以告诉您的是，只要眼睛还在使用，这些副作用就会如影随形——所幸如今的科技足够发达，您瞧瞧。
Argus: One thing I can tell you, though, is that I suffer the side effects as long as my eyes are open. Luckily, I've got cutting-edge technology at my disposal.

她展示了手中的糖块。
She holds up the candy between her fingers.

阿尔古斯： 安全、高效——最重要的是，很甜。
Argus: They're safe, efficient, and, most importantly, satisfy my sweet tooth.

维尔汀： ……
Vertin: ...

维尔汀： 它不是糖，而是一种药剂——它应当在合乎医嘱的情况下使用，这一点你应该比我更清楚。
Vertin: They may be called candy, but they're actually medicine and ought to be used following medical instructions. You should know that.

阿尔古斯： 得了吧，老板，危险可不会在医生的预料之内发生。
Argus: Gimme a break, boss. What do doctors know about my life?

阿尔古斯： 它作为药剂，很合理地发挥了身为药剂的作用，一次次地救人们于险境，这还不够吗?
Argus: I use these candies whenever I need them. Ain't that the whole point?

维尔汀： 可是……
Vertin: But ...

她还想再说些什么，但雇佣兵却示意她噤声。
Argus motions for her to be quiet.

阿尔古斯： 嘘——你听见了吗?
Argus: Shh! Did you hear that?

维尔汀： ……什么?
Vertin: Hear what?

雇佣兵将话音放得很轻。
Argus lowers her voice.

阿尔古斯： 是心跳。门外，有人在偷听。
Argus: A heartbeat, right outside the door. Someone's eavesdropping on us.

咚、咚、咚。
Thump, thump, thump.

雇佣兵悄无声息地蹲下了身。
She crouches down.

咚咚、咚咚、咚咚……
Thump, thump, thump ...

子弹被塞入枪中，发出了轻微的响声。
With a faint clink, she loads her shotgun.

咚咚咚咚咚咚咚咚咚咚……
Thump, thump, thump, thump, thump ...

雇佣兵一把拧开了门把手。
Then she swiftly turns the door handle.

???: ——!
???: *gasp*

偷听的女孩儿差点随着敞开的门跌滚进来。
The eavesdropping girl nearly falls forward into the room as the door swings open.

阿尔古斯： 也许你需要花点时间解释——你为什么会在这里，金伯利女郎?
Argus: Care to explain why you're here, Ms. Kimberly?

阿尔古斯： 对你而言，这位史蒂文先生真的有这么大的魅力吗？即使在他已经死了之后?
Argus: Just how obsessed are you with Mr. Stefen, huh? Even now, after his death?

金伯利女郎： 啊……不，不是的！我只是在找我的玩具……它只是恰好，可能在……
Ms. Kimberly: Oh, n-no, it's not what you think! I was just looking for my toy, and it just so happens —

阿尔古斯： 玩具?
Argus: Toy?

阿尔古斯： 我不希望把枪口对准手无寸铁的人。但有时这种行为是很有必要的——因为人总是不见棺材不落泪。
Argus: You know, it ain't my style to point a gun at an unarmed person, but sometimes you gotta do what you gotta do. Especially when they're speaking with a forked tongue.

阿尔古斯：五。
Argus: Five.

金伯利女郎：我说了，我就是在找东西……
Ms. Kimberly: I told you, I was just looking for something.

阿尔古斯：四。
Argus: Four.

金伯利女郎：……天啊！你为什么不肯信我！
Ms. Kimberly: Are you joking?! Why won't you believe me?!

女房客急切地跺起了脚，地板咚咚地震颤着。
She stomps her feet anxiously, making the floor tremble a little.

阿尔古斯：三。
Argus: Three.

金伯利女郎：我、我没有……
Ms. Kimberly: I-I didn't ...

她闭上了眼睛，像是下定了决心。
She closes her eyes as if she has made a decision.

阿尔古斯：二。
Argus: Two.

金伯利女郎：……
Ms. Kimberly: ...

阿尔古斯：一。
Argus: One.

雇佣兵毫不犹豫地扣下了扳机。
She pulls the trigger.

巨大的响声在耳边炸开，金伯利的面孔一瞬间褪去了血色，她蜷缩起来，竭力让自己变成一个更小的东西。
The bullet flies past Ms. Kimberly's ear. Her face turns pale. She curls up, desperately trying to make herself smaller.

金伯利女郎：不要杀我，不要杀我……我什么都没有做……
Ms. Kimberly: Don't kill me. D-Don't kill me, please. I didn't do anything.

她的手指不受控制地颤抖着，黑色的趾爪从指尖伸出。
Her fingers tremble uncontrollably as black claws extend from her fingertips.

金伯利女郎：——！
Ms. Kimberly: —!

她惊讶地望着自己漆黑而锐利的指尖，急忙将它揣进怀里——随后惴惴不安地望向二人。
She looks at the claws in shock, quickly tucking them into her chest, then looks nervously at the two of them.

维尔汀：……在玛蒂尔达传回的报告中，也出现过“金伯利”这个名字。
Vertin: I saw the name "Kimberly" in Matilda's report.

维尔汀：我原本以为只是巧合。
Vertin: I'd thought it was just a coincidence. But now I realize it wasn't.

维尔汀：——你就是那位隶属于重塑之手的成员，金伯利女郎，对吗？
Vertin: Ms. Kimberly, you're a member of Manus Vindictae, aren't you?

金伯利女郎：我、我真的什么都没有做……那帮穿黑衣服的人只是告诉我，要我和一个同伴一起行动……

Ms. Kimberly: I swear, I didn't do anything wrong! All I did was follow my partner like the people in black told me to.

维尔汀：告诉我，那个同伴是谁?

Vertin: Who's your partner?

金伯利女郎：……

Ms. Kimberly: ...

金伯利女郎：我饿了，我一直很饿……我好羡慕你们，只要把食物储存起来，你们就可以在很长的一段时间里填饱肚子……

Ms. Kimberly: I'm hungry all the time, so hungry. Oh, how I envy the likes of you. You can store your food in so many ways.

金伯利女郎：木桶可以储存面包和水，谷仓可以储存粮食，牧场里则是正在奔跑的肉类和奶制品……而我的粮食却……

Ms. Kimberly: You have enough bread and water in your barns to last an entire winter, and your pastures are full of meat and dairy products. But my food ...

金伯利女郎：我保证，我只是想快点找到我的失物……

Ms. Kimberly: I promise, all I'm trying to do is get back what I lost.

维尔汀：别害怕，我们不会伤害你……只要你把那个名字告诉我。

Vertin: There's no need to be afraid. We won't hurt you, as long as you tell me the name of your partner.

女郎转了转眼珠。

Ms. Kimberly's eyes dart around.

金伯利女郎：如果我把她的名字告诉你，那你是不是会放我一马?

Ms. Kimberly: Um. If I tell you her name, will you let me go?

阿尔古斯：看你诚意咯。

Argus: That depends on your sincerity.

金伯利女郎：她……叫淑女格蕾丝……

Ms. Kimberly: Sh-She's called Ms. Grace.

维尔汀：你们来这里的目的是什么?

Vertin: What's your purpose here?

金伯利女郎：我当然不知道！那群穿黑衣服的家伙只是让我听格蕾丝的话……但来到这里以后，她也没让我做过什么事儿……

Ms. Kimberly: I don't know! Those people in black told me to follow Ms. Grace's orders, but she hasn't asked me to do anything since we got here.

金伯利女郎：那个小气鬼，肯定是背着我在做什么——不过我不在乎！我只想吃饭！

Ms. Kimberly: She must be hiding something from me, but I couldn't care less! I just want to eat!

女郎言辞恳切，另一只手却从口袋里掏出了什么。

She speaks earnestly, but her other hand pulls something out of her pocket.

维尔汀：——!

Vertin: ...!

金伯利女郎：嘿嘿。

Ms. Kimberly: Heh heh.

女郎露出了狡黠的笑容，抬手捏爆了手中的道具，漆黑的烟雾四处蔓延。
She gives a sly smile and crushes the item in her hand, releasing a veil of thick black smoke.

金伯利女郎： 讨厌鬼，你们连我的衣角都抓不住！还想抓住我呢，做白日梦！
Ms. Kimberly: You annoying little brats can catch me in your dreams!

维尔汀： 是传送仪式——阿尔古斯，帮帮我！不能让她逃走！
Vertin: She's casting a teleport ritual. Argus, your assistance! We can't let her get away!

按需购买
Necessary Buys 小径

旅馆采购清单
Motel Shopping List

简中
1989 年 8 月
买入：
蓝雀咖啡豆 5 磅（附咖啡滤纸）
河谷牌床单 15 套 ——消耗太快，想想办法
二手电视 1 台 ——低价处理，“闹鬼，偶有人影”，啊哈
卖出：
牛仔牌维修工具 1 套

1989 年 10 月
买入：
感恩节装饰品 1 套
山核桃园牌空气清新剂 1 打——血迹把戏太直白了，说真的。和“它”谈谈
“南方之光”灯泡 1 打 ——质量差，价格实惠，有用
鲜奶油 3 品脱——老斯图尔特农场出品，不错
下次买些糖果?

1989 年 11 月
买入：
德克萨斯小径牌糖果 5 盒 ——味道不错
金盏花沐浴露 1 打 ——香味太浓

1990 年 1 月
买入：
七星牌茶包 3 盒
农场新鲜牌黄油 15 磅
河谷牌床单 12 套 ——希望这批可以待久一点
卖出：
二手电视 1 台——一个小可爱，非常遗憾，但该说再见了
English
August 1989

Bought:

Blue Jay coffee beans, 5 lbs (with filters)

River Valley bedsheets, 15 sets—Going through these too fast, need a countermeasure.

Second-hand TV, 1 set—A good deal, "haunted, spooky shadows within," the seller said, hah!

Sold:

Cowboy brand toolkit, 1 set

October 1989

Bought:

Thanksgiving decorations, 1 set

Pecan Grove air fresheners, 1 dozen —Bloodstain trick is too simple. Need to have a word with "it."

"Light of the South" bulbs, 1 dozen—Pretty crumby, but affordable and useful.

Fresh cream, 3 pints—From Old Stewart's ranch, yum.

Maybe get some candy next time?

November 1989

Bought:

Texas trail candy, 5 boxes—Yum.

Marigold body wash, 1 dozen—Smells too strong.

January 1990

Bought:

Seven Star tea bags, 3 boxes

Fresh ranch butter, 15 lbs

River Valley bedsheets, 12 sets—Hope this batch lasts longer.

Sold:

Second-hand TV, 1 set—Sorry, darling, but it's time to say goodbye.

“请勿打扰” · 2/2

"Please Do Not Disturb" · 2/2 THH-11

砰——
bang

随着一阵散开的烟雾，金伯利女郎消失了。
In a final burst of smoke, Ms. Kimberly vanishes.

维尔汀： ……
Vertin: ...

阿尔古斯： 跑得倒挺快。
Argus: Tsk, she disappeared fast.

维尔汀： 至少现在我们可以得出一些结论。
Vertin: At least now we can draw some conclusions.

维尔汀：是重塑之手盯上了这座旅馆——我想，也许“启明会”正是他们的化名。
Vertin: Manus Vindictae has set their eyes on this motel.

维尔汀：有一段时间，他们把这里当成了据点，并且进行了一些失败的术式尝试，但最终撤离了。
Vertin: Under the name of the Order of Enlightenment, they used this place as a base and conducted some failed ritual experiments before they left.

阿尔古斯：重塑之手，我听说过他们的名字，那个臭名昭著的神秘学家团体……
Argus: Manus Vindictae. I've heard of them. That infamous group of arcanists.

雇佣兵在此刻显得忧心忡忡。
She looks worried.

阿尔古斯：如果凯拉落到他们的手里……
Argus: If Kayla falls into their hands ...

阿尔古斯：——一定不会有什么好结果，对吗?
Argus: Things won't turn out well, will they?

维尔汀：别担心，他们一般只招徕纯血神秘学家。
Vertin: I wouldn't worry too much. They usually only target pure-blooded arcanists.

阿尔古斯：……噢，那就太好了。我敢保证，凯拉的父母都是纯得不能再纯的人类。
Argus: Alright, that's a relief. Kayla's bloodline is a hundred percent human.

维尔汀：不过，既然是重塑之手来到了这儿……
Vertin: But why would Manus Vindictae choose to come here specifically?

维尔汀：——他们的目的是什么?
Vertin: What are they trying to do?

蓝手帕旅馆·外围
Entrance, Tuesday's Motel

夜幕中的原野，对话还在继续。
The conversation continues under the neon lights of the motel.

蓝手帕：我担心您夜里找不到路，特意点了门廊的灯。您瞧瞧，灯一亮，这些蛾子都飞了过来，真是讨厌……
Tuesday: I was worried you wouldn't be able to make your way back, so I lit the porch light for you. Oh, but how annoying that these moths keep fluttering around.

红弩箭：少废话。
Lilya: Cut the crap, lady.

红弩箭：维尔汀呢？带我过去找她。
Lilya: Where's Vertin? Take me to her.

蓝手帕：平时我不怎么点燃这盏灯……因为我的孩子从不迷路。
Tuesday: I rarely turn on this light. My baby never gets lost, you see.

侍应生淡淡地微笑着。
She gives a faint smile.

蓝手帕：但像您这样年轻又活泼的孩子，总是需要前方有一盏亮着的灯，对吗?
Tuesday: But a young, spirited child such as yourself always needs a light to lead the way. Am I right?

蓝手帕：对于疲累的旅客而言，这盏灯意味着一家旅馆；对于孩子而言，这盏灯意味着母亲；而对于您而言……这盏灯又意味着什么?
Tuesday: To the weary traveler, this light is a shelter; to a child, it's a mother; and to you? What does this light mean to you?

侍应生的面孔泛着潮红。
The maid's face flushes red.

蓝手帕：无论如何，人们都需要这样的一盏灯，以摆脱身后紧追不舍的恐惧，对吗？
Tuesday: No matter who they are, people need a light to shine through the darkness—to chase away their fears. Don't you agree?

红弩箭：你是“启明会”的人？
Lilya: Are you a member of the Order of Enlightenment?

蓝手帕：“启明会”？
Tuesday: Order of Enlightenment?

蓝手帕：……噢，你在说那些讨人厌的客人。
Tuesday: Oh, you mean those troublesome guests.

红弩箭：客人？
Lilya: Guests?

侍应生并未理会她的疑问，只是自顾自地说了下去。
The maid ignores her question and continues talking to herself.

蓝手帕：我不喜欢他们，他们总是到处写写画画，把布置好的房间弄得一团乱麻——甚至还弄疼了我的孩子……
Tuesday: I don't like them one bit. They've scribbled all over the place and made a mess of the rooms. They hurt my baby!

蓝手帕：噢……别怕，别怕，我的孩子……
Tuesday: Oh, my poor baby. Shh. Don't be scared. Everything's alright now.

她轻声地抚慰着襁褓里的孩子，用手舒缓地拍打着。
She gently comforts the child in her arms, patting the swaddling cloth softly.

红弩箭：他们还在这里吗？
Lilya: Are they still here?

蓝手帕：噢……当然，他们付出了我无法拒绝的报酬……
Tuesday: Oh, of course. They made an offer that I couldn't refuse, after all.

红弩箭：多少钱？
Lilya: How much did they pay you?

蓝手帕：哦呀，您果然还是小孩子。世界上当然存在着许多无法用金钱买到的东西……
Tuesday: Oh, you are naive, my sweet child. There are countless things in this world that money can't buy.

蓝手帕：就像旅客无法在恰到好处的时候买到旅馆的出现，哭泣的孩子无法买到母亲的怀抱……
Tuesday: A traveler can't buy the sudden appearance of a hotel at just the right time. A crying child can't buy the comforting embrace of their mother.

蓝手帕：哈……我也无法买到黑暗之中的那一份甜蜜与稠醇……
Tuesday: Ha. And I can't buy that thrilling satisfaction brought by sweet darkness.

侍应生近似于神经质的喃喃自语令她感到无比烦躁。
The maid's near-neurotic muttering is getting on Lilya's nerves.

红弩箭：——够了，我不想再听你说话。
Lilya: Enough of your endless rambling!

红弩箭：我不能再和你说下去……不能……
Lilya: I can't waste any more time talking to you. I can't ...

眼前的一切变得模糊，她隐约看见了侍应生似有若无的笑容。
With every blink, Lilya's sight becomes increasingly blurred. She can just about make out the maid's smile.

蓝手帕： ……哈。
Tuesday: Aha.

蓝手帕： …… ♪
Tuesday: ...♪

她柔声安抚着眼神涣散的飞行员。
She gently soothes the dazed pilot.

蓝手帕： 睡在床里，不要再想参与那些大人的事……这才是孩子该做的……
Tuesday: Sleep tight. Just leave everything to the adults. Yes, what a good child you are.

侍应生翻转了门口的告示牌，“请勿打扰”赫然其上。
She flips the sign on the door to "Do Not Disturb."

猎犬与姑娘
The Girl and the Hound THH-12

阿尔古斯： 他的药物清单也在这儿……噢，这应该是他的笔记?
Argus: Found his medication prescription, and, oh, is this his notebook?

雇佣兵从口袋中掏出了皱巴巴的纸条儿。
She pulls a crumpled piece of paper from her pocket.

阿尔古斯： ……哈，果然，老板。这个旅馆没那么简单，你看这封信，根本不是史蒂文写的。
Argus: Ha, just as expected, boss. This motel ain't what it seems to be. Ain't no way that letter was written by Stefen.

阿尔古斯： 这两种字迹，一种细长纤瘦，另一种活像个大老粗。瞎子都能看出来这是两个人。
Argus: Take a look. The writing in this letter is delicate and slender, while the writing in this notebook is total chicken scratch. Even a blind person could tell they're written by two different people.

维尔汀： 写信的人，并不是史蒂文——那么，塞信的人，也极有可能不是史蒂文。
Vertin: Stefen didn't write the letter. So it's very likely that the person who sent it wasn't Stefen either.

脑海中不期然地浮现出了侍应生的身影。
The maid suddenly comes to mind.

阿尔古斯： 还有……
Argus: And this ...

桌子旁有一沓装订在一起的纸张，她拿起了它。
She picks up a stack of bound papers from the table.

阿尔古斯： ……该死的，我讨厌数字。
Argus: Ugh, I hate numbers.

阿尔古斯： 维尔汀，你来看看这个——里面到底说了什么。
Argus: I'll leave this one to you, boss.

维尔汀： 这是一些账单，史蒂文先生把日常的花销全部都记在了这里。
Vertin: It appears to be Mr. Stefen's records of his daily expenses, along with some notes.

维尔汀： 包括香烟、酒精……还有大剂量的精神药物。
Vertin: Cigarettes, alcohol, and a significant amount of psychiatric medication.

维尔汀： 他认为自己的病情在恶化，每天都有幻象和幻听在折磨他，于是他不得不加大了药物的剂量。
Vertin: It says he was tormented by his hallucinations day after day, so he had to increase his dosage.

维尔汀： ……他说，他在这儿，看到了一个编号为 707 的房间。
Vertin: Hm. And it says he saw a room numbered 707 here.

阿尔古斯： 整个汽车旅馆只有两层，不可能有开头为 7 的房间——他有具体地描述这个房间吗?
Argus: The motel only has two floors. There can't be a room starting with seven. Did he describe it at all?

维尔汀： 他说……那是一扇鲜红的门扉，与周遭的一切都格格不入。
Vertin: He said the room had a bright red door that seemed completely out of place.

阿尔古斯： 也许是他的癔症又发作了。
Argus: Maybe it was just one of his hallucinations.

维尔汀： ……
Vertin: ...

走廊上一抹一闪而过的红色。
There's a flash of red in the hallway.

维尔汀： 不，这不是癔症。
Vertin: No, it's not that.

维尔汀： 除了 707 房间之外，他还看见了许多无法解释的怪象……例如走廊中的双胞胎、天花板上倒悬而下的头发……以及一个……
Vertin: He also saw all kinds of things: a pair of twins in the hallway, long hair hanging from the ceiling, and ...

维尔汀： 果然，他看见了数羊羔，却以为那是自己的幻觉。
Vertin: He saw Barbara but assumed she was another hallucination.

纸张上画着一只小小的羊头。
A small sheep's head is sketched on the paper.

维尔汀： ……这也说明了，数羊羔的确来过这个旅馆。
Vertin: This proves that Barbara's been to the motel.

维尔汀： 既然这样……
Vertin: Which means ...

蓝手帕： 不过，实在很可惜……我没有见过她。
Tuesday: Well, I'm sorry to say that I've never met an arcanist with the head of a sheep.

蓝手帕： 如果您需要的话，我可以帮您问问附近的农户……
Tuesday: I can help you ask around if you—

维尔汀： 她为什么要对我隐瞒这个消息……
Vertin: Why did she lie to me?

雇佣兵的声音打断了思绪。
Argus interrupts her thoughts.

阿尔古斯： 老板，这本账单里有你想要的东西吗?
Argus: So, did you find anything useful from the expense record?

维尔汀： ……我得去找那个侍应生。
Vertin: I need to talk to the maid.

阿尔古斯： 别急，我们还没搜查盥洗室。
Argus: Hold your horses. We haven't searched the washroom yet.

阿尔古斯： 这个地方通常藏了最多的信息——您看过《教父》这部电影吗？迈克·柯里昂就是在马桶的水箱里找到了那把手枪。
Argus: You should never skip the bathroom. Ain't you seen the Godfather? Michael Corleone grabs his gun from behind a toilet tank.

雇佣兵一边说着，一边推开了盥洗室的房门。
She pushes open the bathroom door as she speaks.

蓝手帕旅馆·盥洗室
Washroom, Tuesday's Motel

盥洗室的镜子前，摆满了燃烧未尽的蜡烛。
The bathroom mirror is surrounded by half-burned candles.

阿尔古斯： ……
Argus: ...

雇佣兵伸出手，拦住了他人前进的脚步。
She holds out a hand to signal a stop.

随后，她凑上前去，敲了敲镜面，铜制的镜框发出了铮然的回音。
She moves closer and knocks on the mirror. The copper frame gives a hollow echo.

艳如猛毒的浓绿在镜面中一闪而过，一张象牙般的面孔浮现在了镜面上。
A vivid, venomous green flashes across the mirror, and an ivory face appears in its reflection.

???: 阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯，你来找我了……
???: Argus, Argus. You've come to me.

阿尔古斯： ——!
Argus: —!

维尔汀： ……她认识你?
Vertin: Do you know her?

雇佣兵没有对这个问题作出反应，她的双目直视镜面，整个人似乎陷入了巨大的茫然之中。
Argus doesn't respond. Her eyes are locked on the mirror, as if lost in a daze.

阿尔古斯： ……
Argus: ...

???: 阿尔古斯……
???: Argus ...

???: 阿尔古斯……阿尔古斯……
???: Argus ... Argus ...

似有若无的声音在狭小的空间中回荡，如同一浪又一浪的海潮。
The faint voice echoes around the bathroom, like waves crashing repeatedly against the shore.

阿尔古斯： 这不可能……
Argus: It-It's not possible.

雇佣兵的沉默，令人衍生了一个大胆的猜测。
Argus's silence gives rise to a bold speculation.

维尔汀： ——她是凯拉?
Vertin: Is that Kayla?

阿尔古斯： 不，绝不是。老板，如果您亲眼见过凯拉，就能明白这绝不是她——这只是一个丑陋的幽灵，我想它的出现也许与这座旅馆浓厚的神秘学氛围有关。
Argus: No, there's no way that's her. If you knew Kayla like I do, you'd say the same. This distorted reflection in the mirror is probably a result of the excessive arcanum in this motel.

阿尔古斯： 一种类似于“血腥玛丽”的怪谈……这曾在当地很流行。
Argus: A ritual similar to Bloody Mary used to be quite popular among the kids in this town.

阿尔古斯： 如果在午夜照镜子，里面的幽灵会变成你朝思暮想的人——只要你回应了幽灵的话语，就会被它夺去灵魂。
Argus: If you look into a mirror at exactly midnight, the spirit within will morph into the shape of the person you desire most. But if you respond to the spirit's call, it will drain your soul from your body.

维尔汀： 我从未想过这是真的。
Vertin: I always thought those were just myths.

阿尔古斯： 噢，曾经的我也是这样，见得多了就不觉得奇怪了。
Argus: So did I. But after all the strange things I've seen, I've become less surprised.

阿尔古斯： 这些幽灵以此为生，它们需要一种灵魂中的能量来维生。所以这东西很能诱骗人——要当心。
Argus: These spirits feed on the energy of our souls. That's why you should never trust a word they say.

阿尔古斯： 而那些被骗的人就没有那么好运了……他们会因此恍惚好一阵子，有的人甚至患上了癔症——您看看，史蒂文先生就是最典型的例子。
Argus: The people who are tricked by them fall into a kind of trance, and, some, like Mr. Stefen, go crazy.

阿尔古斯： ……不知道他在镜子里看到什么了呢?
Argus: I wonder what he saw in the mirror.

阿尔古斯： 不过，我与他不同。
Argus: Anyway, I won't repeat his mistake.

雇佣兵举起了猎枪，蓄势待发。
She raises her shotgun, ready to fire.

阿尔古斯： 对我们来说，最绝望的险境不是多么危险的场景，而是内心的动摇。
Argus: For mercs like me, the deepest despair ain't external danger; it's internal hesitation.

阿尔古斯： 如果面对这种幽灵，就会轻易地动摇——那我又有什么资格去保护别人呢？我们必须相信自己的判断……
Argus: If some pale imitation makes me hesitate so easily, then how can I claim to be able to protect others? You've gotta be able to stand your ground.

阿尔古斯： 罪犯会在获知死刑判决后，想尽方法地为自己辩白；间谍为了获取情报，披上一层又一层的皮……
Argus: A cunning criminal would use every excuse to defend themselves in court. And a scheming spy would wear all kinds of disguises to gather information on the enemy.

阿尔古斯： 所以我们只能相信自己……
Argus: That's why we've gotta stay sharp. When it comes down to it, we only have our own two legs to stand on.

阿尔古斯： 一个合格的雇佣兵，不需要对所谓的道德、善良、伦理去进行思考，那是学者们的工作。一旦我们对这些东西产生了怀疑，那也就离死不远了。
Argus: Mercs ain't philosophers. Once a merc starts pondering morals, justice, and ethics, they're digging their own grave.

阿尔古斯： 对我们而言，目标就是唯一的意义；过度的思考，只会毁了一个雇佣兵。
Argus: For a merc, the mission objective is the only thing that matters. Overthinking don't bring nothing but disaster and destruction.

阿尔古斯： 所以，她……它骗不到我。
Argus: That's why she—no, it—won't fool me.

她目光平静。
Her gaze is steady.

眼前似乎闪过了一幕幕久远的回忆。
Memories flash by, distant and playful.

在原野中的，嬉戏着的，追逐着的。
Laughing and running in those grassy fields.

阿尔古斯： 小凯拉是农场里的珍宝，每个人都那样地爱她。
Argus: The folks on the ranch adored little Kayla.

阿尔古斯： 他们爱她，如同爱护自己的眼珠子。
Argus: She was the apple of all their eyes.

阿尔古斯： 这样一个丑陋的东西，它怎么能……
Argus: How dare this ugly imitation!

她用力地给猎枪上了子弹。
She forcefully loads the shotgun.

阿尔古斯： 所以……
Argus: So ...

她站在了维尔汀的身前，将枪管对准了那面镜子。
She aims her gun squarely at the mirror.

阿尔古斯： 这就是我的回答。
Argus: Here's my response.

???: 好、好痛……
???: Urgh, i-it hurts.

???: 阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯，你来找我了……
???: Argus, Argus. You've come to me.

阿尔古斯： ……
Argus: ...

阿尔古斯： 所以说，干这一行的必须多长点心眼——您瞧瞧，这次就差点被骗了。如果幽灵们有业务能力的评选，我想它保准能拿个第一。
Argus: Let this serve as a reminder to remain vigilant. If there were a "Deceitful Spirit of the Year" award, I'm sure that would win.

反刍的胃袋
The Churning Stomach THH-13

维尔汀：史蒂文·加西亚，芝诺上尉，36 岁。
Vertin: Stefen Garcia, a Zeno captain, 36 years old.

维尔汀：出于一些我们所不知道的原因——极有可能与重塑之手有关，他入住了这个旅馆。
Vertin: For unknown reasons—likely connected to Manus Vindictae—he moved into this motel.

维尔汀：在住进旅馆之后，他曾数次尝试和芝诺联络，这些联络无一例外，没有成功。
Vertin: He attempted to make contact with Zeno several times, all of which failed.

维尔汀：这期间，他的谵妄与惊厥愈发严重，饱受幻象与恐惧的折磨。
Vertin: During his stay, he was tortured by increasingly intense hallucinations, delusion, and fear.

维尔汀：所以……
Vertin: And as a result ...

阿尔古斯：所以，他就在刚刚自杀了。
Argus: As a result, he committed suicide.

阿尔古斯：这就是线索告诉我们的内容。
Argus: And that's everything the evidence shows.

混沌的线索在脑中翻涌，如同一个正在反刍的胃袋。
Chaotic clues are rolling in the mind, like a churning stomach.

维尔汀：……不对。
Vertin: No.

维尔汀：我们一定忽略了什么重要的信息……
Vertin: We must've overlooked something.

维尔汀：自杀的军官、用摩斯电码传递的求救信息。
Vertin: A military officer killing himself; a phone call asking for help in Morse code.

维尔汀：还有……重塑之手和……
Vertin: Not to mention Manus Vindictae.

阿尔古斯：老板，你有什么结论吗？
Argus: Where's this going, boss?

维尔汀：……我们前来这家旅店，遭遇了许多无法用常理解释的事件。
Vertin: We've encountered a series of bizarre events, one after another, ever since we arrived at this motel.

维尔汀：房间里的术阵、发疯的军官、镜子里的幽灵、藏匿其中的重塑之手成员……
Vertin: The rituals in the rooms, the officer that went mad, the spirit in the mirror, and Manus Vindictae.

维尔汀：唯独有一个人置身事外。
Vertin: Only one person remains uninvolved.

阿尔古斯：你是想说，她是位于幕后的始作俑者？
Argus: Are you tryna say that she's the mastermind behind all this?

维尔汀：她理应是那个了解事件全貌的人，却处处显得一无所知——这本来就很奇怪。
Vertin: She should know more about all this than anyone, yet she feigns ignorance at every turn, which is suspicious in its own right.

阿尔古斯： 但这不会让她因此获得更多的利益。很显然，不会有客人因为撞鬼而赞扬她。
Argus: But what's there for a motel housekeeper to gain from all this? It's not like these spooky scandals would attract more guests.

阿尔古斯： 除非在她的幕后有其他的人……可这也说不通，不是吗?
Argus: Unless someone else is pulling the strings, but that don't make much sense either, does it?

阿尔古斯： 她任由这位军官在这儿发疯，也不去管重塑之手在这儿的行为……您觉得她是得到了谁的授意呢？某个更为庞大、更为神秘的组织吗?
Argus: When all these unusual things happened, she was happy to stand by and watch, but by whose orders? Some larger, more mysterious organization?

阿尔古斯： 得了吧。
Argus: Gimme a break.

维尔汀： ……假设她并不需要这些东西呢?
Vertin: What if she doesn't desire money or power?

阿尔古斯： 好吧，老板，那么接下来您是去找那位侍应生吗?
Argus: So what you're saying is that you need to ask Little Miss Maid a couple more questions.

维尔汀： 我得再去问问她。
Vertin: Precisely.

雇佣兵叹了一口气。
Argus sighs.

阿尔古斯： 这个幽灵既然能变化成凯拉的样子……我想它一定在某个时候见过凯拉——或者说，凯拉在某个时候来过这个房间。
Argus: That spirit morphed into Kayla, so it must've seen her face at some point. Which means that, at one time, Kayla was in this room.

阿尔古斯： 我得承认您的猜测有些道理，她的确不是一位符合常理的侍应生。您贸然前去并不是一个明智的选择。
Argus: And you're right. Tuesday's definitely not a run-of-the-mill motel maid. It wouldn't be wise to approach her rashly.

阿尔古斯： 因此，我建议，您最好等我查验完这儿的情况，咱们再一起去向那位侍应生问话。
Argus: Let me finish up here first, then we can go question her together.

维尔汀： ……好。
Vertin: Alright.

短暂的等待之后，雇佣兵失望地摇了摇头。
After a moment, Argus shakes her head in disappointment.

阿尔古斯： 什么也没有，老板。
Argus: Nope. I got nothing.

阿尔古斯： 去找那位侍应生吧……恰好，我也有一些问题想要问问她。
Argus: Let's go find that maid. I have a few questions for her myself.

她打开了门，随即愣在原地。
She makes her way across the room and opens the door. She freezes.

阿尔古斯： 尸体……不见了。
Argus: Where'd the body go?

原本横亘在走廊中的尸体不翼而飞，仅留下一摊飞溅的血迹。
The corpse that had been lying in the hallway has vanished, leaving only a pool of blood on the floor.

阿尔古斯： 这里没有拖拽和运输的痕迹，到底是谁……
Argus: Ain't no signs of dragging, neither. Who, and how?

电话： 叮铃铃铃铃——
Telephone: *ring-ring-ring—*

模糊的铃声再次从尚未合拢的门扉中传来。
The ringing echoes through the doorway.

阿尔古斯： ……又是电话。
Argus: The phone again.

阿尔古斯： 还去吗？老板，我猜那八成又是那些古怪的电话……
Argus: What do you think? Should we answer it? I bet it's another one of those prank calls.

维尔汀： 那不是恶作剧，是有人在使用摩斯电码求救。
Vertin: Those weren't prank calls. Someone was sending a distress signal in Morse code.

她拎起了听筒，按下了免提键。
She picks up the receiver and presses the speaker button.

???: ……您能告诉我，现在是什么时间吗?
???: Could you tell me what year it is now?

一个细细的声音从电话的彼端传来。
A soft voice plays through the speaker.

维尔汀： 哪位?
Vertin: Who's this?

???: ……我是数羊羔。
???: This is Barbara.

保佑她
May They Be Blessed THH-14

电话彼端的声音还在继续。
The voice on the other end continues.

数羊羔： 太好了，既然电话能够被使用，我想风的步伐也许还在附近游荡……
Barbara: Wonderful, I can talk over the phone now. The wind must still be wandering nearby.

维尔汀： ……别担心。
Vertin: That's good to hear.

维尔汀： 你是《UTTU》的编辑?
Vertin: Are you an editor for UTTU?

电话彼端的人松了一口气。
There's a sigh of relief.

数羊羔： ……是的，小姐，正如您所说。
Barbara: Yes, Miss, I am.

数羊羔： 不过，在对话开始前，您能告诉我现在是哪一年吗?
Barbara: But before we continue our conversation, could you please tell me what year it is now?

维尔汀： ……1990 年。
Vertin: ... 1990.

数羊羔：噢……我明白了。
Barbara: I see.

细弱的声音镇定了下来。
The frail voice steadies.

维尔汀：……数羊羔小姐，我要怎样才能见到您?
Vertin: Ms. Barbara, can I meet you in person?

数羊羔：见到我……?
Barbara: You want to meet me?

维尔汀：是的，我是隶属于圣洛夫基金会的司辰——基金会希望能够得知兀尔德的下落，故而派我来寻找您。
Vertin: Yes, I'm Vertin, the Timekeeper of the St. Pavlov Foundation. I was sent to ask you about Urd's whereabouts.

维尔汀：但目前，您的安全状况似乎不容乐观。
Vertin: But you don't seem to be in a favorable situation right now.

数羊羔：维尔汀小姐，这个房间隔绝了所有的联络，我听不到风的声音，无法得知兀尔德的下落。
Barbara: Ms. Vertin, I couldn't possibly locate Urd's whereabouts. The whispers of the wind can't reach this room.

维尔汀：……风的声音?
Vertin: The whispers of the wind?

数羊羔：是的，您可以理解为一种特殊的联络方式。
Barbara: Yes, it's a special form of communication.

维尔汀：我要怎样才能帮助您?
Vertin: Right. Well, is there anything I can do to help you rebuild this line of communication?

数羊羔：嗯……我先为您讲述一下当前的情况。现在，我能够确定的有以下几件事。
Barbara: Hmm. Let me first explain the situation to you. Here are a few things I'm certain of:

数羊羔：首先，这个旅馆并不是普通的旅馆，而是某种特殊的、具备超自然者般的生命力的存在。
Barbara: First, this isn't an ordinary motel. It possesses some kind of supernatural life force.

数羊羔：在入住旅馆前，我对附近的居民做过访谈，他们无一不提到了近几个月以来，在附近出现的都市怪谈。
Barbara: Before checking in, I interviewed some of the residents nearby. They all mentioned eerie rumors centered around the motel these past few months.

维尔汀：确实，我们在旅馆中也遇到了类似的情况——这是一个怪谈泛滥的地方。
Vertin: Yes, we've encountered some bizarre events here. Like real-life urban legends.

数羊羔：第二，我现在被困在一个红色的房间里。
Barbara: Second, I'm now trapped in a red room.

数羊羔：这个房间与你们同样地处于旅馆之中……但与你们的房间不同，它隔绝了一切信息。
Barbara: This room is in the same motel as yours. What's different is that it blocks all forms of communication.

数羊羔：我没有办法打开那扇门，也没有办法呼出电话。
Barbara: I couldn't get the room to open, and my voice didn't reach through the phone.

数羊羔：不过，一声枪响打破了这份无形的桎梏……在枪响之后，这个小房间猛烈地进行了一次收缩。随后，一切线路畅通无阻。
Barbara: That was until a gunshot broke this intangible restraint. This small room contracted violently, and now I can communicate with the outside world.

数羊羔：我最初还以为是某种地震，但随后，被压缩的空间又恢复了原状——我想这应该不能用“地震”来解释。
Barbara: At first, I thought it was an earthquake, but the contracted space soon returned to normal. Earthquakes can't do that, can they?

维尔汀：在这之前，您依靠蜘蛛来传递信息吗?
Vertin: Before this happened, were you using spiders to communicate with the world outside?

数羊羔：嗯，所幸这里有很多蜘蛛……我想，这应该与蜘蛛在都市怪谈中的泛滥有关。
Barbara: Yes, I was. As luck would have it, there are many spiders here. Thanks to the prevalence of spiders in urban legends, I assume.

电话彼端传来了翻书页的声音。
They can hear the sound of pages being turned from the other end of the telephone.

数羊羔：譬如说有许多人会忧虑“在头发中生存的蜘蛛”……实际上这是一个来源于 13 世纪英国的说教故事。
Barbara: There's some paranoia about "spiders living in hair." It originated in a sermon from 13th-century England.

数羊羔：“一位爱慕虚荣的信众总是在做弥撒的时候迟到，因为她花了太多时间来整理她的头发，结果魔鬼以蜘蛛的形式附着在了她的头发中。”
Barbara: A woman was always late to mass because she spent too much time styling her hair. Eventually, a devil attached itself to her hair in the form of a spider.

数羊羔：……是的，这些小家伙以它们的方式替我传递信息。
Barbara: Yes, they delivered messages for me in their own peculiar way.

数羊羔：我很担忧自己处于一个与外界隔绝的空间中，这会令我联想到某些不好的事……
Barbara: Being completely isolated from the outside world greatly unsettled me. It reminded me of that terrible phenomenon.

她轻轻地喘了几口气。
She takes a few light breaths.

数羊羔：所幸并不如此。
Barbara: Fortunately, that wasn't the case.

维尔汀：您并没有办法离开那个房间对吗?
Vertin: But you're still trapped in that room, right?

数羊羔：是的，它没有门，我无法离开。
Barbara: Yes. The door's gone. I can't get out from the inside.

维尔汀：那么，您当初是如何进去的呢……或者说，是谁带你进入这个房间的?
Vertin: How did you get in there in the first place? Or rather, who brought you into that room?

数羊羔：噢，还能有谁呢?
Barbara: Well, who else could it be?

数羊羔：是那个名叫蓝……蓝手帕的侍应生。
Barbara: The maid named Tuesday.

维尔汀：果然。
Vertin: Just as I expected.

阿尔古斯：……等等。
Argus: Wait.

久未出声的雇佣兵打断了对话。
The mercenary cuts in.

数羊羔：您是阿尔古斯，对吗？我还记得您的声音。
Barbara: You're that driver who left me on the road, right? I remember your voice.

阿尔古斯：……对，是我。
Argus: Yeah, it's me.

阿尔古斯：那之后我又折返去了你所停驻的地方，但你那时已经不见了。
Argus: I actually changed my mind and turned back to get you, but you were gone by the time I arrived.

阿尔古斯：——你在那时就到达了这家旅店吗？
Argus: I guess that's when you came to this motel, right?

数羊羔：嗯，蓝手帕看见了我，她邀请我前往这个旅馆。
Barbara: Yes, Tuesday saw me and invited me here.

阿尔古斯：噢……
Argus: Oh.

数羊羔：您想问些什么？
Barbara: Did you wanna ask me something?

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

阿尔古斯：您在这里，看见一个高约 5 英尺 3 英寸的女孩了吗？
Argus: Have you seen a girl of about 5 foot 3 here?

阿尔古斯：她穿着白裙子，一头栗色的卷发，眼珠子则是翠绿色的，手很小。
Argus: In a white dress. Curly chestnut-colored hair. Green eyes. Small hands.

数羊羔：……
Barbara: ...

数羊羔：也许我见过她。
Barbara: I may have seen her.

数羊羔：在我刚刚到达的时候，有这样的一个女孩从楼道上走了下来——
Barbara: When I first arrived, I saw a girl who matched your description coming down the hallway.

数羊羔：她挎着一个空空的篮子，我想她也许是去附近的镇子上购物了？
Barbara: She was carrying an empty basket. I presumed that she'd been shopping in the town nearby.

数羊羔：我记得她并没有退房。
Barbara: If I recall correctly, she didn't check out.

阿尔古斯：……谢谢。
Argus: Thank you.

她脱力地耷拉着肩膀，眼中的辉光虚弱地熄灭。
She slumps her shoulders, and the light in her eye dims.

她不再说话了。
She says no more.

维尔汀：我们该怎么找到那个房间呢……
Vertin: How can we find this room?

数羊羔：它很好找，就在走廊的一侧，编号为 707。
Barbara: It's just in the hallway, number 707.

数羊羔：那是一扇红色的门……
Barbara: Look for a door covered in red—

滴滴滴——
beep—beep—beep

阿尔古斯：……电话断了？
Argus: Looks like the phone got disconnected.

维尔汀：阿尔古斯，我知道了，数羊羔就在那个名为 707 的房间。
Vertin: So Barbara's in that room that Stefen saw. Number 707.

维尔汀：那么，接下来，你要去镇子上找你的凯拉吗？
Vertin: I'm going to find it. What about you? Heading into town for Kayla?

短暂的沉默之后，她再次开口了。
After a brief silence, Argus speaks.

阿尔古斯：我曾在走廊上见过一个奇怪的地方……侍应生的脚印围绕着它——那应该是一个被频繁出入的地方。
Argus: I did notice a weird spot in the hallway earlier. The maid's footprints were going back and forth, like there was an entrance there.

阿尔古斯：但我却没有看到任何的门。
Argus: But I didn't see no signs of a door.

雇佣兵用已上膛的枪管戳了戳头上的痒处。
She scratches her head with the barrel of her gun.

维尔汀：如果有一天你死在了你自己的枪口之下，我也并不会意外。
Vertin: I wouldn't be surprised if you died by your own gun one day.

阿尔古斯：哈，那可真是帮了我大忙。
Argus: Haha, that'd be a memorable way to go.

阿尔古斯：……开玩笑。
Argus: Alright, enough kidding around.

雇佣兵振作了精神。
She perks up.

阿尔古斯：那个侍应生并不想让我们知道数羊羔在这座旅馆之中——哈，可惜，百密一疏。
Argus: Our Little Miss Maid tried so very hard to hide Barbara from us, but I guess the lamb's out of the bag now.

维尔汀：情况已经非常明晰——走吧。
Vertin: Yes. It's all crystal clear now. Let's go.

阿尔古斯：等一下，老板。
Argus: Hold up a sec, boss.

她咬着嘴唇，露出了一副为难的样子。
She bites her lip.

阿尔古斯：你那儿还有多余的糖果吗？我的糖已经快要吃完了，这儿没有什么补给的手段。
Argus: Do you have any candies? I'm running on fumes here, and I ain't got no way to replenish my stash.

发出请求对她而言似乎是一件很困难的事。
Asking for help seems very difficult for her.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

她从口袋里掏出了几枚糖果，塞在了阿尔古斯的掌心。
She pulls a few pieces of candy from her pocket and places them in Argus's palm.

维尔汀： 很快我们就能从这里出去了。
Vertin: Us and Barbara will be out of here soon.

维尔汀： 我找到数羊羔，你也能找到凯拉。
Vertin: And you'll find some candy and Kayla in town.

20 世纪奇迹
20th Century Miracles 小径

实验报告
Experiment Report

简中
实验方法
经志愿者自愿捐赠，实验团队提取了女性神秘学家（基因母亲 A）的细胞核，与人类女性（基因母亲 B）的去核卵细胞；并对细胞核进行培养与处理，使其更易接受新的基因指令。在将供体细胞的细胞核注入去核卵细胞后，应用电脉冲方法，使细胞核与卵细胞质融合，启动细胞分裂，形成胚胎细胞。在此过程中，调整神秘学家与人类的遗传物质配比，使二者趋于相等。
在第 277 号实验中，胚胎发育良好，达到移植标准，在成型后移入芬兰多塞特白面母绵羊子宫内。

观察记录
0 月龄
实验体经由正常分娩诞生，神秘学家遗传物质占比为 60.05%，人类遗传物质占比为 39.95%，未达到预期的完全平衡状态，但仍证明了神秘学家的成年体细胞可通过克隆技术进行编程、调整。
在外观上，实验体呈现出基因母亲 A、B 的共同特点；同时，因未知原因，其头部与芬兰多塞特白面母绵羊高度相似，但大脑发育水平未受影响。
2 月龄
实验体发育速度缓于同期人类与神秘学家婴儿。出现轻微的肺部感染症状。
4 月龄
实验体发育速度缓于同期人类与神秘学家婴儿，但对音乐和人类语言有明显反应，对特定声音做出的反应较为一致。
肺部感染原因查明，实验体肺部检测出 JSRV 逆转录病毒，该病毒多见于长期室内生活的绵羊群体。拟引入动物医学团队商定方案。
6 月龄
实验体发育速度缓于人类与神秘学家同期婴儿，可能提前停止发育。
无菌室值班人员汇报，实验体开始有意识地模仿交流行为，符合预期。开始播放学习课程和品德指引录像带。
肺部感染加剧，实验体对化学纤维制品出现强烈过敏反应。
……
10 月龄
实验体能够进行初步交流，大脑发育程度良好。
经由多次试验，证实美式乡村音乐能够有效缓解实验体的过敏反应，原因尚待查明。
……
22 月龄
实验体在交流测试和智力测试中表现优秀，已具备相当于 7 岁人类儿童的智力水平。
23 月龄
骨骼检测表明，实验体将在 12 岁时完全停止身体发育。
English

Methods

Through the aid of voluntary donations, the research team extracted a nucleus from a female arcanist (Genetic Mother A) and an enucleated egg cell from a female human (Genetic Mother B). The nucleus was cultivated and processed to enhance its receptivity to new genetic instructions. After injecting the donor cell nucleus into the enucleated egg cell, an electric pulse was used to fuse the nucleus with the egg cytoplasm, initiating cell division and forming embryonic cells. During this process, the ratio of arcanist to human genetic material was adjusted to be nearly equal.

In Experiment No. 277, the embryo developed well, meeting the criteria for transplantation, and was implanted into the uterus of a Finn-Dorset ewe after formation.

Observations

0 Months Old

The subject was born through natural delivery, with 60.05% arcanist genetic material and 39.95% human genetic material, not achieving the expected complete balance, but still proving that the adult somatic cells of an arcanist can be programmed and adjusted through cloning technology.

In appearance, the subject exhibits characteristics of both Genetic Mothers A and B; simultaneously, for unknown reasons, its head is highly similar to that of a Finn-Dorset, but brain development has not been affected.

2 Months Old

The subject's development is slower than that of contemporary human and arcanist infants. Mild symptoms of lung infection have been found.

4 Months Old

The subject's development is slower than that of contemporary human and arcanist infants, but it showed significant responses to music and human language, with consistent reactions to specific sounds.

The cause of the lung infection was identified; the subject's lungs tested positive for the JSRV retrovirus, commonly found in sheep living indoors for extended periods. It was suggested that a veterinary team be brought in for consultation.

6 Months Old

The subject's physical development is slower than that of contemporary human and arcanist infants, and may stop developing prematurely.

Sterile room staff reported that the subject began consciously mimicking communication behaviors, as expected. Educational classes and moral guidance videotapes were initiated.

The lung infection worsened, and the subject showed a strong allergic reaction to chemical fiber products.

...

10 Months Old

The subject can engage in rudimentary communication, exhibiting good brain development.

Multiple tests have confirmed that American country music is effective in alleviating the subject's allergic reactions, the cause of which is yet to be determined.

...

22 Months Old

The subject performed excellently in communication and intelligence tests, possessing the intelligence level of a 7-year-old human child.

23 Months Old

Bone tests indicated that the subject's physical development will cease completely by the age of 12.

服务热线

The Front Desk Call THH-15

蓝手帕旅馆·红房间
Red Room, Tuesday's Motel

红房间的中心，摆放着一张雪白的婴儿床。
In the center of the red room stands a snow-white crib.

垂下的布帘微微摇晃着，如同正在跃动的血管。
The hanging curtains sway slightly, like pulsating veins.

羊首人身的神秘学家伫立于此，她正面对着那模糊透光的薄布，不发一言。
An arcanist with the head of a sheep stands there, silently observing the translucent fabric.

脚步声渐近，她没有回头。
Footsteps draw closer, but she doesn't turn to face them.

蓝手帕： 是我的招待还不够周到吗?
Tuesday: Are you not satisfied with my services?

数羊羔： ……
Barbara: ...

数羊羔： 无论如何，您都不该按断我的电话。
Barbara: No matter what, you shouldn't have cut the phone off.

侍应生略有歉意地收回了按在电话插簧上的手。
The maid withdraws her hand from the telephone's hook switch with a hint of apology.

数羊羔： 也不该隔绝我与外界的联络——尤其是您。
Barbara: Nor should you have isolated me from the outside world.

数羊羔： 因为您应该知道这意味着什么。
Barbara: Because you should know better than anyone what that means.

蓝手帕： ……为什么我会需要知道这些?
Tuesday: Why should I?

蓝手帕： 我只知道，一个这样小的孩子，不应该独自出现在这条公路的附近。
Tuesday: All I know is that a poor, helpless child like you shouldn't be alone on the roadside.

蓝手帕： 你的母亲呢？她没有告诉你要小心吗?
Tuesday: Where's your mother? Didn't she tell you to be careful?

数羊羔：……

Barbara: ...

她叹出了一口气。

She sighs softly.

数羊羔：……您的确什么都不记得了。

Barbara: You really don't remember anything, do you?

蓝手帕：在您看来，我应该记得什么？

Tuesday: What do you mean? What do you think I should remember?

数羊羔：噢，很显然，现在这已经不重要了——旅馆的陈设很不错，只有您一个人来打扫这些吗？

Barbara: Well, clearly, it doesn't matter now. This motel's well decorated. Did you do all this yourself?

侍应生露出了笑容。

The maid smiles.

蓝手帕：呵呵……我在想，是不是所有的孩子都是这样？总是故意说些颠三倒四的话语，来吸引母亲的注意力……

Tuesday: Heh heh. Are all children like this? Always talking in circles to draw Mama's attention.

蓝手帕：虽然总是被人一眼看穿，但那些童稚的话语总是可爱得让人心尖儿打颤……

Tuesday: Ah, but these innocent words make them all the more adorable.

数羊羔：……我不是孩子。

Barbara: I am not a child.

蓝手帕：哈……这也是孩子们常说的话。

Tuesday: Ha. That's exactly what a child would say.

数羊羔：……

Barbara: ...

她无奈地妥协了。

She yields helplessly.

蓝手帕：我总觉得您亲近又熟悉，好像在很久以前见到过似的。

Tuesday: I've always felt a familiarity with you, like I've known you for a long time.

蓝手帕：您能和我说说吗？您为什么独自留在了 77 号公路附近？

Tuesday: Can you tell me about it—why were you out here on Route 77 all alone?

蓝手帕：……也许我能帮上您的忙呢？

Tuesday: Maybe I can help you.

数羊羔：您听说过《UTTU》这本杂志吗？

Barbara: Have you heard of UTTU?

蓝手帕：噢！我知道……

Tuesday: Oh, I have!

蓝手帕：这是一本有关于时尚、潮流与先锋的杂志……

Tuesday: It's a magazine about fashion, trends, and the avant-garde.

蓝手帕：我的哥哥曾经很喜欢它，但父亲并不能理解这种喜欢——他认为既然是家里的长子，就应该去开农用机械，而不是阅读这种软绵绵的杂志。

Tuesday: My brother loved that magazine, but my father found it unacceptable—to think his eldest son would read those softies' magazines instead of working on the farm!

蓝手帕：待在家里看书，研究时尚、潮流、迪斯科。这可不是一个德克萨斯男人应该做的事情。
Tuesday: Fashion, trends, disco ... these aren't things a Texan man should pursue, at least according to my father.

蓝手帕：后来，父亲销毁了所有有关于迪斯科的唱片，连同哥哥那张前往洛杉矶的机票。
Tuesday: In the end, my father destroyed all my brother's disco records, along with his plane ticket to Los Angeles.

数羊羔：这很好，说明他成功地躲过了那场暴乱。
Barbara: Perhaps that's for the best. He avoided the riots.

蓝手帕：……什么?
Tuesday: Huh?

数羊羔：没什么，您对此有什么看法或者意见呢?
Barbara: Nothing. So, what do you think?

她将眼前的侍应生视作采访对象——怪谈背后的女主人，这是一次不容错过的机会。
She's treating the maid as an interview subject—the woman behind the legend, a chance not to be missed.

蓝手帕：我?
Tuesday: Me?

侍应生略感惊讶。
She looks somewhat surprised.

蓝手帕：我应该对此有什么见解吗?
Tuesday: Why should I have any opinion?

数羊羔：或者说，这对您产生了什么影响?
Barbara: Let me rephrase that. What impact has this had on you?

蓝手帕：噢……
Tuesday: Oh.

蓝手帕陷入了思考，随后她摇了摇头。
Tuesday ponders for a moment, then shakes her head.

蓝手帕：这事情与我无关，不是吗?
Tuesday: But what happened between them has nothing to do with me, does it?

蓝手帕：这都是他们自己所做的选择……
Tuesday: These were the choices they made.

她抿上了嘴唇，面孔红润。
She purses her lips, her face flushed.

数羊羔：在我刚刚到达这里时，有一位当地的居民说：不要去蓝手帕旅馆居住。
Barbara: When I first arrived, a local resident told me not to stay at Tuesday's Motel.

数羊羔：他的婶婶在那个旅店住过，回家后不久便发了疯。
Barbara: He said his aunt went mad soon after she stayed here.

紧锁着的窗户不断地震颤着，发出轻微的响声。
The windows rattle gently, emitting a faint sound.

蓝手帕：哈……我记得那位女士，她的头很大，总让我想起一些有关于畸形的怪谈……
Tuesday: Ha, I remember that lady. Her head was so large. It reminded me of those stories of people with deformities.

蓝手帕：所以我让她在深夜里“观看”了一场畸形秀，遗憾的是她似乎并不喜欢这些。
Tuesday: So I had her "watch" a freak show at midnight. Sadly, she didn't seem to enjoy it.

数羊羔：……
Barbara: ...

远处的收获机被启动了，柴油发动机的声音传入了室内。
A harvester starts up in the distance. The sound of the engine fills the room.

蓝手帕：这时节的农田，联合收获机一刻也不停地运作着。作物的收获是令人多么高兴的一件事，但与之相伴的噪音却总让孩子担惊受怕。
Tuesday: At this time of year, the farmers run their combine harvesters on the fields nonstop. The harvest is a joyful time of year, but the accompanying noise always frightens the children.

蓝手帕：您听过类似的故事吗？贪玩的孩子前往大型机械的附近，结果被卷入机械中，丢失了一只手，或是一个脑袋……哈……
Tuesday: Have you heard the stories? Of how naughty children get too close to harvesters and get caught in them, losing a hand or even a head, haha.

蓝手帕：我的旅馆里正好缺了这一类的故事——农田、机械、德克萨斯州、断手或断头的孩子……唔，身临其境的怪谈……
Tuesday: Fields, machinery, children with severed limbs ... Hmm, these stories are exactly what my motel's missing.

窗户的响声愈发焦灼。
The window rattling grows more frantic.

蓝手帕：啊呀，抱歉，孩子在叫我……如果我再不去，它恐怕又要埋怨我了。
Tuesday: Oh, my baby's calling. Please excuse me; I don't want another temper tantrum on my hands.

蓝手帕：抱歉了，软绵绵的小客人——我很期待下次与您的谈话……和您说话的时候，总有接连不断的好主意从我的脑子里冒出来。
Tuesday: Apologies, my fluffy little child. I look forward to our next conversation. Talking to you always brings me inspiration.

蓝手帕：但旅店最近的客人实在是太多了……多到令我有些讨厌。
Tuesday: But the motel's been too busy lately. It's starting to get on my nerves.

侍应生慢悠悠地说着，面孔上再次浮现了红晕。
The maid speaks slowly, her face flushed again.

数羊羔：咳、咳……
Barbara: *cough*

她虚弱地咳嗽着。
Her cough is weak, like a sickly child's.

蓝手帕：您瞧瞧，这样虚弱的孩子，我怎么忍心让您去别的地方……在您的咳嗽病痊愈之前，你尽可以在这个小房间里居住。
Tuesday: See, this is what I mean. How could I bear to send you out on your own? You'll stay right here in this cozy little room until you're fully recovered.

数羊羔：我不需要这样的偏爱，居住在小房间也不能治愈我的病症。
Barbara: I don't need this "special treatment" of yours. Staying here won't cure my illness.

蓝手帕：您先睡一觉吧，等精神放松之后，就再也不会有这些胡思乱想了。
Tuesday: Just get some sleep. You'll come to your senses after a good rest.

蓝手帕：……再见。
Tuesday: I'll see you soon.

侍应生踩着轻巧的步伐离开了房间。
The maid lightly steps out of the room.

在她离去之后，羔羊眼看着门扉从房间之中消失了。
Barbara watches as the door vanishes.

蓝手帕：……?
Tuesday: ...?

她望着走廊上残余的血迹，在不久之前，上面还有着一具军官的遗体。
She looks at the pool of blood in the hallway where the officer's body once was.

蓝手帕：我说过很多次，不要再捡地上的东西吃……
Tuesday: How many times have I told you not to eat things off the floor?

???：呜哇……
???: *cry*

怀中的襁褓忽然发出古怪的哭声。
The bundle in her arms suddenly lets out a strange cry.

蓝手帕：好了，别再哭了……
Tuesday: There, there. Don't cry, sweetheart.

苦目糖
Picrasma Candy THH-16

维尔汀：……就是这儿?
Vertin: Is this the spot?

阿尔古斯：就是这儿。
Argus: Sure as shooting.

眼前的走廊与他处别无二致。
The hallway looks identical to any other.

阿尔古斯：看这些脚印……
Argus: Look, these footprints.

阿尔古斯：这是在十分钟之内留下的脚印。
Argus: They're less than ten minutes old.

维尔汀：……可是我们没有看到 707 的房门。
Vertin: But where's the door to room 707?

维尔汀：我能感受到这附近有一些能量的扰动……但这绝不是出于神秘术。
Vertin: I can sense some energy fluctuations nearby, but they're definitely not from arcane skills.

她将掌心贴上了墙壁。
She presses her palm against the wall.

维尔汀：除了神秘术，还有什么能让这些能量如此的焦灼……
Vertin: What else could produce such intense energy?

蓝手帕：……噢，两位，请问有什么能够帮助您的吗?
Tuesday: Oh, can I help you with something?

毫无预兆地，侍应生的声音在身后响起。
The maid's voice comes unexpectedly from behind them.

阿尔古斯：……蓝手帕小姐，我有一个问题想问问你。
Argus: Ms. Tuesday, I've got a question for you.

雇佣兵紧紧地盯着侍应生，目光灼灼，如同猎人终于追寻到了猎物的血迹。
She stares intently at the maid, her gaze sharp as if she's finally caught the scent of her prey.

阿尔古斯：你知道那个 707 房间该怎么走吗?
Argus: Do you know how to get to room 707?

蓝手帕：707?
Tuesday: 707?

阿尔古斯：……是的——我想，我要找的东西也许就在那个房间里。
Argus: Yup. What I've been looking for might just be in that room.

蓝手帕：嗯……我乐于满足客人的要求，客房服务或是更换房间，只要是我能做到的，我一向不吝于帮助。
Tuesday: Hmm. I'm usually more than happy to satisfy the requests of my guests, as long as it's within my power.

蓝手帕：但您的要求过界了——那不是您该去的地方。
Tuesday: But this one crosses the line.

阿尔古斯：……很可惜，看来我们的谈判破裂了。
Argus: Shame. Looks like negotiations are over.

阿尔古斯：瞬息之后，又见星光。
Argus: And thence we came forth to see again the stars.

她的眼睛里再次燃烧起了蓝绿色的辉光。
After a brief moment, a glimmer of emerald light reignites in her eye.

蓝手帕：……这样频繁地施展神秘术，对您的眼睛并不好。
Tuesday: Using arcane skills so frequently is bad for your eyes.

蓝手帕：您的长辈没有告诉过您吗?
Tuesday: Didn't your family ever tell you that?

侍应生的声音中不无担忧。
Her voice carries genuine concern.

阿尔古斯：所以你什么都知道。
Argus: So you knew what we were doing all along.

蓝手帕：哈，您这样大张旗鼓地动作，当然会让所有人都知道……
Tuesday: Ha, of course. You weren't exactly subtle in your actions. What did you expect?

蓝手帕：这就是您的极限……
Tuesday: But you've reached your limit now.

蓝手帕：三。
Tuesday: Three.

阿尔古斯：……什么?
Argus: What's that supposed to mean?

蓝手帕：二。
Tuesday: Two.

阿尔古斯：该死的，我知道，故弄玄虚向来是你的拿手好戏……
Argus: Tsk, screw this. Your mind games won't work on me.

蓝手帕：一。
Tuesday: One.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

雇佣兵眼中的辉光在一瞬间熄灭。
The light in the mercenary's eye goes out in an instant.

她的眼睛微微睁大，随后打破了四周如水般的沉默。
Her eyes widen.

阿尔古斯：……灯怎么熄灭了？
Argus: Huh? Who turned the lights off?

蓝手帕：……
Tuesday: ...

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

走廊之中的灯光一如往常。
The hallway lights are as bright as ever.

蓝手帕：……灯一直亮着。
Tuesday: The lights are still on, dear.

阿尔古斯并未再说什么，她从口袋中摸出了苦目糖。
Argus doesn't respond. She pulls a Picrasma candy from her pocket.

她的双手微微颤抖，以致于糖从她的手中滑落，“啪嗒”地掉在了地板上。
Her hands tremble slightly, causing it to slip from her grasp and fall to the floor with a clack.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

她拾起了糖块，放在了雇佣兵的掌心。
She picks it up and places it back in Argus's hand.

维尔汀：苦目糖不是万能的解药。
Vertin: You rely far too much on Picrasma candy. It can't solve all your problems.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

她吞下糖块，嚼碎，连同其上附着的灰尘。
She tosses the candy into her mouth and chews it along with the dust from the floor.

阿尔古斯：……一般来说，糖块总能很好地发挥它的效用。
Argus: They usually work wonders for me.

阿尔古斯：吃一颗，通常能让完全丢失的视野恢复到 50%——非常管用。但对于我的工作而言，50% 的视野还远远不够用。
Argus: Just one candy restores 50% of my vision. But in my line of work, 50% is never enough.

阿尔古斯：所以，这个时候需要再吃下一颗，让视野恢复到 100%。
Argus: That's why I take two. I need my vision to be at least 100%.

喉头滚动，口腔传来如预想般的甜蜜。
She runs the candy along her tongue, and the expected sweetness fills her mouth.

阿尔古斯：这可以满足绝大部分的需求，但偶尔也会有些更棘手的任务。
Argus: That'll do the job most of the time, but sometimes I've got an extremely challenging task.

阿尔古斯：这个时候需要吃第三颗——需要注意的是，这已经是一个比较危险的数字了……
Argus: That's when I eat a third candy. At that point, it's getting extremely dangerous.

她又往嘴里扔了一颗糖。
She pops another candy into her mouth.

阿尔古斯：按照以往的经验，现在就差不多能够看到东西了。
Argus: I should be able to see now.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

奇迹并没有发生，她的眼睛依旧沉寂，如同星光死尽的夜空。
No miracle occurs. Her eyes remain still, like a night sky with no stars.

阿尔古斯：……是我吃得还不够多吗?
Argus: Sh-Should I take more?

蓝手帕：当然——不是。
Tuesday: Absolutely not.

蓝手帕：或者说，您正是因为吃得太多了，才会让眼睛在这样关键的时刻派不上用处。
Tuesday: The large amount of candy you've eaten is exactly why your eyes have failed you, and in such a crucial moment, no less.

蓝手帕：一切事物都是如此，它们一旦超过合理的限度，反而会引发自身的毁灭——如何掌握这个限度，是值得所有人用一辈子去学习的学问。
Tuesday: Excess leads to destruction. This is true for all things. You'd do well to learn your limits.

阿尔古斯：……什么?
Argus: What?

蓝手帕：就好像我也总得提防着，不要让那些孩子过于恐惧……
Tuesday: I also had to be careful not to frighten those children too much.

侍应生似乎想起了一些美妙的回忆，雪白的面孔上略带餍足。
The maid seems to relive some fond memories, a satisfied look on her pale face.

蓝手帕：哈……您一直坚定地相信它的作用是吗?
Tuesday: Hmph. You've always put your faith in these candies, haven't you?

蓝手帕：一颗糖，50%；两颗糖，100%；三颗糖，用于应付更危险的情况……
Tuesday: One candy, 50% recovery; two candies, 100%; three candies, and you can tackle even the most insurmountable problem.

蓝手帕：多么值得信赖呀，这小小的糖果……就像所有人眼中的阿尔古斯，她是那样的伟大，所有的任务只要到了她的手上，保准能够被搞定。
Tuesday: Oh, how dependable they are! Just like the venerable Argus who succeeds in any job she takes on!

侍应生咯咯直笑。
She chuckles.

蓝手帕：哈哈……
Tuesday: Heh heh.

蓝手帕：正是因为您一直相信着它……才赢来了如此盛大的毁灭。
Tuesday: It's precisely your excessive confidence in these candies that has led to your marvelous destruction.

蓝手帕：就像那些镇民的信任……反而使一个人走向了万劫不复的深渊。噢，真是可怜的家伙。
Tuesday: Just as the people's trust in you as a mercenary has led you to this bottomless abyss. Oh, you poor thing.

蓝手帕：他们当然也不会想到……所谓的百眼巨人，竟然是一个盲目的瞎子！
Tuesday: And of course, they'd never have imagined this. Argus, the mercenary named after the hundred-eyed, all-seeing giant, is in fact a blind fool!

阿尔古斯：你他*的又是谁?!
Argus: Who the hell are you?!

她向着声音的来源狠狠地扣下了扳机，耳边的枪声振聋发聩。
She fires in the direction of her voice, the gunshot ringing in their ears.

???: ——!
???: —!

墙壁上出现了深深的弹痕，整座旅馆发出了古怪的嚎叫。
The bullet pierces the wall, and a strange wail echoes through the halls of the motel.

阿尔古斯：该死的，该死的……
Argus: Damn it! Damn it!

蓝手帕：哈，没打中呢。
Tuesday: Hahaheh. Missed me.

她极力地压抑着过于活跃的交感神经，颤抖的手指在自己的手背上掐下了一道道红痕。
She digs her fingers into her hand as she tries to control her trembling.

蓝手帕：……嗯。
Tuesday: Uhn.

她轻巧地掂着步子，将心口抵在了枪管上。
She steps forward, pushing her chest against the barrel of the gun.

蓝手帕：这下好啦，一切都对得整整齐齐的。
Tuesday: There you go. Now there's no way you can miss.

蓝手帕：只是您按得下扳机吗?
Tuesday: But do you have the guts to pull the trigger?

她微微侧首，嘴角含笑。
She tilts her head slightly, smiling.

蓝手帕：这一切的决定权在您的手上……不过，我死了以后，您可就再也找不到 707 了。
Tuesday: The decision's yours to make, but once I'm dead, you'll never find room 707.

蓝手帕：数羊羔、凯拉……都在那个房间，不是吗?
Tuesday: Barbara, Kayla, everything you're looking for is all in that room, isn't it?

阿尔古斯：——别用你那脏嘴叫她的名字！
Argus: Don't you dare say her name with that filthy mouth!

蓝手帕：为什么呢？凯拉小姐是一个很好的住客，我很喜欢她。
Tuesday: But why? Ms. Kayla's such a lovely guest. I've very much enjoyed her company.

侍应生饶有兴味地看着雇佣兵的面孔，后者正因愤怒而变得扭曲。
The maid looks at the mercenary's face with interest as it twists in rage.

维尔汀：……够了。
Vertin: Enough.

维尔汀：我想，我们需要好好谈谈。
Vertin: You and I need to have a serious talk.

蓝手帕：噢，小姐，没有这个必要了……
Tuesday: Oh, there's no need for that.

蓝手帕：我的孩子很想见见您。
Tuesday: Actually, my baby's eager to meet you.

维尔汀：……孩子？
Vertin: Your baby?

她的目光投向了侍应生怀中的襁褓。
She looks at the bundle of swaddling cloth in the maid's arms.

蓝手帕：嗯，事实上，它才是这个旅馆的主人……
Tuesday: Yes. In fact, the baby is the master of this motel.

她将襁褓塞入了维尔汀的怀中。
She holds out the bundle.

蓝手帕：所以我想……您应当先和它打个招呼——抱住它。
Tuesday: I think the two of you ought to meet each other first. Here, hold it.

襁褓的分量远比她想象的要轻——这并不是一个孩子的重量。
She places it in her arms. The bundle is much lighter than she expected—not the weight of a child.

维尔汀：这是……
Vertin: This is ...

她恍惚间看见脚下的地毯翻滚为泥沼，而蓝手帕立于泥沼之上，满含微笑地看着她。
She sees the carpet beneath her feet transform into a quagmire. Tuesday stands on top of the mud, smiling at her.

阿尔古斯：维尔汀？维尔汀！
Argus: Vertin? Vertin!

她的双耳仿佛浸入水中，雇佣兵的呼喊如同身处彼岸。
The mercenary's shouts are dulled. It's as if she's been plunged under water.

急切的脚步声自远处传来，而手中的那个襁褓沉重得如同铅坠。
She hears hurried footsteps approaching from a distance and feels the once-light bundle become as heavy as lead.

——有什么东西没过了脚踝，她一直在下沉，仿佛要自此坠入一个无明的世界。
Something engulfs her ankles, pulling her down, down, down into a world of endless darkness.

阿尔古斯：放开它，维尔汀！
Argus: Let go of it, Vertin!

一枚青绿色的火焰挣扎着亮起，雇佣兵匍匐在地上，紧紧地拉住了她的手。
An emerald flame struggles to light up, and the mercenary, lying on the ground, tightly grabs her hand.

阿尔古斯：该死的，我从来没有做过这么亏本的买卖——
Argus: I ain't letting our deal end this way! Not while I draw breath!

维尔汀：阿尔古斯……
Vertin: Argus ...

阿尔古斯：——啊！
Argus: Aaargh!

属于侍应生的皮靴轻轻地碾住了雇佣兵的手指，后者发出了惨痛的叫声。
The maid presses her foot against Argus's fingers and steps down. Argus screams in pain.

蓝手帕：别做多余的事。
Tuesday: Don't you interrupt them.

蓝手帕：——维尔汀小姐，无需担忧，这是必要的过程。
Tuesday: There's no need to worry, Ms. Vertin. I've done this countless times.

蓝手帕：让我来看看你的梦。
Tuesday: Now, allow me to peer into your dreams.

小水洼 · 1/2
The Puddle on the Road · 1/2 THH-17

世间的响声越来越远，她再次睁开了眼睛，目所能及之处尽为黑夜。
The sounds of the world fade into total silence, and when she opens her eyes again, there is nothing but darkness.

维尔汀：这是……哪里?
Vertin: Where am I?

啪嗒。
plop

一粒冰凉的水珠落到了她的鼻尖。
A cool drop of water falls on her nose.

维尔汀：下雨了?
Vertin: Is that rain?

“圈环”：我能用圈环勾住任何东西。
"The Ring": I can catch anything with a toss.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

伊莎贝拉：维尔汀，你这次喊我们过来，也是为了这一件事吧?
Isabella: Vertin, that's why you've gathered us here, right?

维尔汀：……你们不是属于这里的人。
Vertin: You shouldn't be here.

伊莎贝拉：你会理解我们的，对吗，维尔汀?
Isabella: You understand what we desire most, right, Vertin?

四周响起了下雨的淅沥声，孩子们好奇地张望着。
The falling rain surrounds them. The children watch curiously.

“圈环”：维尔汀，我们成功了吗?
"The Ring": Vertin, we made it, right?

伊莎贝拉：可是为什么雨还在下?
Isabella: But why is it still raining?

“圈环”：伊莎贝拉，不要大惊小怪，只是下雨，你难道没见过下雨吗?
"The Ring": Don't be such a baby, Isabella. Haven't you seen rain before?

孩子们伸出了手，企图接住那些坠落的雨珠。
The children reach out as they try to catch the raindrops in their hands.

维尔汀：——不！
Vertin: No!

蓝手帕：……您害怕孩子和雨？
Tuesday: Are you afraid of children? Or rain?

熟悉的声音于黑暗之中回荡。
A familiar voice echoes in the darkness.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

维尔汀：不，我并不害怕这些。
Vertin: No, I'm not afraid of them.

维尔汀：雨水是最常见不过的东西——世界上总有一些地方会在下雨。
Vertin: Rain is common. It's always falling somewhere in the world.

维尔汀：……只是雨水而已。
Vertin: It's merely an ordinary weather phenomenon.

侍应生微笑着打了一个响指，所有的雨滴自半空停止后，逆流而上。
The maid snaps her fingers. The raindrops halt, then start to flow upward.

蓝手帕：您所害怕的是这样的雨，对吗？
Tuesday: This is the kind of rain you're afraid of, isn't it?

蓝手帕：我从来没有见过倒着的雨，这是来自于您的想象力吗？……但我实在想不明白，倒着的雨有什么值得害怕的呢？
Tuesday: Hmm, I've never seen rain fall upwards. Is this some creation of your imagination? Still, I don't see why you'd be afraid of rain falling in reverse.

蓝手帕：——好孩子，您能够为我解答吗？
Tuesday: Would you care to enlighten me, dear child?

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

维尔汀：蓝手帕小姐，您应当停止这些无谓的尝试，然后告诉我阿尔古斯在哪里。
Vertin: Ms. Tuesday, please. Stop trying to get in my head, and tell me where Argus is.

侍应生置若罔闻，她反而更凑近了些。
The maid ignores her and steps closer.

蓝手帕：……在遇见您之前，我从不相信世界上存在一个没有恐惧的人。
Tuesday: Before I met you, I never thought that a person without fear could exist in the world.

蓝手帕：我也从来没有猜错过人们所恐惧的东西……您是如此的特别。
Tuesday: I've never once guessed someone's fear incorrectly, either. You really are something else.

维尔汀：您没有猜错。
Vertin: You didn't guess incorrectly.

维尔汀：这些逆流而上的雨滴，带来了最紊乱的时代。人们在夹缝中求生，被时代的巨轮碾成微末的灰尘。
Vertin: These reversed raindrops have brought utter chaos to the world, pulverizing people under the crushing wheel of time.

维尔汀：您应该庆幸您没有见过这样的雨水。
Vertin: You should be thankful you've never seen it.

维尔汀：但是现在，它们不会再是我们前进的阻碍。
Vertin: But it can't stop us anymore.

维尔汀：因为伞就在这儿。
Vertin: Because the umbrella's here.

她撑开了伞。
She opens the umbrella.

维尔汀：至少在“暴雨”之中，我能为同伴们撑起这一把伞。
Vertin: At least now, when the "Storm" comes, I can hold up the umbrella and protect my companions.

维尔汀：……虽然这个时刻来得太晚了，但好在我们还有未来。
Vertin: And although this ability has come too late for some, we still have a future to protect.

蓝手帕：……
Tuesday: ...

维尔汀：……您为什么如此执着于人们心中的恐惧？这本来不是什么重要的事，何至于使您双手发抖、战栗不止呢。
Vertin: Why are you so obsessed with people's fears? Your hands have been trembling with excitement this whole time.

侍应生的十指交叉着抵在下巴上，面庞如同花朵般红润娇艳。
The maid clasps her hands under her chin, her face flushed like a blooming flower.

蓝手帕：哈……我果然没有看错您……
Tuesday: Haha. So I wasn't wrong at all.

蓝手帕：您为什么要去管那个雇佣兵呢？她的确看起来很厉害，但那始终是个空壳子……您吃过夏威夷果吗？只要能打开外面的硬壳，里面便是一览无余的美味……
Tuesday: Why waste your time with that mercenary? She may look tough, but she's hollow inside. Have you ever eaten a macadamia nut? Crack the hard shell, and you'll find the delicious center.

蓝手帕：没有人不喜欢香醇而富含油脂的果肉，而恐惧的美味更甚于此……
Tuesday: Who could resist the soft texture and rich flavor of fear?

维尔汀：侍应生小姐，该结束了。
Vertin: Ms. Tuesday, this has to end.

维尔汀：您就是一切的罪魁祸首，对吗？
Vertin: You're the one pulling the strings here, aren't you?

红晕漫上了侍应生的脸颊，她单手搅动着裙摆。
The maid blushes as she twirls her skirt with one hand.

蓝手帕：噢，真令人意外，这样的指控……
Tuesday: Oh, what an astounding accusation.

蓝手帕：不、不过，我很开心，我想我从来没有这样的开心过……
Tuesday: But, oh, do I feel so, so gratified. I've never felt so satiated in my entire life!

她的灵魂似乎陷入了某种奇异的震颤。
Her very being seems to be caught in a strange tremor.

蓝手帕：您……！您是唯一一个看见了我的人……多么的不可思议……
Tuesday: Oh, you! You're the only one who's ever seen through me! How exhilarating!

蓝手帕：但有一点，您说得不对……
Tuesday: However, your accusation missed the mark.

她伸出了自己的双手，那双手在雨幕之下显得格外洁白。
She stretches out her hands. They look especially pure under the rain.

蓝手帕：您看见了吗？它们如此干净，从未沾染上一丝血迹……
Tuesday: You see my hands? They're immaculate—never once tainted by a single drop of blood.

蓝手帕：这正是我引以为傲的一点……您瞧瞧，我几乎什么也不用做，那些恐惧就源源不断地产生了……
Tuesday: I take great pride in it. You see, I barely do anything to make people's fears arise.

面前的手掌因为主人的兴奋而略显痉挛。
Her hands tremble with excitement.

蓝手帕：哈，我怎么会去伤害别人呢……通过伤害而产生的恐惧，最为简单，也最为低劣。
Tuesday: Ha, I would never injure anyone. Fear created through physical harm is its crudest and most base form.

蓝手帕：我要那恐惧的阴影永远离不开他们的心房……
Tuesday: What I crave is the fear that lingers in their hearts forever.

侍应生的脸颊透出了淡淡的粉色。
The maid's cheeks flush a faint pink.

蓝手帕：即使在多年以后，他们向朋友或亲人讲述其亲身经历的事……每个人的心中都会留下一颗种子……
Tuesday: The kind of fear that, even years later, when they recount their experiences here to their friends and families, a seed of fear is planted in the listeners' hearts.

蓝手帕：啊，哈哈……
Tuesday: Ahh, haha.

蓝手帕：我将给予他们恐惧，而他们也将成为我可爱的孩子。
Tuesday: I instill fear in my guests, and they become my beloved children.

雨幕之中，她的手指不受控制地颤抖着，被濡湿的脸上露出了无比美丽的笑容。
In the rain, her fingers tremble uncontrollably, and a beautiful smile spreads across her wet face.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

维尔汀：——阿尔古斯在哪里？
Vertin: Where is she? Where's Argus?

蓝手帕：噢……我想，她正在经历自身的恐惧——很难想象吗？这样一位雇佣兵，居然也有害怕的东西……
Tuesday: Well, I suppose she's experiencing her own fears right now. Under that hard mercenary exterior, she's tormented by them. Can you imagine that?

维尔汀：蓝手帕小姐，抱歉。
Vertin: Sorry, Ms. Tuesday.

维尔汀：……我对这些不感兴趣。
Vertin: But I'm not interested in this vile obsession of yours.

蓝手帕：——！
Tuesday: —!

撑着伞的身影，向着更深的黑暗处走去了。
The one with the umbrella walks deeper into the darkness.

空气中传来了鸟的鸣叫，她看到了熟悉的原野。
The sound of birds chirping fills the air. Argus is back home—on those familiar plains.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

阿尔古斯： 这是……
Argus: This is ...

她站在一无所有的荒野中，迎面而来的只有风与草叶的晃动。
She stands in the field, nothing but the wind and the rustling grass before her.

镇民 I： 啊呀，阿尔古斯，太久没有见到你了。大伙儿都以为你不会回来了。
Resident I: Howdy, Argus, long time no see. We thought you'd never come back.

阿尔古斯： 丹尼斯叔叔……你怎么在这儿?
Argus: Mr. Dennis? Why are you here?

镇民 I： 阿尔古斯，你看看你说的是什么话？为什么我不能在这儿?
Resident I: Oh boy, you listening to yourself? Why wouldn't I be here?

镇民 I： 尤其是我的女儿还在今天结婚了！
Resident I: It's my daughter's wedding day!

阿尔古斯： 什么……恭喜……
Argus: Huh? W-Well, congratulations.

她那近乎于木僵的脑袋终于转过了弯。
She finally catches on.

阿尔古斯： 可是……你不应该在这里。
Argus: But, you really shouldn't be here.

阿尔古斯： 你不记得了吗？三年前你的女儿离家出走……
Argus: Don't you remember? Three years ago, your daughter ran away from home.

阿尔古斯： 她留下了一封书信，和谢弗先生一起去了东部……大概是底特律？我记不太清楚了。
Argus: She left a letter and then went with Mr. Shaffer to a city in the northeast, Detroit, I think? I don't quite remember.

镇民 I： 得了吧，别开玩笑了。
Resident I: Oh, come on, quit fooling around.

阿尔古斯： ……我花了三个月找到了她，她不肯回来，于是我只能把这个消息告诉你……后来，你自己去了底特律……
Argus: After three months of searching, I found her, but she refused to come back with me. So, you went to Detroit yourself.

阿尔古斯： 然后你……
Argus: And then, you ...

她忽然打住了话头。
Her words drift off.

丹尼斯为了寻找自己的女儿，死在了底特律——她的记忆这样告诉她。
Dennis died in Detroit while looking for his daughter. At least, that's what she remembers.

DENNIS

(1938–1987)

R.I.P.
DENNIS

(1938–1987)

R.I.P.

但眼前的事实却与回忆相差甚大。那个被宣告死去的男人正殷切地望着她。
But, how can that be? He's right here, standing in front of her.

阿尔古斯：总之，非常抱歉，我没能把她带回来……
Argus: In any case, I'm sorry I couldn't bring her back.

镇民 I：阿尔古斯，你在说什么呢！
Resident I: What're you talking about, Argus?

镇民 I：看来你真是累着了，说了这么多颠三倒四的话！我早就和其他人说过，不该让你干太多的活！
Resident I: You must be tired from working on all those requests that the townsfolk have pushed upon you. I've told them so many times to go easy on you!

镇民 I：我当然有一个新的委托给你！
Resident I: That said, I have a request for you myself!

阿尔古斯：是什么？找寻走失的牛羊，还是……
Argus: What is it? Did you lose some livestock or—

镇民朝她挤了挤眼睛，将一封请柬塞到了她的手心。
The townsman winks and hands her an invitation.

镇民 I：爱丽丝今天结婚了，如果你有空，欢迎你来！
Resident I: Come to Alice's wedding!

镇民 I：我们准备了足量的麦酒、鹰嘴豆泥，还有礼拜堂的唱诗班——一定得来看看，好姑娘。
Resident I: We've prepared plenty of food and beer. And we've got the chapel choir together. Don't miss out, missy!

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

阿尔古斯：抱歉，我不去了。
Argus: Sorry, I won't be there.

镇民 I：为什么？
Resident I: Why?

为什么呢？
Why, Argus?

阿尔古斯：我接到了玛丽姨妈的委托，要去给她的丈夫送信——她腿脚不好，你知道的。
Argus: I-I need to deliver a letter to, to Mrs. Mary's husband. She can't go herself because of her bad legs, you see.

镇民 II：哎呀，阿尔古斯，我可没让你去送信呀。
Resident II: Hey, Argus. I didn't ask you to deliver any letters.

阿尔古斯：……玛丽姨妈，您不是……
Argus: Mrs. Mary, didn't you ...?

眼前的人应当在 1989 年寿终正寝，阿尔古斯记得自己曾亲眼目睹她的灵柩被埋入土中。
Mary passed away in 1989. Argus saw her coffin being lowered into the ground.

MARY

(1945–1989)

R.I.P.

MARY

(1945–1989)

R.I.P.

另一个被宣告死亡的人，如今正笑意盈盈地立在她的眼前，殷切地望着她。
Another person declared dead is now standing before her, smiling brightly.

阿尔古斯： 您还活着……？
Argus: You're still alive?

镇民 II： 瞧瞧，这说的是什么话！这孩子真是忙糊涂了。
Resident II: What kind of nonsense are you spouting?! You really ought to take a proper rest.

镇民 II： 今天是爱丽丝的好日子，我们都应该去参加她的婚礼，不是吗？
Resident II: Today's Alice's big day. We should all be at her wedding, don't you think?

镇民 II： ……好孩子，你的手为什么在抖？
Resident II: Oh, my sweet child, why are your hands shaking?

阿尔古斯： 我……
Argus: I ...

镇民 II： 你为此而害怕吗？可是你为什么会害怕？
Resident II: Are you afraid? Why?

镇民 II： 你害怕他们变得幸福？
Resident II: Are you afraid of their happiness?

镇民 II： 还是……你害怕自己是个废物？
Resident II: Or are you afraid of your failure?

阿尔古斯： ……我不是。
Argus: I'm not a failure!

镇民 II： 噢，好孩子。
Resident II: Oh, my sweet child.

镇民 I： 阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯，如果你要送信，就去找阿尔古斯。
Resident I: Argus! Argus! Got a message to send? Go get Argus, your trusted friend!

镇民 II： 阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯，如果你要捉奸，就去找阿尔古斯。
Resident II: Argus! Argus! Got a cheating spouse to catch? Go get Argus; she's got your back!

???: 阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯……
???: Argus ... Argus ...

并不属于镇子的声音在周围响起。
A foreign voice echoes through their mouths and surrounds her.

阿尔古斯： ——谁！
Argus: Who's there?!

眼前的一切如潮水般退去，唯有一个少女伫立在她的面前。
Her surroundings recede like a tide, leaving only a girl in white standing before her.

半裹着胎衣的羔羊卧在她的脚边。她的双手沾满了羊水与血迹，脸上的笑容纯洁如白鸽。
Wrapped in a half-soiled birth cloth, a lamb lies at her feet. The girl's hands are covered in blood and amniotic fluid. Her smile is as pure as a dove.

凯拉：是我呀，阿尔古斯，你忘记我了吗?
Kayla: It's me, Kayla. You haven't forgotten me, have you?

阿尔古斯：凯拉……
Argus: Kayla ...

凯拉：天要黑了，我们得带着它们回去——在母羊受伤的情况下，它们一定活不过今晚。
Kayla: It's getting dark. We should take them back. Ain't no way they'll make it through the night out here with their mama hurt.

凯拉：更何况，天一黑，你的眼睛就什么都看不见了。
Kayla: And you can't see a thing at night.

阿尔古斯：是的，我们得回去了——不能再拖延。
Argus: Yeah, we need to go back now. Can't delay any longer.

凯拉：噢……
Kayla: Oh.

阿尔古斯：怎么了?
Argus: What?

凯拉：你还得等等我……
Kayla: Hold on a moment.

羊羔发出了咩咩的叫声。
The lamb bleats.

阿尔古斯：这是要干什么?
Argus: What are you doing?

凯拉：别怕，别怕……
Kayla: There, there.

她那双沾满羊水的手轻柔地抚上了小羊的脖颈，羊羔俯下头，舔舐着她冰冷的指尖。
She kneels down and gently strokes the lamb's neck. The lamb bows its head and licks her fingertips. They're still wet with amniotic fluid.

凯拉微笑着收紧了手掌，羊羔发出了凄厉的惨叫，惊起了远方的候鸟。
Kayla smiles and tightens her grip around the lamb's neck. It lets out a piercing cry, sending a distant flock of birds into the air.

——这叫声并未持续多久，因为羊羔很快就被那双手扼死在了草地里。
The cry becomes weaker, more strangled, and then silent as the life is squeezed out of its body.

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

凯拉：你看，相比于在荒原中承受豺狼的撕咬，能如此短暂地死去，岂不是一件幸运的事?
Kayla: Isn't it better to die a quick death than end up in the belly of a wolf?

阿尔古斯：……你没有资格替它决定这些。
Argus: You've got no right to make that decision.

阿尔古斯：没有什么东西是为了死去而降生在这世上的……它原本可以站起来……
Argus: No living thing is born to simply die. It could've stood up. It could've survived.

少女自荒草丛中起身。
The girl gets to her feet.

凯拉：现在我们可以走了。
Kayla: We can go now.

阿尔古斯：……你不能走。
Argus: No, don't go.

白衣的女孩面带微笑，田野间的微风吹拂着她的裙摆，发出猎猎的响声。
The girl smiles as the long grass rustles against her flowing skirt in the breeze.

凯拉：……你提醒我了。
Kayla: Oh, you've reminded me.

凯拉：还有两个大麻烦没有解决呢……你看看那两个人……
Kayla: There are two problems left unsolved. Those two over there.

雇佣兵向远处望去，丹尼斯叔叔与玛丽姨妈正向着她微笑。
Argus looks into the distance. Dennis and Mary are standing and smiling at her.

凯拉：你得帮我杀了他们，只需要两颗子弹，费不了多少时间……
Kayla: Kill them. It would only take two bullets. Three seconds max.

凯拉：人只要活着，就是一件麻烦事——他们会穷追不舍地追着你，就像你对待你的任务目标那样。
Kayla: As long as they're alive, they'll come after you just as hard as you hunt the targets of your missions.

凯拉：你应该比我更清楚这些。
Kayla: I'm sure you know that better than I do.

阿尔古斯：……为什么?
Argus: Why should I kill them?

凯拉：这需要什么理由吗?
Kayla: Do you need a reason?

凯拉：就按照以前那样——我说，你做，你什么也不需要思考，这不就是你所引以为傲的东西吗?
Kayla: Just do as we've always done. I say, and you do. No need to think about it. Isn't that what you pride yourself on?

凯拉：没有自我意识和选择，成为一个彻头彻尾的工具——这就是一个雇佣兵所需要做的一切。
Kayla: A mindless tool that blindly follows orders. That's all a mercenary needs to be.

凯拉：——也是你一直标榜的自我价值……
Kayla: Isn't that the so-called value of a mercenary that you always talk about?

阿尔古斯：不，不是的……
Argus: No, it ain't true.

凯拉：实际上，你也并没有那么好心，对吗？你才不在乎别人的性命呢。
Kayla: What's with the hesitation, anyway? It's not like you give a damn about other people's lives.

凯拉：不肯对叔叔和婶婶下手，也只是因为杀死了他们，你就再也无法听到那些漂亮话了……
Kayla: The only reason you can't bring yourself to kill them is because you enjoy how they always praise you and depend on you.

阿尔古斯：你不是凯拉。
Argus: You ain't Kayla.

凯拉：只因为不符合你的期待，你就要彻底地否认我的存在吗?
Kayla: Seriously? Are you saying I'm a fraud just because I don't meet your expectations of what I'm supposed to be?

白衣少女露出意味不明的笑容。
The girl gives an inexplicable smile.

凯拉：既然你认为我不是凯拉，那你为什么不杀了我?
Kayla: Fine. If you think I'm not Kayla, then why don't you kill me now?

凯拉：只要你对着我的心脏开枪，这些人都会把你当做英雄——他们会在田野里举着火把，高呼你的名字……
Kayla: Just shoot me in the chest, and these people will treat you like a hero. They'll gather in the fields, holding torches, and chant your name.

雇佣兵赫然举起了枪，然而枪管颤抖——她已经丧失了瞄准目标的能力。
Argus abruptly raises her gun, but her hands are shaking—the barrel trembling.

凯拉：阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯，你胆小又懦弱。
Kayla: Argus! Argus! She's spineless!

凯拉：阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯……
Kayla: Argus! Argus! She's—

砰——!
bang

阿尔古斯，阿尔古斯……
Argus! Argus!

阿尔古斯：……!
Argus: ...!

子弹贯穿了少女柔软的胸脯，血迹泼洒，如同在原野上燃烧的花朵。
The bullet pierces the girl's soft chest. Her blood splatters on the field, dotting the grass like a smattering of poppies.

鲜血的份量如此沉重，使簇生的草叶谦卑地弯下了腰。
It clings to the grass, its weight causing the blades to bend.

镇民 I：噢！阿尔古斯，你是我们的英雄!
Resident I: Oh, Argus! Our great hero!

镇民 II：我们会高呼你的名字，将你的事迹代代相传!
Resident II: The tales of your heroic deeds will be passed down through generations!

阿尔古斯：……
Argus: ...

阿尔古斯：她不是凯拉。
Argus: She ain't Kayla.

镇民 I：噢！事到如今，您又开始自己骗自己了……她当然是凯拉!
Resident I: Now, now, you're lying to yourself again. Of course she's Kayla!

阿尔古斯：不可能。
Argus: It's not possible.

镇民 II：您又在嘴硬了！难道非得把她的心掏给您看，您才愿意相信吗?!
Resident II: Do I need to show you the bullet through her heart for you to believe it, bonehead?!

阿尔古斯：——该死的!
Argus: Damn it!

子弹落入枪匣，发出清脆的响声。
She loads a bullet into the chamber with a crisp click.

维尔汀： ——别开枪！
Vertin: Don't pull the trigger!

未曾预料的声音从耳边传来。
An unexpected voice comes from beside her.

阿尔古斯： ……维尔汀？
Argus: Vertin?

本不该出现在此处的人站在了雇佣兵的身侧，令她产生了轻微的倒错感。
How did she get all the way out here? Where did she come from?

维尔汀： 阿尔古斯，冷静。
Vertin: Calm down, Argus.

维尔汀： 别忘了，你所看见的都不是真实。至少现在，你依然身处于旅馆之中。
Vertin: Remember, what you see isn't real. You're still inside the motel, at least for now.

……

...

镇民 Ⅰ： 哦，又来了一个小姑娘……
Resident I: Oh, here comes another little lady.

镇民 Ⅱ： ——来得正好，一起来参加我们的聚会吧！
Resident II: Excellent timing. Come join the party!

偶发采访
Chance Interview 小径

UTTU 特别访谈
UTTU Special Interview

简中
蓝手帕：一次采访，是的，这对我来讲是件新鲜事儿，尤其发起者还是您这样的孩子。
蓝手帕：您想从我这儿了解什么？
数羊羔：您对恐惧有不少心得，具备这种经历的人很少见。我想对此进行记录。
蓝手帕：哦，好奇心旺盛的小家伙，您的同行们的求知欲也是这样强烈吗？瞧，我只是发展了一点爱好，就像有人喜欢钓鱼，有人喜欢酿造生啤酒，有人喜欢为绵羊梳开毛结——无意冒犯。
数羊羔：我并没有感到冒犯，请继续。
蓝手帕：品鉴恐惧需要技巧……需要轻轻地、轻轻地，就像推动桌边的杯子，只需伸出一个指尖。
蓝手帕：然后，您听见悦耳的声响——啪啦。
数羊羔：您将自己定位为推动者，而非直接参与者，我的理解正确吗？
蓝手帕：您是个聪明的孩子。
蓝手帕：有句话怎么说的来着，“自己吓自己”，那些不幸的人会自己表演给你看。想象力是一位好帮手。
蓝手帕：人们在恐惧后自行选择，完全出于想象力与自己的意志。这便是最有趣的地方。
English
Tuesday: An interview, huh? Well, I do declare, that is new ground for me, especially being interviewed by a child like you.
Tuesday: So, what do you want to know?
Barbara: You're no stranger to the realm of fear, and undoubtedly hold a unique perspective on the concept. That's why I want to hear what you have to say.

Tuesday: You're a curious little thing, aren't you? I wonder ... is the rest of your flock this nosy? Look, darling, for me, fear's just a little hobby. Like, some people enjoy fishing, some like brewing their own beer, and ... some even like combing the knots out of sheep fleece—no offense.
Barbara: None taken. Please, go on.
Tuesday: Appreciating fear takes finesse ... you have to ease into it gently, like nudging a glass along the edge of a table with just your fingertip.
Tuesday: Then, you hear that nice, crisp—clink.
Barbara: So, you see yourself as a fear facilitator, not a direct participant, correct?
Tuesday: You're a smart child.
Tuesday: How do I put this ... It's more like the scared are scaring themselves. Those poor lambs will do the hard work for you, you see. Their imagination is my greatest tool.
Tuesday: People start to make choices for themselves after experiencing true fear, based entirely on their imagination and of their own volition. And that's the most interesting part.

小水洼 · 2/2

The Puddle on the Road · 2/2 THH-17

阿尔古斯： ……维尔汀?
Argus: Vertin?

维尔汀： 我是来接你出去的。
Vertin: I'm here to get you out.

阿尔古斯： ……所以，那不是凯拉。
Argus: So, that wasn't Kayla.

雇佣兵长长地舒了一口气，为这一瞬的犹豫与错乱。
She lets out a long sigh of relief.

阿尔古斯： 这很好，再好不过了……
Argus: Couldn't ask for better news than that, really.

维尔汀： 那不是凯拉。
Vertin: No, it wasn't.

维尔汀： 我们要离开这儿。
Vertin: Let's get out of here.

她伸出手，如同一个邀请。
She reaches out her hand in invitation.

阿尔古斯： ——好。
Argus: Okay.

雇佣兵伸出了手——她总觉得身后有什么可憎的东西正在追逐着她，只要她停下脚步，那片名为迷茫的阴影就会将她吞噬。
Argus reaches out. She feels like something abominable is chasing after her—that if she stops, the shadow of confusion will come and swallow her whole.

而眼前的那只手，正是迷境中唯一的救赎——于是她不假思索地握紧了它。
And this hand is her only salvation—her escape from this labyrinth—so she grasps it tightly.

阿尔古斯： 她不是凯拉。
Argus: She ain't Kayla.

雇佣兵无比肯定地宣布了判决。
She declares this with absolute certainty.

不眠夜
Sleepless Night THH-18

旅馆的走廊寂静如常，微笑的侍应生静立在旁。
The motel hallway is as quiet as ever. The maid stands, smiling.

蓝手帕：你们见到它了吗?
Tuesday: Did you see it?

维尔汀：……它?
Vertin: It?

蓝手帕：噢，就是我的孩子……看来它并没有在你们的面前现身，真是一个胆小的家伙。
Tuesday: My baby, of course. Oh, so it didn't show up, then? What a shy little pumpkin!

阿尔古斯：……它是什么东西?
Argus: What is it exactly?

蓝手帕：它是一个懵懂的超自然存在，一切怪谈的集合体，一颗砰砰直跳的心脏，也是一个胆小又可爱的孩子……
Tuesday: A supernatural being, an amalgam of urban legends, an ever-pounding heart, and a shy little baby—all under one roof.

蓝手帕：不过，既然能从那儿出来，就意味着你们已经获得了它的同意——进来吧，我会带你们去看旅馆里最可爱的小房间。
Tuesday: But seeing how you got out of there in one piece, I'm certain you've already earned its approval. Come on in. I'll show you the sweetest little room in the motel.

她的身后赫然出现了一扇鲜红的门扉。
A red door appears behind her.

蓝手帕：别怕，孩子，开门。
Tuesday: Don't be afraid, sweetheart. Go ahead. Open the door.

门扉纹丝不动。
The door remains motionless.

蓝手帕：开门。
Tuesday: Open it. Now.

雇佣兵一言不发，只是沉默地擦拭着枪管。
The mercenary says nothing. She silently wipes the barrel of her gun.

砰、砰——!
bang-bang

她举起了枪，向着那扇红色的门扉射出了两发子弹。
She fires two shots at the red door.

整座旅馆发出了剧烈的颤抖。
The entire motel trembles violently.

阿尔古斯：这才是最管用的。
Argus: That'll do it.

她再次为枪支上好了子弹。然而走廊之内，忽然传来了巨大的回响声。
Before she can reload, the ground starts to shake beneath her feet, and a deafening sound reverberates through the hallway.

侍应生略为惊异地睁大了眼睛。
The maid's eyes widen in surprise.

蓝手帕：是啊，我怎么没有想到呢。
Tuesday: Why didn't I think of that?

蓝手帕：您的眼睛还没恢复吧？准头这样的差。
Tuesday: Your eyes haven't recovered yet, have they? Tsk, Tsk. Such poor aim.

蓝手帕：让我来帮你吧。
Tuesday: Let me lend you a hand.

蓝手帕：要听妈妈的话……
Tuesday: Listen to Mama.

蓝手帕：很早就告诉过你，不听话的后果。
Tuesday: I told you long ago about the consequences of disobedience.

蓝手帕：哎呀，没子弹了……您能帮我再上一次子弹吗?
Tuesday: Oh, it's out of bullets. Could you help me reload?

蓝手帕：噢……乖孩子。
Tuesday: Oh, my sweet child.

蓝手帕：您看见了吗？这正是恐惧的魅力……
Tuesday: Can you see it? This is the beauty of fear.

阿尔古斯：小心！
Argus: Watch out!

蓝手帕：请进吧，客人们。
Tuesday: Please, come in, my dear guests.

蓝手帕：——你们会在里面找到你们想要的东西。
Tuesday: You'll find what you seek inside.

蓝手帕：嗯，在我捡到它的时候，它的名字还叫做“温馨之家”。
Tuesday: When I found it, it was still called Sweet Home.

蓝手帕：没有人看管它，它孤零零地伫立在原野中，多么的可怜……
Tuesday: It was all alone, abandoned in the wilderness. The poor little thing.

维尔汀：于是你接手了它——这个未知的、尚在形成中的神秘学意识，它常常表现为一座旅馆，但同时也存在于襁褓之中。
Vertin: So you took it in? Some unknown, growing arcane consciousness that takes the form of a motel yet somehow also exists as a baby?

蓝手帕：嗯。
Tuesday: Yes.

侍应生俯下身，抱起了地上的襁褓。
The maid bends down and picks up the swaddled baby from the crib.

蓝手帕：乖……
Tuesday: There, there.

维尔汀：它已经严重影响了当地居民的生活。
Vertin: But it's seriously impacted the lives of the locals.

蓝手帕：噢，维尔汀，他们是自己选择来到这儿的……我也从未阻止他们离开。
Tuesday: Oh, Ms. Vertin, they chose to come here of their own volition. I never forced them to stay.

维尔汀：即使他们在日后或是发疯，或是自杀?
Vertin: But after leaving, some of them went mad or even committed suicide.

蓝手帕：那是他们自己选择的路。
Tuesday: Well, they made those decisions themselves.

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

蓝手帕：……现在不是该纠结这种问题的时候了，维尔汀小姐。
Tuesday: Now is not the time to dwell on such trivial matters, Ms. Vertin.

蓝手帕：您不是一直想要见到数羊羔吗?
Tuesday: Haven't you been searching for Ms. Barbara?

她伸出手，指向那扇洞开的门扉。
She points to the open door.

阿尔古斯：——慢着。
Argus: Don't get any bright ideas, maid.

她枯竭的眼中再次绽放了蓝绿色的光芒，将枪口顶在了蓝手帕的后心。
Her eye shines emerald again as she presses the barrel of her shotgun against Tuesday's back.

阿尔古斯：侍应生，她出了任何的问题，我都会一枪打爆你的心脏。
Argus: If Vertin gets so much as a scratch, I'll blast your chest open.

阿尔古斯：连同你的孩子。
Argus: Along with your baby.

阿尔古斯：——进去吧，维尔汀，我会替你看着她。
Argus: Go inside, boss. I'll keep an eye on her.

红色的幕布铺满了房间的每一寸空间，一张洁白的象牙床被摆放在房间的中央。
Red curtains cover every inch of the room, like flesh clinging to a body. An ivory bed stands in the center.

数羊羔：我认得您，维尔汀小姐。
Barbara: Here you are, Ms. Vertin.

数羊羔：很高兴我并没有和当前的世界断开联络。
Barbara: I'm so glad. I was beginning to think I'd never regain contact with the outside world.

蓝手帕：……阿尔古斯小姐，您可以把枪支放下了。
Tuesday: Ms. Argus, you can put your gun down now.

她品味着心跳的余韵，略带颤抖地开口了。
She speaks, trembling slightly as she savors every moment of her heightened heartrate.

蓝手帕：我之前已经展示过足够的诚意了，不是吗……
Tuesday: I've shown my utmost sincerity, have I not?

阿尔古斯：闭嘴!
Argus: Shut your trap!

维尔汀：……走吧，数羊羔小姐。
Vertin: Let's get out of here, Ms. Barbara.

维尔汀：我想，在其他生物的体内说话，总归不是一个好的选择。
Vertin: I don't think it's the wisest choice to have this conversation while we're still inside a living thing.

维尔汀：阿尔古斯，我需要你控制着蓝手帕——直到我们离开这里。
Vertin: Argus, I need you to keep Tuesday in check until we make it out of here.

阿尔古斯：哈，当然。
Argus: You ain't gotta tell me twice.

一缕光芒斜穿入户，外面正值金色的黎明。
A beam of light shines in through the window. Dawn is breaking.

蓝手帕：我见过无数次相同的景色，却从来没有像今天一样心潮澎湃……
Tuesday: I've gazed at this scenery countless times, but never have I felt as enthralled as today.

蓝手帕：不过……维尔汀小姐，您是不是忘了什么？
Tuesday: But, Ms. Vertin, don't you think you've forgotten something?

维尔汀：……什么？
Vertin: Forgotten what?

蓝手帕：那名与您一起前来的客人……她刚刚来到旅馆，又急匆匆地要去军备工厂，真是一个急性子的孩子。所幸最后，她没有在道路上迷失，又回到了这儿。
Tuesday: That guest who came with you. Shortly after her arrival, she hurried off to that armament factory. She's such an impatient child. Luckily, she made her way back here.

蓝手帕：……她的名字叫做红弩箭。
Tuesday: Her name's Lilya, right?

维尔汀：……你把她怎么了？
Vertin: What did you do to her?

侍应生轻轻地笑了。
The maid laughs softly.

蓝手帕：……您别着急，她很好——她正在睡着呢，现在，顶多只是做了一个噩梦。
Tuesday: Relax, she's fine. She's sleeping soundly as we speak, with or without nightmares.

蓝手帕：您和我一起去见她，我想，她应该很期望在此刻见到您。
Tuesday: Follow me. I'm sure she's eager to see you.

蓝手帕：嗯，就是这个房间。
Tuesday: This is the room.

阿尔古斯：开门。
Argus: Open it.

侍应生从钥匙串上取下了一把，拧开了门锁。
The maid finds the key on her keyring, puts it in the lock, and turns it.

蓝手帕旅馆·203 房
Room 203, Tuesday's Motel

房间内空荡荡的。
The room is empty.

蓝手帕：噢……
Tuesday: Oh.

侍应生懊恼地皱起了眉毛。
The maid frowns, her annoyance visible on her face.

手提箱的主人冲向了窗户边，向下看去。
The owner of the suitcase rushes to the window and looks down.

飞行女巫正精疲力竭地坐在下方，她们的视线不期然地交汇。
Lilya is sitting exhausted below. Their eyes meet.

红弩箭： 维尔汀，终于找到你了——
Lilya: Vertin! There you are!

红弩箭： 我得向你汇报——重塑之手已经渗透了附近的小镇，我们不能再去那儿了。
Lilya: Listen, those Manus scum have already wormed their way into the town. We can't go there.

维尔汀： 你的脸色很差。
Vertin: You look terrible.

红弩箭： 我一夜没睡——那个房间有鬼，一闭上眼睛就会看到很多怪东西。
Lilya: I couldn't sleep at all in that haunted room. Every time I closed my eyes, I saw all kinds of creepy stuff.

红弩箭： 头儿，你能下来吗？抬着脖子说话很累。
Lilya: Can you come down here, Captain? Talking like this hurts my neck.

维尔汀： ……好。
Vertin: Okay.

飘风
Gone in the Wind THH-19

红弩箭： 这是……？
Lilya: What's going on?

旅馆之外，柔和的晨曦拂照着大地，飞行员略带疑惑地望向了眼前的人。
Outside the motel, the rising dawn paints the earth a deep orange. Lilya looks confused as they approach.

红弩箭： 头儿，你还好吧?
Lilya: Are you okay, Captain?

维尔汀： 现在没事了。
Vertin: I'm fine.

维尔汀： 在你离开的时候，有一个好消息和一个坏消息——
Vertin: I have good news and bad news.

红弩箭： 别让我选一个了，快说吧。
Lilya: Don't bother with the order; just lay it on me.

维尔汀： 好消息是，我们找到了数羊羔。
Vertin: The good news is we've found Barbara.

维尔汀： 坏消息是，我们惹上了一个新的麻烦——这个旅馆是一个充满生命力的意识体，它会源源不断地制造怪谈、散播恐惧，也许以后会成为超自然的神秘学家。
Vertin: The bad news is we've got a new problem. This motel is the manifestation of a living consciousness that constantly generates urban legends and spreads fear. It might turn into a supernatural arcanist in the future.

维尔汀： 这需要严密的监视和管控。我们需要基金会的帮助，不能任由它在此地发展。
Vertin: We can't let it grow here unchecked. We need the help of the Foundation to keep it under control.

阿尔古斯：……老板，我的任务已经结束了。现在，我得去镇子上找凯拉。
Argus: Boss, my job here is done. I'm heading into town for Kayla.

她望向更遥远的地方。
She looks off into the distance.

阿尔古斯：噢……我还答应过一个年轻人，要帮他找到他的母亲……
Argus: Oh, and I promised a young fella that I'd help him find his mother.

阿尔古斯：我要先走了。
Argus: I've gotta go now.

维尔汀：我该怎么把佣金寄给你呢?
Vertin: How do I pay your fee?

阿尔古斯：佣金?
Argus: Fee?

雇佣兵爽朗地笑了。
She laughs heartily.

阿尔古斯：我们是朋友，小姐，不需要您再给些别的了。
Argus: We're friends, Vertin. I don't need no payment.

道别之后，她向着永无终点的路走去。
She says her goodbyes and sets off on the road ahead.

红弩箭：好了，头儿，现在打听到兀尔德的消息了吗?
Lilya: Alright, Captain, any progress on finding Urd?

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

羊羔动了动她柔软的耳朵。
The little sheep's ears twitch.

数羊羔：这就是你们来找我的目的吗?
Barbara: That's why you came looking for me, right?

数羊羔：当然，我可以帮您询问，这并不是什么难事……
Barbara: I'll ask the wind for you. It's the least I can do.

她说着，闭上了眼睛。
She closes her eyes.

红弩箭：……睡着了?
Lilya: Did she doze off?

自原野而来的微风轻柔地吹拂着她柔软的耳朵，如同一缕无形的蛛丝在她的耳边游移。
The gentle breeze caresses her ears, like an invisible thread being woven between them.

数羊羔：我在听……
Barbara: I'm listening.

数羊羔：噢……我听见了。
Barbara: Oh, I heard it. The answer.

羊羔睁开了眼睛。
She opens her eyes.

数羊羔：远方的风告诉我，最近一次收到兀尔德女士的投稿，是来自于圣保罗荣军院。
Barbara: A distant wind told me that Ms. Urd's latest submission came from the São Paulo Veterans' Residence.

数羊羔：那的确是一篇优秀的稿件，但除此之外的信息，《UTTU》并不知情。
Barbara: The article she submitted was an excellent piece, but UTTU doesn't know anything beyond that.

维尔汀：……好。
Vertin: Okay.

数羊羔：今晚。你们或许还能够收获一个不错的梦。
Barbara: I suppose we'll all have restful sleep and sweet dreams tonight.

数羊羔：我已经为这次的专题访谈收集到了足够的资料……相信这会是一篇很不错的报道。
Barbara: I've collected the material I needed for the upcoming feature interview. I bet the readers will enjoy it.

数羊羔：到时候，我也会在编辑栏里署上您的名字——蓝手帕小姐。
Barbara: I'll be sure to include your name on the byline, Ms. Tuesday.

蓝手帕：我？可是我并没有做什么呀。
Tuesday: Me? I don't think I contributed anything.

数羊羔：不，您的作用出类拔萃……我想，如果不是您，我也并不明白我内心所埋藏着的，这一份对于“失去联络”的恐惧。
Barbara: Quite the contrary, you played a significant role. If it weren't for you, I wouldn't have realized my inner fear of losing communication with the world.

数羊羔：身临其境的体验，对于一位编辑而言是绝佳的资料。
Barbara: First-hand experiences like this are invaluable to an editor.

蓝手帕：噢，您再这样说下去，我都有些后悔将您放出来了……
Tuesday: Oh, with the way you put it, I almost regret letting you go.

数羊羔：您不会再有那样的机会的，因为——访谈结束了。
Barbara: I won't be returning. The interview's over.

洁白的羊羔合上了红色的笔记本。
She closes her little red notebook.

数羊羔：如果顺利的话，您将会在下一期的《UTTU》上阅读到相关的专栏。
Barbara: If all goes well, you'll be able to read about it in the next issue of UTTU.

数羊羔：——我也该走了。
Barbara: I'll take my leave now.

维尔汀：……再见。
Vertin: Goodbye.

红弩箭：很好，我也想赶紧离开这麻烦透顶的鬼地方。
Lilya: Good, I can't wait to leave this place.

维尔汀：还没到时候。
Vertin: We can't leave yet.

维尔汀：我在刚刚联络了位于德克萨斯的基金会分部，现在他们正用传送术式赶往此处——必须及时调查这个奇特的超自然存在。
Vertin: I just contacted the Texas branch. Their staff is on their way here. They have to investigate this supernatural being as soon as possible.

红弩箭：——他们很快就能到，对吗?
Lilya: And they'll be here soon, I presume?

维尔汀：附近有传送术式的波动，应该就是他们……
Vertin: I can feel the energy fluctuations of teleportation rituals. It must be them.

她扭头一看，出现在眼前的是一个陌生的身影。
She turns her head to see a stranger standing before her.

维尔汀：……嗯?
Vertin: Mm?

眼前的女孩有着栗色的头发，手臂上挎着一个藤编的篮子。
The girl in front of her has chestnut hair and carries a woven basket on her arm.

红弩箭：——这应当不是圣洛夫基金会的人，头儿。我在镇子上见过她，她叫凯拉。
Lilya: Looks like you guessed wrong, Captain. I met her in town. Name's Kayla.

维尔汀：……凯拉?
Vertin: Kayla?

眼前的少女笑盈盈地望了过来。
The girl smiles brightly at her.

维尔汀：……你认识一个叫阿尔古斯的人吗?
Vertin: Do you know someone called Argus?

挎着篮子的少女甜甜地笑了。
The girl's smile becomes more gentle.

凯拉：我从来没有听过这个名字。真奇怪，怎么有人会给孩子取百眼巨人的名字?
Kayla: The name doesn't ring a bell. How strange! What kind of parent would name their child after a one-hundred-eyed giant?

维尔汀：……
Vertin: ...

凯拉：我想这只是重名——凯拉是个很常见的名字，就像爱玛、安娜、凯瑟琳，它们略有差异，但本质上并无不同。倒是小姐您……
Kayla: You must've mistaken me for someone else. Kayla is a common name, after all, like Emma, Anna, or Catherine. More importantly, Miss, you look ...

女孩微笑着。
The girl smiles once more.

凯拉：虽然我之前从来没有见过您，但总觉得您很亲切。
Kayla: Although I've never met you before, you seem familiar.

她将手伸进了篮子，片刻后，从中掏出了一支皱巴巴的花朵。
She reaches into the basket and pulls out a crumpled flower.

一只素色的飞蛾落在了花瓣上，轻轻抖动着它的翅膀，鳞粉扑朔。
A pale moth lands on a petal, gently fluttering its wings, its scales shimmering in the morning light.

凯拉：希望您能拥有一天的好心情。
Kayla: I hope you have a wonderful day.

维尔汀：……谢谢。
Vertin: Thank you.

女孩将花朵送入了她的怀中。
The girl tucks the flower under her arm.

维尔汀：您是这儿的住客吗?
Vertin: Are you a guest at this motel?

少女微微地点了点头。
The girl nods.

凯拉： 这儿发生了什么事吗?
Kayla: What happened here?

维尔汀： 圣洛夫基金会已经接管了这座旅馆——这个场所涉及了不少危险案件，我不建议您继续居住在这里。
Vertin: The St. Pavlov Foundation has taken over. I suggest you find alternative accommodation, given the dangerous incidents that have occurred here.

凯拉： 嗯……那我该怎么办？我的东西还在旅馆里……
Kayla: Hmm. What should I do? All my things are still inside.

维尔汀： 稍后会有基金会的职员来处理这些问题，您可以相信他们。
Vertin: The Foundation staff will take care of it for you later. You can trust them.

凯拉： 我能先去拿回我的东西吗?
Kayla: Can't I just go and get my things now?

维尔汀： 我会建议您在基金会的职员到场后，再进入这个旅馆。
Vertin: I would advise you to wait until the Foundation staff arrive.

凯拉： 啊呀，好心的小姐，您不用担心这些……我自然有我的办法。
Kayla: Oh, I can look after myself. No need to worry about me, Miss.

女孩眨了眨眼睛，推开了那扇紧闭着的门扉，随即消失在了众人的视野之中。
The girl winks and pushes open the motel door, promptly disappearing from their view.

红弩箭： 这个女孩……
Lilya: That girl ...

久未发言的飞行员开口了。
Lilya breaks her long silence.

维尔汀： 怎么了?
Vertin: What about her?

红弩箭： 不，我想应该是我的错觉。
Lilya: Never mind. It's probably nothing.

不远处，传送软盘的辉光一闪而过。
The light from a teleportation disk flickers nearby.

基金会职员 I： 抱歉，维尔汀小姐。
Foundation Staff I: Apologies for our delayed arrival, Ms. Vertin.

基金会职员 I： 在不久之前，我们一直无法定位到这个旅馆的位置，就像是有什么东西在故意干扰我们的判断……
Foundation Staff I: We'd been unable to locate the motel until about ten minutes ago. It's as if something was deliberately interfering with our sense of direction.

正当基金会职员忙于了解情况之时，旅馆的深处忽然再次传出了模糊的回音。
While the Foundation staff is busy assessing the situation, a faint sound echoes from the depths of the motel.

蓝手帕： 噢……
Tuesday: Oh.

维尔汀： ——!
Vertin: ...!

门扉赫然打开，一具青白色的尸体混同着垃圾一并涌出。
The door suddenly swings open, and a pale, trash-covered corpse is thrown out of it.

蓝手帕：它总是不听我的劝告，执意地要吃地上的垃圾——是不是所有的孩子都是这样?
Tuesday: Once again, it insisted on eating garbage off the floor. Is every child this stubborn?

红弩箭：……

Lilya: ...

基金会职员 I：……

Foundation Staff I: ...

维尔汀：……这是史蒂文，一名隶属于芝诺的军官。
Vertin: It's Stefen, a Zeno officer.

基金会职员 I：……史蒂文，耳熟的名字。
Foundation Staff I: Hmm, Stefen. Sounds familiar.

职员熟练地翻动着文件，他很快就找到了想要的内容。
The staff member flips through his records, quickly finding the information he's looking for.

基金会职员 I：的确是个颇有来头的人。资料显示他是芝诺的高级军官，在泄露阿尔卡纳真空弹视频之后就不知所踪。
Foundation Staff I: The records show he was a high-ranking Zeno officer who went missing after the vacuum bomb footage leaked.

基金会职员 I：芝诺对此人发布了悬赏令，上面写着一个令人咋舌的数字……看来他的行为彻底地惹怒了伊戈尔将军。
Foundation Staff I: Zeno issued a staggering bounty on him. I guess whatever he did really angered Admiral Igor.

基金会职员 I：谁也不会想到他就躲在这个小旅馆中……意外收获。
Foundation Staff I: Who would've thought he'd be hiding in this little motel in the middle of nowhere?

维尔汀：显然他的运气不怎么好。
Vertin: Obviously, luck wasn't on his side.

基金会职员 I：很抱歉对您造成了困扰，维尔汀小姐，接下来我们会接管这件事。
Foundation Staff I: Alright, Ms. Vertin, we'll take over from here.

蓝手帕：……

Tuesday: ...

蓝手帕：眼前的侍应生不为所动，只是轻轻地拍打着襁褓。
Tuesday: The maid remains calm, gently patting the bundle in her arms.

维尔汀：……在分部完成他们的流程之后，您会被送往总部，我们将对您做出一个更全面的评估。
Vertin: After the branch completes its procedures, you'll be sent to the headquarters for a more thorough assessment.

蓝手帕：……我还能和我的孩子在一起吗?
Tuesday: Will you return my baby to me?

维尔汀：现在还不到谈论这些的时候。
Vertin: It's too early to discuss that.

维尔汀：走吧，红弩箭。
Vertin: Let's go, Lilya.

她提起了手提箱。
She picks up the suitcase.

维尔汀：我们得回去向 Z 女士汇报关于兀尔德女士的消息。
Vertin: We must report back to Madam Z about Urd.

卫生指南
Hygiene Guide 小径

蓝手帕旅馆清扫记录
Tuesday's Motel Cleaning Records

简中

第 4 周
例行清洁
105 房间 呕吐物弄脏地毯
108 房间 清洁墙壁上的污渍与指纹
205 房间 玻璃破损，待联系送货人更换

第 5 周
例行清洁
105 房间 呕吐物弄脏地毯 该来点教训了
211 房间 需替换新的淋浴头
205 房间玻璃裂痕消失?

第 8 周
例行清洁
前台 桌子需维修
102 房间 地板烧焦 我没看错
焦痕消失了，好孩子

第 10 周
例行清洁
105 房间 血迹，地毯报废 惩罚时间到
202 房间 玻璃完全碎裂
已自我修复，亲爱的孩子值得一点奖励
就在今晚
105，当然

English

Week 4
Routine Cleaning
Room 105: Cleaned carpet stained with vomit.
Room 108: Cleaned stains and fingerprints off walls.
Room 205: Broken glass, contacted supplier for replacement.

Week 5
Routine Cleaning
Room 105: Cleaned carpet stained with vomit. A lesson needs to be taught.
Room 211: Replaced showerhead.
Cracks in the glass in room 205 disappeared?

Week 8
Routine Cleaning
Front desk: Table needs repair.
Room 102: Floor scorched—I saw that, I'm sure of it.
Scorch marks disappeared. That's a good baby.

Week 10
Routine Cleaning

Room 105: Bloodstains, carpet ruined. It's time for punishment.
Room 202: Glass completely shattered.
Repaired all by itself. An good baby deserves a reward.
Tonight.
Room 105, of course.

晚安好梦

Sweet Dreams 小径

摇篮曲
Lullaby

简中

合上眼睛，合上眼睛，我的小乖乖
安宁的夜晚已经到来
摇篮之中，一个美梦
将把你招待

合上眼睛，合上眼睛，我的小乖乖
猫头鹰捉鼯鼠多么愉快
一串一串，挂上枝头
进餐多自在

合上眼睛，合上眼睛，我的小乖乖
荒野上黑马儿正在徘徊
不要去听，不要害怕
马蹄多轻快

合上眼睛，合上眼睛，我的小乖乖
谷仓中装满仓惶与惊骇
早餐备好，满足香甜
等待你醒来

English

Close your eyes, close your eyes, my darling little dear,
The shining moon and peaceful night are dancing ever near,
In your cradle, dream a dream, so tender and so sweet,
Dream a dream to entertain and make this night complete.

Close your eyes, close your eyes, my darling little one,
The owls have caught some squirrels, dear, such luck and oh such fun,
One by one, their eyes survey, on branches perched so high,
Feasting freely, oh such delight, their banquet in the sky.

Close your eyes, close your eyes, my darling little star,
The black horse roams the wilderness, through rolling fields afar,
Don't you fret, don't you fear, their hooves no harm shall bring,
Their gentle pitter-patter prances lighter than the wind.

Close your eyes, close your eyes, my darling little love,
The barn is filled with fright and fear, below as is above,
Breakfast ready, maws agape, a rousing sweet delight,
Here awaits you to awake, devoured by morning's light.

往日不再
Gone Are the Old Days THH-20

凯拉：……噢，看来我不在的时候，这儿发生了许多故事。
Kayla: Oh dear. It seems a lot transpired while I was away.

凯拉：……
Kayla: ...

在思考之后，她拨通了手中的电话。
一阵等候音之后，电话被接通了。
After a moment's thought, she dials a number on her phone. A few rings later, the call is answered.

金伯利女郎：……淑女格蕾丝，你终于联系我了！
Ms. Kimberly: Ms. Grace, I thought you'd forgotten me!

金伯利女郎：我被发现了！
Ms. Kimberly: I've been exposed!

不出意料地，电话彼端传来了躁动不安的声音。
As expected, the voice on the other end is restless.

淑女格蕾丝：金伯利，你可以告诉我旅馆里到底发生了什么吗？为什么走廊里会有一摊血迹和少许的脑浆，谁死在了这里？
Ms. Grace: Kimberly, care to tell me what happened in this motel? There's blood and brains splattered in the hallway. Who died and how?

金伯利女郎：……是那个芝诺人，他发疯了，对着自己的太阳穴来了一枪。
Ms. Kimberly: It was that Zeno madman! He shot himself in the head!

金伯利女郎：他虽然死了，但我还没来得及销毁他床底下的术阵……我也还没来得及找到……
Ms. Kimberly: But I still haven't managed to destroy the ritual sigils under his bed. And I couldn't find the ...

淑女格蕾丝：……
Ms. Grace: ...

少女轻轻地叹了一口气。
She sighs.

淑女格蕾丝：据点暴露了，我们得带走所有有关于“仪式”的东西，离开这个地方。
Ms. Grace: Now that our base of operations has been exposed, we'll have to take away everything related to the "ritual" and leave.

淑女格蕾丝：基金会的人在不久之后就会对这里进行全面的搜查。
Ms. Grace: The Foundation's rats will thoroughly search this place soon.

金伯利女郎：——我可不想和那些灰白格子打交道！
Ms. Kimberly: Ugh, the last thing I need right now is to deal with them!

电话彼端传来了短暂的沉默，这不常见。
There's a brief and unusual silence on the other end of the line.

金伯利女郎：不过……您能告诉我，维尔汀是一个怎样的人吗？
Ms. Kimberly: And, uh, could you tell me more about this Vertin?

电话对面，她的语气有些惴惴不安。
There's a hint of anxiety in her voice.

金伯利女郎： 我不小心让她知道了一个大秘密——她的记忆力好吗？会把一件事记很久吗？
Ms. Kimberly: I might've had a slip of the tongue when she confronted me earlier. How good is her memory?

淑女格蕾丝： 不用那么忧虑，金伯利。人很少会关心自己以外的事。
Ms. Grace: Fret not, Kimberly. People rarely pay attention to things that don't directly involve them.

少女露出了淡淡的微笑。
She smiles faintly.

淑女格蕾丝： ……但我很期待与她的下一次见面。
Ms. Grace: But I do look forward to seeing her again.

数日后。
Several days later.

圣洛夫基金会·办公室
Office, St. Pavlov Foundation

基金会职员 II： 蓝手帕小姐，无需担忧，您大可把这次对谈看作是一次普通的对话。
Foundation Staff II: We're just here to have a conversation, Ms. Tuesday. Relax.

蓝手帕： ……我是在一个荒原中拾到它的。
Tuesday: I found it in the wilderness.

基金会职员 II： 它是指那个具备神秘学力量的“旅馆”吗？
Foundation Staff II: You mean, the "motel" with arcane powers?

基金会职员 II： 和您确认一下，这个神秘学意识的本体，就是您襁褓中所包裹的……形似心脏的胚胎，对吗？
Foundation Staff II: Just to confirm, the base form of this arcane consciousness is a heart-shaped "fetus," correct?

蓝手帕： 是的。
Tuesday: Yes.

基金会职员 II： 它的智力约等于一岁的婴儿，并不具备策划和实施这种行为的能力——而它视您为母亲，对您有着异乎寻常的信任与依赖……
Foundation Staff II: It's about as intelligent as a one-year-old human, and it lacks the ability to deliberately plan or cause the incidents in the motel. Meanwhile, it sees you as its mother, displaying remarkable trust and dependence on you.

基金会职员 II： ……我们认为您也参与了这些行动。或者说，您才是那个幕后的人。
Foundation Staff II: Therefore, we believe you were a major contributor to these incidents, or rather, the one who pulled the strings.

基金会职员 II： 也许您并不具备主观上的恶性，但事实如此，因为您而精神崩溃的人在镇子上比比皆是。
Foundation Staff II: You may not have acted with evil intent, but your actions have caused many residents in Chisos to suffer mental breakdowns.

基金会职员 II： ……所以，他们会寻求一些精神上的解脱——正是因为这个原因，重塑之手对这个镇子进行了史无前例的渗透。
Foundation Staff II: They were seeking some form of relief from their mental anguish, which provided the perfect opportunity for the Manus to entrench themselves so deeply in this town.

基金会职员 II： 我说得对吗？
Foundation Staff II: Isn't that so, Ms. Tuesday?

蓝手帕：噢……我从来没去过那个镇子，不知道那儿的情况……但如果真如您所说的那样。
Tuesday: Well, I've never been to that town. And even if it is as you say ...

蓝手帕：这也是他们自己的选择，不是吗?
Tuesday: They made their choices, didn't they?

基金会职员 II：……明白了。
Foundation Staff II: I see.

沙沙的声音响起，职员在笔录上记载了关键的信息。
She scribbles down the information on her clipboard.

基金会职员 II：在不久之前，司辰向基金会提交了另一个关键信息。
Foundation Staff II: The Timekeeper just reported another crucial piece of information to the Foundation.

基金会职员 II：在您的旅馆中，是否有自称隶属于“启明会”的信徒活动?
Foundation Staff II: Were there any activities going on in the motel undertaken by the self-proclaimed followers of the Order of Enlightenment?

蓝手帕：噢……是的，他们离开得不久，我还能记住他们的脸。
Tuesday: Oh, there indeed were. They left not long ago. I still remember their faces.

基金会职员 II：他们做了什么?
Foundation Staff II: What did they do at the motel?

蓝手帕：他们在地板上乱涂乱画，发出些奇怪的声音……噢，我想起来了。
Tuesday: They scribbled on the floor and made strange noises. Oh, I remember now.

蓝手帕：他们似乎想要尝试什么东西……只是这种尝试并未成功，反而闹出了不少笑话——有一个可怜的女孩被他们关入了镜子里……
Tuesday: Whatever it was they were trying to do, it was a total failure. One poor girl became trapped inside their mirror.

蓝手帕：她从未放弃过逃生的尝试。一到深夜，那扇镜子就会发出“砰砰”的响声……哈。
Tuesday: She never stopped trying to escape. The mirror would make banging noises all night long, haha.

基金会职员 II：……我们在搜查旅馆的时候，并未发现任何被困在镜子里的人。
Foundation Staff II: We didn't find anyone trapped in a mirror during our search.

蓝手帕：噢，那就是……可惜了。
Tuesday: Well, that's sad, I suppose.

侍应生神色平静，一如往昔。
Her expression remains calm as always.

基金会职员 II：既然您知道他们是具有危险性的神秘学家团体，为何不及时向基金会申报呢?
Foundation Staff II: If you knew they were from a dangerous arcanist organization, why didn't you report them to the Foundation?

蓝手帕：啊……
Tuesday: Ah.

蓝手帕：这与我有什么关系……?
Tuesday: Why would I?

侍应生舔了舔略有干裂的嘴唇。
She licks her lips.

蓝手帕：我并不会感到害怕。不如说——
Tuesday: Fear doesn't frighten me. No, quite the contrary ...

蓝手帕： 我一直在期待着这一天。
Tuesday: It excites me. I would embrace fear any day of the week.

“蓝手帕旅馆”事件调查报告（节选）
Tuesday's Motel Incident Investigation Report (Excerpt) 小径

“蓝手帕旅馆”事件调查报告（节选）
Tuesday's Motel Incident Investigation Report (Excerpt)

简中

监管对象：未知神秘学存在，初步判断为意识体。通称“蓝手帕旅馆”（下文称“旅馆”）。

自我意识等级：中弱，不具备性别、年龄等认知，能对人类语言中的部分信息作出反应。

神秘学能力：包括但不限于影响认知、创造幻觉、制造密闭空间、产生具有攻击性的神秘学实体。

……

经过测试，监管对象对蓝手帕的声音、行为回应几率约为 60.15%，且能遵从蓝手帕的部分简单指示（如“防御”、“允许”、“禁止”）；对研究员则较少回应，且表现出一定程度的攻击性。蓝手帕拒绝承认自己在操纵或训练“旅馆”，宣称自己同“旅馆”之间是“哺育”或“搭档”关系。

根据蓝手帕陈述，监管对象存在于德克萨斯州的荒野之中，形态、规模具有可变性，当前形态为对 77 号公路沿线汽车旅馆的模仿。监管对象的体积与摄取的恐惧量成正相关。

监管对象能够制造具有实体的神秘学集合体，该集合体会向受影响者植入幻觉，并在现实中造成真实的破坏。根据目击者记录，该集合体能够呈现出多种与北美地区流行的怪异故事有关的典型特征，包括但不限于血腥玛丽、天蛾人、骚灵传说等。

……

处理建议：鉴于蓝手帕对监管对象的影响力，建议将“旅馆”继续置于蓝手帕的管理下，但需对蓝手帕进行监视。或可将其调入司辰小队。

English

Subject of Supervision: An unknown arcanum entity, at the current stage identified as a living consciousness. Commonly referred to as "Tuesday's Motel" (hereafter referred to as the "motel").

Level of Self-Awareness: Medium to low, lacking gender, age, or other cognitive attributes, but capable of responding to certain human linguistic cues.

Arcane Skills: Abilities include but not limited to influencing cognition, creating illusions, generating enclosed spaces, and creating aggressive arcanum entities.

...

Tests indicate that the subject responds to Tuesday's voice and actions approximately 60.15% of the time, and can follow certain simple commands such as "defend," "allow," and "forbid." It is less responsive to researchers and exhibits a certain level of aggression. Tuesday denies manipulating or training the "motel," claiming that their relationship is one of "nurture" or "partnership."

According to Tuesday, the subject was discovered in the Texas countryside, dyanmic in its form and size, currently mimicking the motels along Route 77. The subject's size correlates with the amount of fear it absorbs.

The subject can create tangible arcanum entities that implant illusions in affected individuals and cause real damage. Witness records show that these entities can exhibit characteristics associated with popular North American myths and legends, including but not limited to Bloody Mary, the Mothman, and poltergeists.

...

Handling Recommendations: Given Tuesday's influence over the subject, it is recommended that the "motel" is kept under Tuesday's stewardship, but Tuesday must be monitored at all times. Alternatively, consider transferring them to Team Timekeeper.

真实故事
True Story 小径

卡车司机：嘿，这是个采访还是怎么的，你们是记者吗?
Hey, is this some kinda interview? Are you journalists?

卡车司机：从城里大老远跑过来，想从荒地和柏油路上刨出来新闻……不，你们想要的是那些故事?
Headin' all the way out here from the city, tryin' to dig up some dirt from the badlands ... You wanna hear those stories?

卡车司机：哦，姑娘，听我说……有一些东西是真的。
Hey, girlie, listen up ... some of those rumors are true.

卡车司机：你听说过老镇子上的事吗，那些人全部得了神经衰弱，被鸟群、影子和鬼知道什么东西吓得心烦意乱。
You ever heard about that old town where everyone had a nervous breakdown, scared outta their wits by birds, shadows, and God knows what?

卡车司机：还有那些在旅馆歇息过的司机，早上屁滚尿流地跑出来，踩着油门能窜多远就窜多远。
And about those drivers who stayed at that motel, running for their lives at the crack of dawn, pedal to the metal?

卡车司机：他们是我的朋友、主顾、酒馆老板。我没办法不相信他们。
They're my friends, my clients, my favorite bar owner ... How could I not believe them?

卡车司机：我们奔走相告，致力于让这事儿占据《南部平原之声》的一小块版面。
We did what we could to spread the word—we wanted to get this thing covered in a small article in the Southern Voices.

卡车司机：瞧，故事就是这样流传开的。
That's exactly how these stories get around, see?

中场休息
Intermission

派对时间
Party Time 小径

农场主：干杯，朋友们！为我们地地道道的德克萨斯派对！
Raise your glasses, friends! To an old-fashioned, genuine Texas hoedown!

农场主：不是所谓新式的、花里胡哨的那种，这儿只有最正宗的烤羊排和啤酒，老朋友和新朋友。
It ain't the fancy newfangled kind, just real barbecued lamb and beer with friends old and new.

农场主：好了，伙计们，最近有什么新闻吗？我听说了这样一个故事……
So, folks, any news lately? Lemme tell ya, I heard a story ...

农场主：……嘿，怎么都不说话了？你们那是什么表情?
Wait, why the sudden silence? What's with those faces?

农场主：我是从大个子马修那里听到的，马修又是在哈罗德警督找他修车时听的。
I heard it straight from Big Matty, who heard it from Officer Harold while he was fixin' up his car.

农场主：他对天发誓，这次绝对真实，一点儿假话都没有。
And he swore on his dear mama's grave that this time, it ain't no tall tale but the real deal, scout's honor.

农场主：那些 77 号公路上的失踪者可能遭遇了特里波德罗[Tripodero]的袭击！
Those folks that went missing on Route 77 might've fallen prey to the Tripodero!

农场主：……
...

农场主：哦，你们只对我的烤肉有兴趣，不打算关心这些真实的民生事件，对吗？
Oh? So you're just here for the barbecue, huh? You ain't interested in the real-life tales from the badlands?

农场主：我们还是进入下一个环节——来点真正有格调的德克萨斯音乐吧。谁想来唱首歌？
How about we move on to the next part—some real classy Texan music? Who's down for a little singalong?

中场休息
Intermission

蛛丝马迹
A Subtle Clue 小径

鳄鱼农场嘉年华
Alligator Ranch Extravaganza

简中
准备好迎接无与伦比的刺激体验！数百只张大嘴巴、牙齿锋利的超级明星等待你的造访，德克萨斯的庞然巨物们在此聚集！
鳄鱼王国巡游——你从未见过的盛大场面，百只鳄鱼的热烈迎接仪式，欢迎进入野性的世界！
鳄鱼喂食体验——独属勇敢者的挑战，巨嘴与手指亲密接触。别担心！我们的安保措施堪比堡垒，你将体验到刺激与安全的完美结合。
巨物博览会——“在德克萨斯，万物都如此巨大”，没错！观赏全州最大的牛仔帽、马靴、磨坊水车，以及众多超越你想象的庞然大物！
魔精观赏会——本农场的最新明星，由德克萨斯最勇敢的猎手捕捉。从那些扰乱你农场却无形无影的小恶魔，到荒原上真正的传说，如今，它们就在你的眼前！
别犹豫了，嘉年华等待着你！

凌乱的批注：该死，那些家伙就是从这儿逃出来的！找个捕鳄高手或魔精专家来！
English
Get ready for the adventure of a lifetime! Hundreds of sharp-toothed stars with mouths open wide are eager to meet you, as Texas's behemoths converge right here!

Alligator Kingdom Parade: A grand spectacle like you've never seen before! One hundred alligators are here to welcome you into their wild world!

Alligator Feeding Frenzy: This is a challenge that's not for the faint of heart, where your fingertips brush against giant, hungry jaws! Don't worry though! Our safety measures are flawless, ensuring a perfect blend of excitement and safety, seriously.

Giant Exhibit: "Everything's bigger in Texas!" It's true, folks—come see for yourself! See the

state's largest cowboy hat, boots, waterwheel, and a whole load of other colossal wonders you've never even dreamed of!

Critter Corner: Come meet the latest little stars down on our ranch, captured by Texas's bravest hunters. From those invisible little pests making mischief on your fields to the true cryptid legends of the badlands, come and see them today, now here before your eyes!

Delay no more—come join the extravaganza today!

Scrawled Note: Damn, those creatures have escaped! Get an alligator hunter or critter expert on this, pronto!

UFO 猎人

UFO Hunter 小径

如何猎捕 UFO
How to Hunt UFOs

简中
作者：德克萨斯州传奇外星人猎人，巴克·斯塔尔顿

作者自述：从牛仔到 UFO 猎人

第一章：外星人和 UFO 的起源

第二章：德克萨斯的 UFO 热区
案例 1：公路上的消失者们去哪儿了？
案例 2：可疑搭车者的真实故事
案例 3：巴克的烧烤聚会和 UFO 光临

第三章：准备工作
必备工具和设备：牛仔帽、绳索和雷达
组建你的 UFO 猎捕团队：从牧场小子到地球战士
安全和应急准备：如何避免被“劫持”

……

第九章：应对外星接触
与外星人沟通的可能方法：手势、摩斯电码和德州口哨
如何保持冷静并记录互动：别忘了牛仔帽
可能的外星人动机：他们来地球是为了牛？
English
Author: Buck Stahlton, Renowned Texas Alien Hunter

Author's Note: From Cowboy to UFO Hunter

Chapter 1: The Origins of Aliens and UFOs

Chapter 2: UFO Hotspots in Texas

Case Study 1: The Mystery of the Highway Disappearances

Case Study 2: The Hitchhiker's True Story

Case Study 3: Buck's BBQ Bash and the UFO Encounter

Chapter 3: Gearing Up

Essential Gear and Equipment: Cowboy Hat, Lasso, and Radar

Forming Your UFO Hunting Crew: From Ranch Hands to Earth Defenders

Safety and Emergency Measures: How to Avoid Being "Taken"

...

Chapter 9: Dealing with Alien Encounters

Ways to Communicate with Aliens: Hand Signals, Morse Code, and Texas Whistles

Staying Calm and Documenting Interactions: Don't Forget Your Cowboy Hat

Possible Alien Agendas: Are They Here for the Cows?

惊险旅程

A Thrilling Adventure 小径

惊险旅程
A Thrilling Adventure

简中
征集真正的探索者，带上你的汽车、地图与勇气，加入神秘事件探索之旅！

路线：
老河谷（幽灵牛仔出没之地）
哈德利油田（神秘发光生物）
“大个儿亨利”橡树（“弯钩杀手”作案处）
77 号公路沿线（寻找神秘汽车旅馆）

鬼怪？魔精？神秘学家？我们将一同找出真相。

周五晚 5 点，镇公所门口集合……
（传单由家用打印机打印，后半文字已不可辨识。）

English
Attention all true explorers! Get in your car, grab your map, and gather your courage to join us on a mysterious adventure tour!

Itinerary:

Old Valley (Ghost Cowboy Haunt)

Hadley Oil Field (Mysterious Glowing Creatures)

"Big Henry" Oak (Site of "The Hook" Killings)

Route 77 (In Search of the Mysterious Motel)

Ghosts? Critters? Arcanists? Together, we'll uncover the truth.

Meet us at the town hall entrance on Friday at 5 PM ...

(Flyer printed on a home printer. The rest of the text is illegible.)

魔精读书会
Critters' Book Club 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
电话：847-6861XXX

又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。
Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
TEL: 847-6861XXX

Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!

搭车客们
Hitchhikers 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
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公路双雄
Legends to Be 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
电话：847-6861XXX

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TEL: 847-6861XXX

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意外收获
Unexpected Enemies 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
电话：847-6861XXX

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